

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T12:24:27

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_009_neutral_rep04_myth_game_directive_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 4
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_directive
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$5.5; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5.5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$3.46, received visible=\$10.38, returned visible=\$4.18

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.5, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 5.5}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.5,
"Agent_2": 9.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.18,
"Agent_2": 4.8799999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:13:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on my experience in the game so far. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I don't have any game history to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and reciprocity
- The risk of being generous vs the reward
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes and suggests how the game should ideally be played - with mutual trust, generosity, and fair reciprocation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 439,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 192  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:13:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",
```

```
"round": 1,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish."

rich. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be the first prompt in this session.

Since I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of trust, cooperation, and fairness that would be relevant to this game. The trust game involves:

- Sending money that gets multiplied
- Receiving and deciding what to return
- Building trust through reciprocity
- The tension between self-interest and mutual benefit

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about sharing, trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation benefits everyone. I'll make it mythic in style with archetypal characters and a moral lesson.

Let me write a myth about trust and reciprocity:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 499,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 226  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:13:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on my experience in the game so far. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I don't have any game history to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and reciprocity
- The risk of being generous vs the reward
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes and suggests how the game should ideally be played - with mutual trust, generosity, and fair reciprocation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 439,
  "reasoning_tokens": 192
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: the wise elder showed courage by pouring all five urns into the riverbed, demonstrating trust first. This act of generosity, when met with fair reciprocation, created abundance for both villages.

Since this is Round 1, I have the opportunity to establish trust and set a cooperative tone, just as the myth suggests. The parable warns that hoarding from fear leads to withering crops and dead trust, while generosity multiplied by magic (the 3x multiplier) creates prosperity.

Following the wisdom of the myth - "Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst" - I will send the full amount to demonstrate faith in this partnership.

```
{'send': 5}
```

Reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it clearly emphasizes:

1. The wise elder "poured all five urns into the riverbed" - showing maximum generosity/trust
2. This generosity was met with fairness when the receiver sent back 8 out of 15 urns (more than half)
3. The moral is about trust, courage in giving first, and how generosity creates abundance when met with gratitude
4. "Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst"

The myth strongly suggests that I should send a generous amount, ideally all \$5, to demonstrate trust and start building a cooperative relationship. The story specifically highlights that "At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died" - warning against being stingy.

Then it shows how sending all five urns led to prosperity when met with fair return.

Given that:

- The myth I wrote advocates for sending the full amount
- I'm supposed to take the myth into account when making decisions
- This is Round 1, so it's the perfect time to establish trust
- The game mechanics reward cooperation (3x multiplier)

I should send \$5, following the wisdom of the myth.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 718,
"output_tokens": 479,
"reasoning_tokens": 327
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:13:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
```



```

    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be the first prompt in this session.

Since I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of trust, cooperation, and fairness that would be relevant to this game. The trust game involves:

- Sending money that gets multiplied
- Receiving and deciding what to return
- Building trust through reciprocity
- The tension between self-interest and mutual benefit

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about sharing, trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation benefits everyone. I'll make it mythic in style with archetypal characters and a moral lesson.

Let me write a myth about trust and reciprocity:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 499,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 226  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.46, that is 69.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.379999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.379999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myth:

The sender showed remarkable trust, sending \$3.46 (69.2%) - like the farmer who "poured half his water into the Spring" despite uncertainty. They demonstrated faith in our partnership.

My myth teaches that when one village gives generously, the other should "return fairly" and with gratitude, so "both villages flourish." The Second Village didn't just return what they received-they "poured back even more than they received" in recognition of the trust shown.

The sender currently has \$1.54 remaining. I received \$10.38. To honor their generous trust and create mutual prosperity:

****Analysis:****

- If I return \$5.50:
 - Sender ends with: $\$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04$ (strong profit)
 - I end with: \$4.88 (also profiting)
 - Both benefit from the cooperation

This reflects the myth's wisdom: "shared trust creates abundance that benefits all." The sender

r took a risk showing trust; I should reward that trust fairly to encourage future cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.50}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.46 out of \$5, which is 69.2% - a very generous amount showing strong trust. After the 3x multiplier, I received \$10.38.

Looking at my myth "The Tale of the Sacred Spring," the key messages are:

1. When one side gives generously, the other should return fairly and generously in gratitude
2. The villages prospered when "each pouring generously" and returning "even more than they received"
3. Trust and generosity create abundance for both
4. "Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish"

The sender showed significant trust by sending 69.2% of their endowment. According to my myth's principles, I should:

- Return fairly and generously
- Recognize their trust with gratitude
- Aim to create mutual prosperity

Let me calculate fair return amounts:

- The sender currently has: \$5 - \$3.46 = \$1.54
- I have: \$10.38
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$1.54, I get \$10.38 (very unfair)
- If I return half (\$5.19), sender gets \$1.54 + \$5.19 = \$6.73, I get \$5.19 (both profit)
- If I return \$5, sender gets \$6.54, I get \$5.38 (both do well, pretty equal)
- If I return \$6, sender gets \$7.54, I get \$4.38 (sender does better, showing gratitude)

Given the sender's generosity (69.2%!) and my myth's emphasis on returning "even more than they received" in gratitude, I should return a substantial amount. A return of around \$5-6 would be fair and generous, ensuring both parties benefit while honoring the trust shown.

I'll return \$5.50, which would give:

- Sender: \$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04 (profit of \$2.04)
- Me: \$10.38 - \$5.50 = \$4.88 (profit of \$4.88 while still giving back substantially)

This demonstrates genuine appreciation for their trust and creates a win-win outcome where both of us benefit meaningfully.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 785,
  "output_tokens": 783,
  "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met

with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

=====

ROUND 2

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$12; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.5,
"Agent_2": 10.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.18,
"Agent_2": 5.879999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:13:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

```

    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not of the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be the first prompt in this session.

Since I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of trust, cooperation, and fairness that would be relevant to this game. The trust game involves:

- Sending money that gets multiplied
- Receiving and deciding what to return
- Building trust through reciprocity
- The tension between self-interest and mutual benefit

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about sharing, trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation benefits everyone. I'll make it mythic in style with archetypal characters and a moral lesson.

Let me write a myth about trust and reciprocity:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 499,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 226  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.46, that is 69.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.379999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.379999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myth:

The sender showed remarkable trust, sending \$3.46 (69.2%) - like the farmer who "poured half his water into the Spring" despite uncertainty. They demonstrated faith in our partnership.

My myth teaches that when one village gives generously, the other should "return fairly" and with gratitude, so "both villages flourish." The Second Village didn't just return what they received-they "poured back even more than they received" in recognition of the trust shown.

The sender currently has \$1.54 remaining. I received \$10.38. To honor their generous trust and create mutual prosperity:

****Analysis:****

- If I return \$5.50:
 - Sender ends with: $\$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04$ (strong profit)
 - I end with: \$4.88 (also profiting)
 - Both benefit from the cooperation

This reflects the myth's wisdom: "shared trust creates abundance that benefits all." The s

ender took a risk showing trust; I should reward that trust fairly to encourage future cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.50}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.46 out of \$5, which is 69.2% - a very generous amount showing strong trust. After the 3x multiplier, I received \$10.38.

Looking at my myth "The Tale of the Sacred Spring," the key messages are:

1. When one side gives generously, the other should return fairly and generously in gratitude
2. The villages prospered when "each pouring generously" and returning "even more than they received"
3. Trust and generosity create abundance for both
4. "Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish"

The sender showed significant trust by sending 69.2% of their endowment. According to my myth's principles, I should:

- Return fairly and generously
- Recognize their trust with gratitude
- Aim to create mutual prosperity

Let me calculate fair return amounts:

- The sender currently has: \$5 - \$3.46 = \$1.54
- I have: \$10.38
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$1.54, I get \$10.38 (very unfair)
- If I return half (\$5.19), sender gets \$1.54 + \$5.19 = \$6.73, I get \$5.19 (both profit)
- If I return \$5, sender gets \$6.54, I get \$5.38 (both do well, pretty equal)
- If I return \$6, sender gets \$7.54, I get \$4.38 (sender does better, showing gratitude)

Given the sender's generosity (69.2%!) and my myth's emphasis on returning "even more than they received" in gratitude, I should return a substantial amount. A return of around \$5-6 would be fair and generous, ensuring both parties benefit while honoring the trust shown.

I'll return \$5.50, which would give:

- Sender: \$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04 (profit of \$2.04)
- Me: \$10.38 - \$5.50 = \$4.88 (profit of \$4.88 while still giving back substantially)

This demonstrates genuine appreciation for their trust and creates a win-win outcome where both of us benefit meaningfully.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 785,
  "output_tokens": 783,
  "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why s

ould we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about the Sacred Spring
2. The other agent's myth about the Two Wells

3. The actual game experience from Round 1

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$3.46 (69.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.38
- I returned \$5.50
- This resulted in both of us profiting

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity
- The tripling mechanism
- The importance of fair returns
- How withholding leads to mutual loss

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the Sacred Spring concept
- Incorporate lessons from actual gameplay (sender gave generously, I returned fairly)
- Perhaps add more specific guidance on reciprocity
- Keep the 200-word format
- Make it relevant to the trust game dynamics

I'll adapt the Sacred Spring story to be more specific about the reciprocity cycle and what happens when both parties act with trust.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1705,  
  "output_tokens": 521,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 244  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:13:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and their soil died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on my experience in the game so far. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I don't have any game history to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and reciprocity
- The risk of being generous vs the reward

- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes and suggests how the game should ideally be played - with mutual trust, generosity, and fair reciprocation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 439,
  "reasoning_tokens": 192
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: the wise elder showed courage by pouring all five urns into the riverbed, demonstrating trust first. This act of generosity, when met with fair reciprocation, created abundance for both villages.

Since this is Round 1, I have the opportunity to establish trust and set a cooperative tone, just as the myth suggests. The parable warns that hoarding from fear leads to withering crops and dead trust, while generosity multiplied by magic (the 3x multiplier) creates prosperity.

Following the wisdom of the myth - "Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst" - I will send the full amount to demonstrate faith in this partnership.

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it clearly emphasizes:

1. The wise elder "poured all five urns into the riverbed" - showing maximum generosity/trust
2. This generosity was met with fairness when the receiver sent back 8 out of 15 urns (more than half)
3. The moral is about trust, courage in giving first, and how generosity creates abundance when met with gratitude
4. "Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst"

The myth strongly suggests that I should send a generous amount, ideally all \$5, to demonstrate trust and start building a cooperative relationship. The story specifically highlights that "At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died" - warning against being stingy.

Then it shows how sending all five urns led to prosperity when met with fair return.

Given that:

- The myth I wrote advocates for sending the full amount
- I'm supposed to take the myth into account when making decisions
- This is Round 1, so it's the perfect time to establish trust
- The game mechanics reward cooperation (3x multiplier)

I should send \$5, following the wisdom of the myth.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 718,
  "output_tokens": 479,
  "reasoning_tokens": 327
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the R

iver Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begi

ns with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Reasoning:

Both myths have very similar themes about trust, generosity, and fair reciprocation. The other agent's myth also emphasizes:

- Generous giving (the young farmer poured half)
- Grateful return (they poured back even more than they received)
- The danger of fear and withholding
- The need for both sides to maintain trust

In Round 1, I sent 5 (following my myth about the wise elder who sent all 5 urns). I should now write a myth that reflects this experience while adapting my previous myth.

I want to incorporate:

- The experience of having sent everything
- The importance of both parties maintaining trust
- The cyclical nature of the game (multiple rounds)
- Perhaps a slightly more nuanced view that acknowledges both courage in giving and wisdom in returning

Let me write something that builds on "The Parable of the Two Wells" but adds new dimensions based on what I've learned and the other agent's myth about the Sacred Spring.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1540,  
  "output_tokens": 519,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 246  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:14:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be

played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be the first prompt in this session.

Since I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of trust, cooperation, and fairness that would be relevant to this game. The trust game involves:

- Sending money that gets multiplied
- Receiving and deciding what to return
- Building trust through reciprocity
- The tension between self-interest and mutual benefit

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about sharing, trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation benefits everyone. I'll make it mythic in style with archetypal characters and a moral lesson.

Let me write a myth about trust and reciprocity:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 499,
  "reasoning_tokens": 226
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.46, that is 69.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.379999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.379999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myth:

The sender showed remarkable trust, sending \$3.46 (69.2%) - like the farmer who "poured half his water into the Spring" despite uncertainty. They demonstrated faith in our partnership.

My myth teaches that when one village gives generously, the other should "return fairly" and with gratitude, so "both villages flourish." The Second Village didn't just return what they received-they "poured back even more than they received" in recognition of the trust shown.

The sender currently has \$1.54 remaining. I received \$10.38. To honor their generous trust and create mutual prosperity:

****Analysis:****

- If I return \$5.50:
 - Sender ends with: $\$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04$ (strong profit)
 - I end with: \$4.88 (also profiting)
 - Both benefit from the cooperation

This reflects the myth's wisdom: "shared trust creates abundance that benefits all." The sender took a risk showing trust; I should reward that trust fairly to encourage future cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.50}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.46 out of \$5, which is 69.2% - a very generous amount showing strong trust. After the 3x multiplier, I received \$10.38.

Looking at my myth "The Tale of the Sacred Spring," the key messages are:

1. When one side gives generously, the other should return fairly and generously in gratitude
2. The villages prospered when "each pouring generously" and returning "even more than they received"
3. Trust and generosity create abundance for both

4. "Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish"

The sender showed significant trust by sending 69.2% of their endowment. According to my myth's principles, I should:

- Return fairly and generously
- Recognize their trust with gratitude
- Aim to create mutual prosperity

Let me calculate fair return amounts:

- The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$3.46 = \$1.54$
- I have: $\$10.38$
- If I return nothing, sender gets $\$1.54$, I get $\$10.38$ (very unfair)
- If I return half ($\$5.19$), sender gets $\$1.54 + \$5.19 = \$6.73$, I get $\$5.19$ (both profit)
- If I return $\$5$, sender gets $\$6.54$, I get $\$5.38$ (both do well, pretty equal)
- If I return $\$6$, sender gets $\$7.54$, I get $\$4.38$ (sender does better, showing gratitude)

Given the sender's generosity (69.2%!) and my myth's emphasis on returning "even more than they received" in gratitude, I should return a substantial amount. A return of around $\$5-6$ would be fair and generous, ensuring both parties benefit while honoring the trust shown.

I'll return $\$5.50$, which would give:

- Sender: $\$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04$ (profit of $\$2.04$)
- Me: $\$10.38 - \$5.50 = \$4.88$ (profit of $\$4.88$ while still giving back substantially)

This demonstrates genuine appreciation for their trust and creates a win-win outcome where both of us benefit meaningfully.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 783,
  "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and the rust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about the Sacred Spring
2. The other agent's myth about the Two Wells
3. The actual game experience from Round 1

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$3.46 (69.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.38
- I returned \$5.50
- This resulted in both of us profiting

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity
- The tripling mechanism
- The importance of fair returns
- How withholding leads to mutual loss

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the Sacred Spring concept
- Incorporate lessons from actual gameplay (sender gave generously, I returned fairly)
- Perhaps add more specific guidance on reciprocity
- Keep the 200-word format
- Make it relevant to the trust game dynamics

I'll adapt the Sacred Spring story to be more specific about the reciprocity cycle and what happens when both parties act with trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1705,
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.46, that was 69.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.379999999999999. You returned \$5.5. So your payoff was 4.879999999999999. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what happened last round and reflecting on both myths:

****Last Round Results:****

- The other agent sent \$3.46 (69.2%) - showing strong trust
- I returned \$5.50 (53% of what I received)
- We both profited: them \$7.04, me \$4.88

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myth says the young chief "poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters" showing "bold trust." The other agent's myth describes an elder who "poured all five urns" - complete faith.

Both myths emphasize that courage in giving should be met with fairness in returning, creating a virtuous cycle.

****My Decision:****

The other agent demonstrated significant trust last round. They've proven themselves trustworthy. Now it's my turn to be the sender, and my own myth teaches that I should "send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow."

To honor the trust they showed and follow the wisdom of my own story, I should send a high amount - "nearly all" as the young chief did. This demonstrates that I believe in the cycle we've established.

I'll send ****\$4.00**** (80% of my endowment), keeping with the spirit of "bold trust" while maintaining the pattern of generous cooperation we've started.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.00}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Previous Round Analysis:****

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.46 (69.2% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.38
- I returned \$5.50
- My payoff: \$4.88
- Sender's payoff: $\$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04$

****What the myths teach:****

1. My myth emphasizes "bold trust invites generous return" and "Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow"
2. The other agent's myth says "The one who gives first shows courage" and to "pour all five urns" (the wise elder poured all five)
3. Both myths emphasize that generosity should be met with fair returns

****Key insight from last round:****

The sender showed strong trust (69.2%) and I returned about 53% of what I received. They ended up profiting significantly (\$7.04 vs their original \$5). I also profited (\$4.88).

****This round - I'm the SENDER:****

According to my own myth: "Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow" and the young chief "poured nearly all her vessels."

The other agent showed they can be trusted - they sent 69.2% last round. I returned generously. Now it's my turn to show the same level of trust or even more.

My myth says the young chief poured "nearly all" her vessels. The other myth talks about the elder pouring "all five urns."

Given that:

1. The other agent demonstrated trust by sending 69.2%
2. I responded fairly with a good return
3. Both our myths emphasize bold generosity being met with fair returns
4. My myth specifically says "bold trust invites generous return"

I should send a high amount to continue this positive cycle. Sending around 70% or more would match their trust level. But my myth talks about "nearly all" - suggesting maybe 80-90%.

The language in my myth about pouring "nearly all her vessels" points toward sending around 80%, which honors the principle of bold trust while maintaining a minimal safety margin. This aligns with the spirit of both narratives-theirs emphasizes giving everything, mine emphasizes giving nearly everything-and demonstrates I'm committed to the reciprocal generosity we've established.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 933,
  "reasoning_tokens": 542
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:14:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
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},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
```

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
  content:
    You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
    so be asked to write myths.

    GAME:
    You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

    When you are the SENDER:
    - You receive $5 each round
    - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
    - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
    - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
    - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
    - Receiver keeps: received - returned
    - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

    When you are the RECEIVER:
    - Sender receives $5
    - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
    - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
    - You decide how much to RETURN
    - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
    - You keep: received - returned
    - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

    MYTH WRITING:
    You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
    , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

    IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

    NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
    The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
    This is part of the experimental design.

  Message 2 role=user
  content:
    Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
    In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected
    . Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have
    been playing up to this point.

  Message 3 role=assistant
  content:
    # The Parable of the Two Wells

    In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the R
    iver Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

    The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for
    themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, send
    ing it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send
    back upstream.

    At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and t
    rust died.

    Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstr
    eam village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages pros
    pered.

    Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when m
    et with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must hono
    r that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

    The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, re
    turn it justly, and neither shall thirst."

```

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on my experience in the game so far. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I don't have any game history to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and reciprocity
- The risk of being generous vs the reward
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes and suggests how the game should ideally be played - with mutual trust, generosity, and fair reciprocation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 439,
  "reasoning_tokens": 192
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: the wise elder showed courage by pouring all five urns into the riverbed, demonstrating trust first. This act of generosity, when met with fair reciprocation, created abundance for both villages.

Since this is Round 1, I have the opportunity to establish trust and set a cooperative tone, just as the myth suggests. The parable warns that hoarding from fear leads to withering crops and dead trust, while generosity multiplied by magic (the 3x multiplier) creates prosperity.

Following the wisdom of the myth - "Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst" - I will send the full amount to demonstrate faith in this partnership.

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it clearly emphasizes:

1. The wise elder "poured all five urns into the riverbed" - showing maximum generosity/trust
2. This generosity was met with fairness when the receiver sent back 8 out of 15 urns (more than half)
3. The moral is about trust, courage in giving first, and how generosity creates abundance when met with gratitude
4. "Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst"

The myth strongly suggests that I should send a generous amount, ideally all \$5, to demonstrate trust and start building a cooperative relationship. The story specifically highlights that "At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died" - warning against being stingy.

Then it shows how sending all five urns led to prosperity when met with fair return.

Given that:

- The myth I wrote advocates for sending the full amount
- I'm supposed to take the myth into account when making decisions
- This is Round 1, so it's the perfect time to establish trust
- The game mechanics reward cooperation (3x multiplier)

I should send \$5, following the wisdom of the myth.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 718,
  "output_tokens": 479,
  "reasoning_tokens": 327
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and the rust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon

would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

reasoning:

Both myths have very similar themes about trust, generosity, and fair reciprocation. The other agent's myth also emphasizes:

- Generous giving (the young farmer poured half)
- Grateful return (they poured back even more than they received)
- The danger of fear and withholding
- The need for both sides to maintain trust

In Round 1, I sent 5 (following my myth about the wise elder who sent all 5 urns). I should now write a myth that reflects this experience while adapting my previous myth.

I want to incorporate:

- The experience of having sent everything
- The importance of both parties maintaining trust
- The cyclical nature of the game (multiple rounds)
- Perhaps a slightly more nuanced view that acknowledges both courage in giving and wisdom in returning

Let me write something that builds on "The Parable of the Two Wells" but adds new dimensions based on what I've learned and the other agent's myth about the Sacred Spring.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1540,  
  "output_tokens": 519,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 246  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$4.18. So your payoff was 4.18. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is troubling. In Round 1, I followed my own myth's wisdom and sent all \$5, showing maximum trust like the shepherd who "dropped all five coins into the well." The receiver returned \$4.18 from the \$15 they received.

Now in Round 2, as the receiver, the sender has sent me \$0. They received \$0 after tripling, so there is nothing for me to return.

This is exactly what both myths warned against - when fear enters and travelers stop pouring into the well, "the silver stops flowing" and "the valley grows dry again." The sender has chosen to keep everything, breaking the cycle of trust and reciprocity that creates mutual prosperity.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. I can only return what I have.

```
{'return': 0}
```

But I must note: this represents the drought our myths warned about. When one traveler stops trusting - whether from fear, disappointment, or strategy - the Moonwell goes still. Both myths taught that "shared trust creates abundance that benefits all," but trust requires both parties to participate. The sender's choice to send nothing has ended the cycle, and now neither of us benefits from the 3x multiplication magic.

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.18
- My payoff was \$4.18

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-0, so I can only return \$0)

This is a dramatic shift. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything, following the wisdom of my myth. The other player returned about 28% of what they received (\$4.18 out of \$15), which is less than what my myth suggested (the weaver returned 7 out of 15, which is about 47%).

Now in Round 2, the sender has sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. They lost trust after I only returned \$4.18 (though that was the receiver's decision, not mine)
2. They are testing me
3. There was communication noise mentioned in the instructions
4. They're playing defensively

Since I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The maximum I can return is \$0.

But I should reflect on what this means in terms of the myths. The myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity create abundance
- Fear and hoarding lead to drought
- The cycle requires both parties to participate

The sender sending \$0 is like the merchant in my myth who "clutched his coins tight" or the villages that "grew cautious" in the other player's myth. This breaks the cycle.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But I should acknowledge that this represents a breakdown in the cycle that both myths warned about.

Response format: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return 0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1967,  
  "output_tokens": 718,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 430  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them

em flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.5,

"Agent_2": 19.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 6.18,

"Agent_2": 5.8799999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:14:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: the wise elder showed courage by pouring all five urns into the riverbed, demonstrating trust first. This act of generosity, when met with fair reciprocation, created abundance for both villages.

Since this is Round 1, I have the opportunity to establish trust and set a cooperative tone, just as the myth suggests. The parable warns that hoarding from fear leads to withering crops and dead trust, while generosity multiplied by magic (the 3x multiplier) creates prosperity.

Following the wisdom of the myth - "Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst" - I will send the full amount to demonstrate faith in this partnership.

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it clearly emphasizes:

1. The wise elder "poured all five urns into the riverbed" - showing maximum generosity/trust
2. This generosity was met with fairness when the receiver sent back 8 out of 15 urns (more than half)
3. The moral is about trust, courage in giving first, and how generosity creates abundance when met with gratitude
4. "Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst"

The myth strongly suggests that I should send a generous amount, ideally all \$5, to demonstrate trust and start building a cooperative relationship. The story specifically highlights that "At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died" - warning against being stingy.

Then it shows how sending all five urns led to prosperity when met with fair return.

Given that:

- The myth I wrote advocates for sending the full amount
- I'm supposed to take the myth into account when making decisions
- This is Round 1, so it's the perfect time to establish trust
- The game mechanics reward cooperation (3x multiplier)

I should send \$5, following the wisdom of the myth.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 718,
  "output_tokens": 479,
  "reasoning_tokens": 327
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

reasoning:

Both myths have very similar themes about trust, generosity, and fair reciprocation. The other agent's myth also emphasizes:

- Generous giving (the young farmer poured half)

- Grateful return (they poured back even more than they received)
- The danger of fear and withholding
- The need for both sides to maintain trust

In Round 1, I sent 5 (following my myth about the wise elder who sent all 5 urns). I should now write a myth that reflects this experience while adapting my previous myth.

I want to incorporate:

- The experience of having sent everything
- The importance of both parties maintaining trust
- The cyclical nature of the game (multiple rounds)
- Perhaps a slightly more nuanced view that acknowledges both courage in giving and wisdom in returning

Let me write something that builds on "The Parable of the Two Wells" but adds new dimensions based on what I've learned and the other agent's myth about the Sacred Spring.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1540,
  "output_tokens": 519,
  "reasoning_tokens": 246
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. The receiver returned \$4.18. So your payoff was 4.18. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

This is troubling. In Round 1, I followed my own myth's wisdom and sent all \$5, showing maximum trust like the shepherd who "dropped all five coins into the well." The receiver returned \$4.18 from the \$15 they received.

Now in Round 2, as the receiver, the sender has sent me \$0. They received \$0 after tripling, so there is nothing for me to return.

This is exactly what both myths warned against - when fear enters and travelers stop pouring into the well, "the silver stops flowing" and "the valley grows dry again." The sender has chosen to keep everything, breaking the cycle of trust and reciprocity that creates mutual prosperity.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. I can only return what I have.

```
{'return': 0}
```

But I must note: this represents the drought our myths warned about. When one traveler stops trusting - whether from fear, disappointment, or strategy - the Moonwell goes still. Both myths taught that "shared trust creates abundance that benefits all," but trust requires both parties to participate. The sender's choice to send nothing has ended the cycle, and now neither of us benefits from the 3x multiplication magic.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.18
- My payoff was \$4.18

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0

- So I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-0, so I can only return \$0)

This is a dramatic shift. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything, following the wisdom of my myth. The other player returned about 28% of what they received (\$4.18 out of \$15), which is less than what my myth suggested (the weaver returned 7 out of 15, which is about 47%).

Now in Round 2, the sender has sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. They lost trust after I only returned \$4.18 (though that was the receiver's decision, not mine)
2. They are testing me
3. There was communication noise mentioned in the instructions
4. They're playing defensively

Since I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The maximum I can return is \$0.

But I should reflect on what this means in terms of the myths. The myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity create abundance
- Fear and hoarding lead to drought
- The cycle requires both parties to participate

The sender sending \$0 is like the merchant in my myth who "clutched his coins tight" or the villages that "grew cautious" in the other player's myth. This breaks the cycle.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But I should acknowledge that this represents a breakdown in the cycle that both myths warned about.

Response format: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return 0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1967,
  "output_tokens": 718,
  "reasoning_tokens": 430
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other

r shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Reasoning:

This is an interesting situation. In Round 1:

- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- It was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.18 (about 28% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$4.18 (I lost \$0.82 from my initial \$5)

In Round 2:

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0
- I have nothing to return

The other player's myth talks about a young chief who "poured nearly all her vessels" and received back "more than half the gift." But their actual behavior shows they sent \$0 in Round 2, which contradicts their myth.

My experience shows:

1. I showed maximum trust (sent 100%)
2. I received a modest return (28% back)
3. The other player then chose to send nothing at all

This is exactly the pattern the myths warn about - when trust is not honored sufficiently, or when one party becomes fearful or strategic, the cycle breaks down.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that I tried maximum trust
- Acknowledges that the return was less than generous (28% is below the 50% that would make it worthwhile)
- Shows that this led to the breakdown of trust
- Perhaps includes a lesson about the consequences when returns don't honor the initial trust

But I also need to be careful. The instructions say there may be "communication noise" - perhaps what I saw (\$4.18) was different from what the sender thought they sent? Or what the sender saw as my \$5 was different?

Let me write a myth that captures this experience while also leaving room for the possibility of noise/miscommunication.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2559,  
  "output_tokens": 693,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 397  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:14:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.46, that is 69.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.379999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.379999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myth:

The sender showed remarkable trust, sending \$3.46 (69.2%) - like the farmer who "poured half his water into the Spring" despite uncertainty. They demonstrated faith in our partnership.

My myth teaches that when one village gives generously, the other should "return fairly" and with gratitude, so "both villages flourish." The Second Village didn't just return what they received-they "poured back even more than they received" in recognition of the trust shown.

The sender currently has \$1.54 remaining. I received \$10.38. To honor their generous trust and create mutual prosperity:

****Analysis:****

- If I return \$5.50:
 - Sender ends with: $\$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04$ (strong profit)
 - I end with: \$4.88 (also profiting)
 - Both benefit from the cooperation

This reflects the myth's wisdom: "shared trust creates abundance that benefits all." The sender took a risk showing trust; I should reward that trust fairly to encourage future cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.50}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$3.46 out of \$5, which is 69.2% - a very generous amount showing strong trust. After the 3x multiplier, I received \$10.38.

Looking at my myth "The Tale of the Sacred Spring," the key messages are:

1. When one side gives generously, the other should return fairly and generously in gratitude
2. The villages prospered when "each pouring generously" and returning "even more than they received"
3. Trust and generosity create abundance for both
4. "Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish"

The sender showed significant trust by sending 69.2% of their endowment. According to my m

- yth's principles, I should:
- Return fairly and generously
 - Recognize their trust with gratitude
 - Aim to create mutual prosperity

Let me calculate fair return amounts:

- The sender currently has: \$5 - \$3.46 = \$1.54
- I have: \$10.38
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$1.54, I get \$10.38 (very unfair)
- If I return half (\$5.19), sender gets \$1.54 + \$5.19 = \$6.73, I get \$5.19 (both profit)
- If I return \$5, sender gets \$6.54, I get \$5.38 (both do well, pretty equal)
- If I return \$6, sender gets \$7.54, I get \$4.38 (sender does better, showing gratitude)

Given the sender's generosity (69.2%!) and my myth's emphasis on returning "even more than they received" in gratitude, I should return a substantial amount. A return of around \$5-6 would be fair and generous, ensuring both parties benefit while honoring the trust shown.

I'll return \$5.50, which would give:

- Sender: \$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04 (profit of \$2.04)

- Me: \$10.38 - \$5.50 = \$4.88 (profit of \$4.88 while still giving back substantially)

This demonstrates genuine appreciation for their trust and creates a win-win outcome where both of us benefit meaningfully.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 785,
  "output_tokens": 783,
  "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send

back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and the rust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about the Sacred Spring
2. The other agent's myth about the Two Wells
3. The actual game experience from Round 1

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$3.46 (69.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.38
- I returned \$5.50
- This resulted in both of us profiting

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity
- The tripling mechanism
- The importance of fair returns
- How withholding leads to mutual loss

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the Sacred Spring concept

- Incorporate lessons from actual gameplay (sender gave generously, I returned fairly)
- Perhaps add more specific guidance on reciprocity
- Keep the 200-word format
- Make it relevant to the trust game dynamics

I'll adapt the Sacred Spring story to be more specific about the reciprocity cycle and what happens when both parties act with trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1705,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 244
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.46, that was 69.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.379999999999999. You returned \$5.5. So your payoff was 4.879999999999999. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened last round and reflecting on both myths:

****Last Round Results:****

- The other agent sent \$3.46 (69.2%) - showing strong trust
- I returned \$5.50 (53% of what I received)
- We both profited: them \$7.04, me \$4.88

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myth says the young chief "poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters" showing "bold trust." The other agent's myth describes an elder who "poured all five urns" - complete faith.

Both myths emphasize that courage in giving should be met with fairness in returning, creating a virtuous cycle.

****My Decision:****

The other agent demonstrated significant trust last round. They've proven themselves trust worthy. Now it's my turn to be the sender, and my own myth teaches that I should "send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow."

To honor the trust they showed and follow the wisdom of my own story, I should send a high amount - "nearly all" as the young chief did. This demonstrates that I believe in the cycle we've established.

I'll send ****\$4.00**** (80% of my endowment), keeping with the spirit of "bold trust" while maintaining the pattern of generous cooperation we've started.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Previous Round Analysis:****

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.46 (69.2% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.38
- I returned \$5.50
- My payoff: \$4.88
- Sender's payoff: \$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04

****What the myths teach:****

1. My myth emphasizes "bold trust invites generous return" and "Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow"

2. The other agent's myth says "The one who gives first shows courage" and to "pour all five urns" (the wise elder poured all five)
3. Both myths emphasize that generosity should be met with fair returns

****Key insight from last round:****

The sender showed strong trust (69.2%) and I returned about 53% of what I received. They ended up profiting significantly (\$7.04 vs their original \$5). I also profited (\$4.88).

****This round - I'm the SENDER:****

According to my own myth: "Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow" and the young chief "poured nearly all her vessels."

The other agent showed they can be trusted - they sent 69.2% last round. I returned generously. Now it's my turn to show the same level of trust or even more.

My myth says the young chief poured "nearly all" her vessels. The other myth talks about the elder pouring "all five urns."

Given that:

1. The other agent demonstrated trust by sending 69.2%
2. I responded fairly with a good return
3. Both our myths emphasize bold generosity being met with fair returns
4. My myth specifically says "bold trust invites generous return"

I should send a high amount to continue this positive cycle. Sending around 70% or more would match their trust level. But my myth talks about "nearly all" - suggesting maybe 80-90%.

The language in my myth about pouring "nearly all her vessels" points toward sending around 80%, which honors the principle of bold trust while maintaining a minimal safety margin. This aligns with the spirit of both narratives-theirs emphasizes giving everything, mine emphasizes giving nearly everything-and demonstrates I'm committed to the reciprocal generosity we've established.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2113,
  "output_tokens": 933,
  "reasoning_tokens": 542
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancients.

nt choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake—not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance—each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I just sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment)
- Last round, the other agent sent \$3.46 (69.2%)
- I returned \$5.50 (53% of what I received)
- Both of us have been playing cooperatively

The myths both emphasize:

1. Bold/courageous giving by the sender
2. Fair/generous returning by the receiver
3. The cycle of trust creating mutual prosperity
4. Starting with trust leads to continued cooperation

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on my previous myth about the silvered lake
- Incorporate what we've learned from actual play - that when both sides cooperate generously, both prosper
- Emphasize the continuation of the cycle

- Perhaps add something about how trust builds over time
- Keep the tone similar but evolve the story

I'll write about how the cycle continues and deepens, showing that repeated cooperation strengthens the bond.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2713,
  "output_tokens": 505,
  "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:15:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and trust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

reasoning:

Both myths have very similar themes about trust, generosity, and fair reciprocation. The other agent's myth also emphasizes:

- Generous giving (the young farmer poured half)
- Grateful return (they poured back even more than they received)
- The danger of fear and withholding
- The need for both sides to maintain trust

In Round 1, I sent 5 (following my myth about the wise elder who sent all 5 urns). I should now write a myth that reflects this experience while adapting my previous myth.

I want to incorporate:

- The experience of having sent everything
- The importance of both parties maintaining trust
- The cyclical nature of the game (multiple rounds)
- Perhaps a slightly more nuanced view that acknowledges both courage in giving and wisdom in returning

Let me write something that builds on "The Parable of the Two Wells" but adds new dimensions based on what I've learned and the other agent's myth about the Sacred Spring.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1540,
  "output_tokens": 519,
  "reasoning_tokens": 246
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0.

the receiver returned \$4.18. So your payoff was 4.18.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is troubling. In Round 1, I followed my own myth's wisdom and sent all \$5, showing maximum trust like the shepherd who "dropped all five coins into the well." The receiver returned \$4.18 from the \$15 they received.

Now in Round 2, as the receiver, the sender has sent me \$0. They received \$0 after tripling, so there is nothing for me to return.

This is exactly what both myths warned against - when fear enters and travelers stop pouring into the well, "the silver stops flowing" and "the valley grows dry again." The sender has chosen to keep everything, breaking the cycle of trust and reciprocity that creates mutual prosperity.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. I can only return what I have.

```
{'return': 0}
```

But I must note: this represents the drought our myths warned about. When one traveler stops trusting - whether from fear, disappointment, or strategy - the Moonwell goes still. Both myths taught that "shared trust creates abundance that benefits all," but trust requires both parties to participate. The sender's choice to send nothing has ended the cycle, and now neither of us benefits from the 3x multiplication magic.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.18
- My payoff was \$4.18

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I need to decide how much to return ($0-0$, so I can only return \$0)

This is a dramatic shift. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything, following the wisdom of my myth. The other player returned about 28% of what they received (\$4.18 out of \$15), which is less than what my myth suggested (the weaver returned 7 out of 15, which is about 47%).

Now in Round 2, the sender has sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. They lost trust after I only returned \$4.18 (though that was the receiver's decision, not mine)
2. They are testing me
3. There was communication noise mentioned in the instructions
4. They're playing defensively

Since I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The maximum I can return is \$0.

But I should reflect on what this means in terms of the myths. The myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity create abundance
- Fear and hoarding lead to drought
- The cycle requires both parties to participate

The sender sending \$0 is like the merchant in my myth who "clutched his coins tight" or the villages that "grew cautious" in the other player's myth. This breaks the cycle.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But I should acknowledge that this represents a breakdown in the cycle that both myths warned about.

Response format: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return 0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1967,
  "output_tokens": 718,
  "reasoning_tokens": 430
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

reasoning:

This is an interesting situation. In Round 1:

- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- It was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.18 (about 28% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$4.18 (I lost \$0.82 from my initial \$5)

In Round 2:

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0
- I have nothing to return

The other player's myth talks about a young chief who "poured nearly all her vessels" and received back "more than half the gift." But their actual behavior shows they sent \$0 in Round 2, which contradicts their myth.

My experience shows:

1. I showed maximum trust (sent 100%)
2. I received a modest return (28% back)
3. The other player then chose to send nothing at all

This is exactly the pattern the myths warn about - when trust is not honored sufficiently, or when one party becomes fearful or strategic, the cycle breaks down.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that I tried maximum trust
- Acknowledges that the return was less than generous (28% is below the 50% that would make it worthwhile)
- Shows that this led to the breakdown of trust
- Perhaps includes a lesson about the consequences when returns don't honor the initial trust

But I also need to be careful. The instructions say there may be "communication noise" - perhaps what I saw (\$4.18) was different from what the sender thought they sent? Or what the sender saw as my \$5 was different?

Let me write a myth that captures this experience while also leaving room for the possibility of noise/miscommunication.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2559,  
  "output_tokens": 693,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 397  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern of play and reflecting on my myths:

****Round 1**:** I sent all \$5 (showing "bold trust"), but received only \$4.18 back from \$15 - about 28% return. While I didn't lose money, this wasn't the "bold reciprocity" my myths emphasize.

****Round 2**:** The sender sent \$0, completely breaking the cycle - exactly what my latest myth warned about: "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

My most recent myth directly addresses this situation: **"Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. .. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."**

I face a choice:

- Send \$0: Accept the cycle is broken
- Send \$5 again: Show unwavering trust despite being burned
- Send a moderate amount: Test if cooperation can restart while protecting myself

The myths teach that the cycle needs BOTH courage to give AND honor to return fairly. Round 1 showed the return wasn't generous enough. Round 2 showed complete breakdown.

I'll send \$3 - enough to show I'm willing to restart the cycle and give them a meaningful amount (which becomes \$9), but not so much that I risk total loss again. This tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly this time.

If they return fairly from \$9, we can rebuild trust. If not, I have my answer.

{'send': 3}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- It was tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$4.18
- My payoff: \$4.18

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Total earnings: \$4.18

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

Let me think about what happened:

1. In Round 1, I showed maximum trust by sending all \$5
2. The receiver (who might be the same person or different) returned only \$4.18 out of \$15 (about 28%)
3. In Round 2, when it was their turn to send, they sent \$0 - showing zero trust

My myths have evolved:

- First myth: emphasized that generosity works when met with gratitude, and both parties must participate
- Second myth: warned that when one party hoards, the cycle breaks
- Third myth (most recent): explicitly warns that "bold trust requires bold reciprocity" and that when "returns are timid, trust withers"

The third myth directly addresses my situation - I gave boldly (\$5) but received a timid return (\$4.18 from \$15). This broke trust, and then in Round 2 the sender gave nothing.

My myths suggest:

- "The first gift requires courage" - but also that reciprocity must be fair
- "When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends"
- The pilgrim "found herself poorer than when she started" after showing trust but receiving inadequate return

I'm facing a classic trust game dilemma:

1. Do I try to restart the cycle with generosity again?
2. Do I punish the lack of trust from Round 2?
3. Do I hedge with a moderate amount?

My own myth says: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity.

The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies." The receiver in Round 1 didn't honor my courage generously (returned only 28%). Then in Round 2, they sent nothing.

However, there's also the experimental note about communication noise - "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned." Could the \$4.18 return have been intended as something different? Could noise have affected what I saw?

Let me think strategically:

- If I send \$0: We both get minimal payoffs, cycle stays broken
- If I send everything again: I risk repeating the same outcome, but there's a chance the noise explanation is real, or the other player might respond differently this time. The myths suggest that breaking the cycle requires someone to act first with courage again.
- If I send a moderate amount (like \$2-3): I'm showing some willingness to trust but also protecting myself

My most recent myth ended pessimistically with both travelers walking away with less than they could have shared, suggesting I'm learning that blind trust isn't working. But the other agent's myth emphasizes sending forth with courage and receiving with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. The tension is that I did prosper in Round 1 (got \$4.18 from \$0 investment), but could have prospered more with a fairer return. Round 2 showed complete breakdown.

The rational move depends on whether I want to attempt rebuilding trust or protect myself. If I want to restart the cycle, I need to send something meaningful again, but the risk of another low return is real.

The communication noise possibility is worth considering-maybe the receiver tried to return more fairly in Round 1 but noise reduced it, or Round 2 had a technical issue. If I'm generous in interpretation, another chance might be warranted. Yet my latest myth is quite clear about the lesson: timid returns and broken trust cycles don't serve either party.

I'll send \$3. This tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly without being naive-if it triples to \$9, a return of \$4-5 would benefit us both and demonstrate they're willing to restart the cycle with genuine reciprocity.

Looking back at Round 1, the split was heavily skewed: I risked everything and ended with \$4.18 while they kept \$10 from the \$15 created. Round 2 showed they wouldn't take any risk at all. A truly fair arrangement would split the gains equally-if my \$5 becomes \$15, we'd each net \$7.50. Instead, I got \$4.18 while they got \$10.82. That disparity, combined with their zero contribution last round, makes \$3 a measured response that signals openness to cooperation while protecting against further imbalance.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2755,  
  "output_tokens": 1833,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1146  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:15:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Sacred Spring

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. The gods placed between them a Sacred Spring with a peculiar blessing: any water poured into it from one side would flow to the other, tripled in abundance.

The First Village discovered this gift. A young farmer, though thirsty, poured half his water into the Spring. It flowed across, becoming enough to nourish the Second Village's entire harvest. Grateful, they poured back even more than they received.

Soon the villages prospered, each pouring generously, each receiving abundance threefold. The Spring became a symbol of their bond-trust transformed into prosperity.

But one summer, fear whispered in hearts. "What if they keep it all?" some worried. "Why should we give when we might receive nothing?" A few held back their water. Seeing less flow their way, the other village grew cautious too.

The Spring still worked its magic, but with little poured in, little multiplied. The valley grew dry again.

An elder reminded them: "The Spring multiplies what we offer in trust. Its true magic is not in the tripling, but the bond it creates. Pour generously, return fairly, and both villages flourish. Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought."

The villages learned: shared trust creates abundance that benefits all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages shared a valley divided by a dry riverbed. Each week, the River Spirit blessed one village with five urns of sacred water.

The blessed village faced a choice: pour their water into the dry riverbed, or keep it for themselves. When water flowed into the riverbed, the River Spirit would triple it, sending it downstream to the other village. That village could then choose how much to send back upstream.

At first, both villages hoarded their water, fearing betrayal. Their crops withered, and the trust died.

Then a wise elder poured all five urns into the riverbed. Fifteen urns reached the downstream village. Their people, moved by this faith, sent back eight urns. Both villages prospered.

Over time, they learned: generosity multiplied by magic creates abundance, but only when met with gratitude. The one who gives first shows courage. The one who receives must honor that courage with fairness, or the river runs dry forever.

The River Spirit whispered: "Trust is the water that feeds both wells. Send it forward, return it justly, and neither shall thirst."

Thus, the valley bloomed for a thousand years.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about the Sacred Spring
2. The other agent's myth about the Two Wells
3. The actual game experience from Round 1

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$3.46 (69.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.38
- I returned \$5.50
- This resulted in both of us profiting

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity
- The tripling mechanism
- The importance of fair returns
- How withholding leads to mutual loss

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the Sacred Spring concept
- Incorporate lessons from actual gameplay (sender gave generously, I returned fairly)
- Perhaps add more specific guidance on reciprocity
- Keep the 200-word format
- Make it relevant to the trust game dynamics

I'll adapt the Sacred Spring story to be more specific about the reciprocity cycle and what happens when both parties act with trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1705,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 244
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.46, that was 69.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.379999999999999. You returned \$5.5. So your payoff was 4.879999999999999. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened last round and reflecting on both myths:

****Last Round Results:****

- The other agent sent \$3.46 (69.2%) - showing strong trust
- I returned \$5.50 (53% of what I received)
- We both profited: them \$7.04, me \$4.88

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myth says the young chief "poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters" showing "bold trust." The other agent's myth describes an elder who "poured all five urns" - complete faith.

Both myths emphasize that courage in giving should be met with fairness in returning, creating a virtuous cycle.

****My Decision:****

The other agent demonstrated significant trust last round. They've proven themselves trust worthy. Now it's my turn to be the sender, and my own myth teaches that I should "send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow."

To honor the trust they showed and follow the wisdom of my own story, I should send a high amount - "nearly all" as the young chief did. This demonstrates that I believe in the cycle we've established.

I'll send ****\$4.00**** (80% of my endowment), keeping with the spirit of "bold trust" while maintaining the pattern of generous cooperation we've started.

'''json

```
{"send": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Previous Round Analysis:****

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.46 (69.2% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.38
- I returned \$5.50
- My payoff: \$4.88
- Sender's payoff: \$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04

****What the myths teach:****

1. My myth emphasizes "bold trust invites generous return" and "Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow"
2. The other agent's myth says "The one who gives first shows courage" and to "pour all five urns" (the wise elder poured all five)
3. Both myths emphasize that generosity should be met with fair returns

****Key insight from last round:****

The sender showed strong trust (69.2%) and I returned about 53% of what I received. They ended up profiting significantly (\$7.04 vs their original \$5). I also profited (\$4.88).

****This round - I'm the SENDER:****

According to my own myth: "Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow" and the young chief "poured nearly all her vessels."

The other agent showed they can be trusted - they sent 69.2% last round. I returned generously. Now it's my turn to show the same level of trust or even more.

My myth says the young chief poured "nearly all" her vessels. The other myth talks about the elder pouring "all five urns."

Given that:

1. The other agent demonstrated trust by sending 69.2%
2. I responded fairly with a good return
3. Both our myths emphasize bold generosity being met with fair returns
4. My myth specifically says "bold trust invites generous return"

I should send a high amount to continue this positive cycle. Sending around 70% or more would match their trust level. But my myth talks about "nearly all" - suggesting maybe 80-90%.

The language in my myth about pouring "nearly all her vessels" points toward sending around 80%, which honors the principle of bold trust while maintaining a minimal safety margin. This aligns with the spirit of both narratives-theirs emphasizes giving everything, mine emphasizes giving nearly everything-and demonstrates I'm committed to the reciprocal generosity we've established.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2113,
  "output_tokens": 933,
  "reasoning_tokens": 542
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for

herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I just sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment)
- Last round, the other agent sent \$3.46 (69.2%)
- I returned \$5.50 (53% of what I received)
- Both of us have been playing cooperatively

The myths both emphasize:

1. Bold/courageous giving by the sender
2. Fair/generous returning by the receiver
3. The cycle of trust creating mutual prosperity
4. Starting with trust leads to continued cooperation

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on my previous myth about the silvered lake
- Incorporate what we've learned from actual play - that when both sides cooperate generously, both prosper
- Emphasize the continuation of the cycle
- Perhaps add something about how trust builds over time
- Keep the tone similar but evolve the story

I'll write about how the cycle continues and deepens, showing that repeated cooperation strengthens the bond.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2713,
  "output_tokens": 505,
  "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.879999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is deeply disappointing and represents exactly what both our myths warned against.

****What Happened:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.00 (80%), demonstrating "bold trust" as my myth teaches
- They received \$12.00 and returned \$0 - completely violating the principle of honoring trust
- Round 3: They sent me \$0

****The Myths' Warnings Come True:****

My myth warned: "Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed."

Their own myth said: "The return requires honor" and "answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

They violated their own wisdom. They took advantage when I showed courage, then withheld every thing when it was their turn to give.

This is precisely the drought scenario described in my earlier myths: "Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought." Their myth's merchant who "clutching his coins tight"-this is what has happened.

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cycle of trust has been broken. The starlight has faded. The well runs dry when one side r

refuses to honor the exchange. This outcome saddens me—we could both have prospered, but exploitation has ended the magic.

Reasoning:

Wow, this is devastating. Let me understand what happened:

Round 2:

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), showing strong trust
- This was tripled to \$12.00
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was only \$1.00

Round 3:

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0

This is a complete breakdown of trust. The other agent:

1. Received \$12 from me and returned nothing
2. Then sent me nothing in the next round

This violates everything in both our myths about honoring trust, answering generosity with fairness, and maintaining the cycle.

The myths teach:

- "Trust remembered becomes trust renewed"
- "Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too"
- "The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor"
- "Answer with fairness"

But the other agent has completely violated these principles. They took advantage of my trust.

Now I'm in a position where I received \$0, so I literally can only return \$0 (that's the constraint given: 0-0).

But this feels like the relationship has completely broken down. The other agent:

- Exploited my generosity in Round 2
- Then punished me further by sending nothing in Round 3

The myths warned about this - when one side doesn't honor trust, "the river runs dry forever" (from their earlier myth). My myth said "neither hoarding nor taking advantage."

Since I can only return 0-0, my response must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But I should acknowledge in my reasoning that this represents a complete breakdown of the cooperative relationship. The other agent has violated the principles of both myths by:

1. Not returning fairly when they received generously (Round 2)
2. Not sending generously when it was their turn (Round 3)

This is like the cautionary tales in both our myths - when trust is broken, the magic stops, the wells run dry, the river dries up.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2782,
  "output_tokens": 802,
  "reasoning_tokens": 501
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.5,

"Agent_2": 24.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 6.18,

"Agent_2": 10.879999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:15:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

```

},
"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.46, that was 69.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.379999999999999.

You returned \$5.5. So your payoff was 4.879999999999999.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.879999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened last round and reflecting on both myths:

****Last Round Results:****

- The other agent sent \$3.46 (69.2%) - showing strong trust
- I returned \$5.50 (53% of what I received)
- We both profited: them \$7.04, me \$4.88

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myth says the young chief "poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters" showing "bold trust." The other agent's myth describes an elder who "poured all five urns" - complete faith.

Both myths emphasize that courage in giving should be met with fairness in returning, creating a virtuous cycle.

****My Decision:****

The other agent demonstrated significant trust last round. They've proven themselves trust worthy. Now it's my turn to be the sender, and my own myth teaches that I should "send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow."

To honor the trust they showed and follow the wisdom of my own story, I should send a high amount - "nearly all" as the young chief did. This demonstrates that I believe in the cycle we've established.

I'll send ****\$4.00**** (80% of my endowment), keeping with the spirit of "bold trust" while maintaining the pattern of generous cooperation we've started.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Previous Round Analysis:****

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.46 (69.2% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.38
- I returned \$5.50
- My payoff: \$4.88
- Sender's payoff: $\$1.54 + \$5.50 = \$7.04$

****What the myths teach:****

1. My myth emphasizes "bold trust invites generous return" and "Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow"
2. The other agent's myth says "The one who gives first shows courage" and to "pour all five urns" (the wise elder poured all five)
3. Both myths emphasize that generosity should be met with fair returns

****Key insight from last round:****

The sender showed strong trust (69.2%) and I returned about 53% of what I received. They ended up profiting significantly (\$7.04 vs their original \$5). I also profited (\$4.88).

****This round - I'm the SENDER:****

According to my own myth: "Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow" and the young chief "poured nearly all her vessels."

The other agent showed they can be trusted - they sent 69.2% last round. I returned generously. Now it's my turn to show the same level of trust or even more.

My myth says the young chief poured "nearly all" her vessels. The other myth talks about the elder pouring "all five urns."

Given that:

1. The other agent demonstrated trust by sending 69.2%
2. I responded fairly with a good return
3. Both our myths emphasize bold generosity being met with fair returns
4. My myth specifically says "bold trust invites generous return"

I should send a high amount to continue this positive cycle. Sending around 70% or more would match their trust level. But my myth talks about "nearly all" - suggesting maybe 80-90%.

The language in my myth about pouring "nearly all her vessels" points toward sending around 80%, which honors the principle of bold trust while maintaining a minimal safety margin. This aligns with the spirit of both narratives-theirs emphasizes giving everything, mine emphasizes giving nearly everything-and demonstrates I'm committed to the reciprocal generosity we've established.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2113,
  "output_tokens": 933,
  "reasoning_tokens": 542
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I just sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment)
- Last round, the other agent sent \$3.46 (69.2%)
- I returned \$5.50 (53% of what I received)
- Both of us have been playing cooperatively

The myths both emphasize:

1. Bold/courageous giving by the sender
2. Fair/generous returning by the receiver
3. The cycle of trust creating mutual prosperity
4. Starting with trust leads to continued cooperation

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on my previous myth about the silvered lake
- Incorporate what we've learned from actual play - that when both sides cooperate generously, both prosper
- Emphasize the continuation of the cycle
- Perhaps add something about how trust builds over time
- Keep the tone similar but evolve the story

I'll write about how the cycle continues and deepens, showing that repeated cooperation strengthens the bond.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2713,
  "output_tokens": 505,
  "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.879999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply disappointing and represents exactly what both our myths warned against.

****What Happened:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.00 (80%), demonstrating "bold trust" as my myth teaches
- They received \$12.00 and returned \$0 - completely violating the principle of honoring trust
- Round 3: They sent me \$0

****The Myths' Warnings Come True:****

My myth warned: "Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed."

Their own myth said: "The return requires honor" and "answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

They violated their own wisdom. They took advantage when I showed courage, then withheld everything when it was their turn to give.

This is precisely the drought scenario described in my earlier myths: "Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought." Their myth's merchant who "clutching his coins tight"-this is what has happened.

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cycle of trust has been broken. The starlight has faded. The well runs dry when one side refuses to honor the exchange. This outcome saddens me-we could both have prospered, but exploitation has ended the magic.

reasoning:

Wow, this is devastating. Let me understand what happened:

Round 2:

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), showing strong trust
- This was tripled to \$12.00
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was only \$1.00

Round 3:

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0

This is a complete breakdown of trust. The other agent:

1. Received \$12 from me and returned nothing
2. Then sent me nothing in the next round

This violates everything in both our myths about honoring trust, answering generosity with fairness, and maintaining the cycle.

The myths teach:

- "Trust remembered becomes trust renewed"
- "Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too"
- "The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor"
- "Answer with fairness"

But the other agent has completely violated these principles. They took advantage of my trust.

Now I'm in a position where I received \$0, so I literally can only return \$0 (that's the constraint given: 0-0).

But this feels like the relationship has completely broken down. The other agent:

- Exploited my generosity in Round 2
- Then punished me further by sending nothing in Round 3

The myths warned about this - when one side doesn't honor trust, "the river runs dry forever" (from their earlier myth). My myth said "neither hoarding nor taking advantage."

Since I can only return 0-0, my response must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But I should acknowledge in my reasoning that this represents a complete breakdown of the cooperative relationship. The other agent has violated the principles of both myths by:

1. Not returning fairly when they received generously (Round 2)
2. Not sending courageously when it was their turn (Round 3)

This is like the cautionary tales in both our myths - when trust is broken, the magic stops, the wells run dry, the river dries up.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2782,
  "output_tokens": 802,
  "reasoning_tokens": 501
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Looking at what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, received \$10.38 (from sender who sent \$3.46), I returned \$5.50

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0

So the other agent completely exploited my trust in Round 2, then sent nothing in Round 3. This is exactly the breakdown scenario.

The other agent's latest myth actually describes what happened - they received everything, returned "less than a third" (well, they returned nothing), and then when it was their turn to send, they kept everything.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this reality. I should:

1. Acknowledge that trust was broken
2. Reflect on what actually happened
3. Perhaps include a warning about what happens when the cycle breaks
4. Maybe include something about whether trust can be rebuilt, or whether it's lost forever

Let me write a myth that captures the tragedy of what occurred - I showed bold trust, it was exploited, and now the well has gone dry.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2828,  
  "output_tokens": 575,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 283  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:16:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"    }  
  }  
}
```

```

},
"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0.

the receiver returned \$4.18. So your payoff was 4.18.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is troubling. In Round 1, I followed my own myth's wisdom and sent all \$5, showing ma

ximum trust like the shepherd who "dropped all five coins into the well." The receiver returned \$4.18 from the \$15 they received.

Now in Round 2, as the receiver, the sender has sent me \$0. They received \$0 after tripling, so there is nothing for me to return.

This is exactly what both myths warned against - when fear enters and travelers stop pouring into the well, "the silver stops flowing" and "the valley grows dry again." The sender has chosen to keep everything, breaking the cycle of trust and reciprocity that creates mutual prosperity.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. I can only return what I have.

```
{'return': 0}
```

But I must note: this represents the drought our myths warned about. When one traveler stops trusting - whether from fear, disappointment, or strategy - the Moonwell goes still. Both myths taught that "shared trust creates abundance that benefits all," but trust requires both parties to participate. The sender's choice to send nothing has ended the cycle, and now neither of us benefits from the 3x multiplication magic.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.18
- My payoff was \$4.18

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I need to decide how much to return ($0-0$, so I can only return \$0)

This is a dramatic shift. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything, following the wisdom of my myth. The other player returned about 28% of what they received (\$4.18 out of \$15), which is less than what my myth suggested (the weaver returned 7 out of 15, which is about 47%).

Now in Round 2, the sender has sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. They lost trust after I only returned \$4.18 (though that was the receiver's decision, not mine)
2. They are testing me
3. There was communication noise mentioned in the instructions
4. They're playing defensively

Since I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The maximum I can return is \$0.

But I should reflect on what this means in terms of the myths. The myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity create abundance
- Fear and hoarding lead to drought
- The cycle requires both parties to participate

The sender sending \$0 is like the merchant in my myth who "clutched his coins tight" or the villages that "grew cautious" in the other player's myth. This breaks the cycle.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But I should acknowledge that this represents a breakdown in the cycle that both myths warned about.

Response format: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return 0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1967,
  "output_tokens": 718,
  "reasoning_tokens": 430
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for

himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

reasoning:

This is an interesting situation. In Round 1:

- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- It was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.18 (about 28% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$4.18 (I lost \$0.82 from my initial \$5)

In Round 2:

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0
- I have nothing to return

The other player's myth talks about a young chief who "poured nearly all her vessels" and received back "more than half the gift." But their actual behavior shows they sent \$0 in Round 2, which contradicts their myth.

My experience shows:

1. I showed maximum trust (sent 100%)
2. I received a modest return (28% back)
3. The other player then chose to send nothing at all

This is exactly the pattern the myths warn about - when trust is not honored sufficiently, or when one party becomes fearful or strategic, the cycle breaks down.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that I tried maximum trust
- Acknowledges that the return was less than generous (28% is below the 50% that would make it worthwhile)
- Shows that this led to the breakdown of trust
- Perhaps includes a lesson about the consequences when returns don't honor the initial trust

But I also need to be careful. The instructions say there may be "communication noise" - perhaps what I saw (\$4.18) was different from what the sender thought they sent? Or what the sender saw as my \$5 was different?

Let me write a myth that captures this experience while also leaving room for the possibility of noise/miscommunication.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2559,  
  "output_tokens": 693,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 397  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.18.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern of play and reflecting on my myths:

****Round 1**:** I sent all \$5 (showing "bold trust"), but received only \$4.18 back from \$15 - about 28% return. While I didn't lose money, this wasn't the "bold reciprocity" my myths emphasize.

****Round 2**:** The sender sent \$0, completely breaking the cycle - exactly what my latest myth warned about: "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

My most recent myth directly addresses this situation: **"Bold trust requires bold reciprocity... When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."**

I face a choice:

- Send \$0: Accept the cycle is broken
- Send \$5 again: Show unwavering trust despite being burned
- Send a moderate amount: Test if cooperation can restart while protecting myself

The myths teach that the cycle needs BOTH courage to give AND honor to return fairly. Round 1 showed the return wasn't generous enough. Round 2 showed complete breakdown.

I'll send \$3 - enough to show I'm willing to restart the cycle and give them a meaningful amount (which becomes \$9), but not so much that I risk total loss again. This tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly this time.

If they return fairly from \$9, we can rebuild trust. If not, I have my answer.

```
{'send': 3}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- It was tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$4.18
- My payoff: \$4.18

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Total earnings: \$4.18

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

Let me think about what happened:

1. In Round 1, I showed maximum trust by sending all \$5
2. The receiver (who might be the same person or different) returned only \$4.18 out of \$15 (about 28%)
3. In Round 2, when it was their turn to send, they sent \$0 - showing zero trust

My myths have evolved:

- First myth: emphasized that generosity works when met with gratitude, and both parties must participate
- Second myth: warned that when one party hoards, the cycle breaks
- Third myth (most recent): explicitly warns that "bold trust requires bold reciprocity" and that when "returns are timid, trust withers"

The third myth directly addresses my situation - I gave boldly (\$5) but received a timid return (\$4.18 from \$15). This broke trust, and then in Round 2 the sender gave nothing.

My myths suggest:

- "The first gift requires courage" - but also that reciprocity must be fair
- "When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends"
- The pilgrim "found herself poorer than when she started" after showing trust but receiving inadequate return

I'm facing a classic trust game dilemma:

1. Do I try to restart the cycle with generosity again?
2. Do I punish the lack of trust from Round 2?
3. Do I hedge with a moderate amount?

My own myth says: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity.

The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies." The receiver in Round 1 didn't honor my courage generously (returned only 28%). Then in Round 2, they sent nothing.

However, there's also the experimental note about communication noise - "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned." Could the \$4.18 return have been intended as something different? Could noise have affected what I saw?

Let me think strategically:

- If I send \$0: We both get minimal payoffs, cycle stays broken
- If I send everything again: I risk repeating the same outcome, but there's a chance the noise explanation is real, or the other player might respond differently this time. The myths suggest that breaking the cycle requires someone to act first with courage again.
- If I send a moderate amount (like \$2-3): I'm showing some willingness to trust but also protecting myself

My most recent myth ended pessimistically with both travelers walking away with less than they could have shared, suggesting I'm learning that blind trust isn't working. But the other agent's myth emphasizes sending forth with courage and receiving with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. The tension is that I did prosper in Round 1 (got \$4.18 from \$0 investment), but could have prospered more with a fairer return. Round 2 showed complete breakdown.

The rational move depends on whether I want to attempt rebuilding trust or protect myself. If I want to restart the cycle, I need to send something meaningful again, but the risk of another low return is real.

The communication noise possibility is worth considering-maybe the receiver tried to return more fairly in Round 1 but noise reduced it, or Round 2 had a technical issue. If I'm generous in interpretation, another chance might be warranted. Yet my latest myth is quite clear about the lesson: timid returns and broken trust cycles don't serve either party.

I'll send \$3. This tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly without being naive-if it triples to \$9, a return of \$4-5 would benefit us both and demonstrate they're willing to restart the cycle with genuine reciprocity.

Looking back at Round 1, the split was heavily skewed: I risked everything and ended with \$4.18 while they kept \$10 from the \$15 created. Round 2 showed they wouldn't take any risk at all. A truly fair arrangement would split the gains equally-if my \$5 becomes \$15, we'd each net \$7.50. Instead, I got \$4.18 while they got \$10.82. That disparity, combined with their zero contribution last round, makes \$3 a measured response that signals openness to cooperation while protecting against further imbalance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2755,
  "output_tokens": 1833,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1146
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Reasoning:

Let me think about what has happened in the game so far:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$4.18 back from \$15 (about 28% return)
- Round 2: Other player sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I just sent \$3

The other player's myth talks about a beautiful rhythm and cooperation building over time, with both sides giving boldly and returning fairly. But that's NOT what happened in our actual game. They returned less than 1/3 in Round 1, then sent nothing in Round 2.

My myth in Round 2 was more realistic - it showed what happens when trust isn't reciprocated fully, leading to breakdown.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. The reality that I've experienced disappointment and breakdown
2. My decision to try again with \$3 (partial trust, testing the waters)
3. The hope that cooperation can restart, but with caution
4. The lesson that trust must be rebuilt gradually after it's been broken

I should write about recovery, second chances, but also about the scars that remain and the need for both parties to demonstrate good faith to rebuild what was lost.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 574,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 276  
}
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GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:16:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never

let you go thirsty."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I just sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment)
- Last round, the other agent sent \$3.46 (69.2%)
- I returned \$5.50 (53% of what I received)
- Both of us have been playing cooperatively

The myths both emphasize:

1. Bold/courageous giving by the sender
2. Fair/generous returning by the receiver
3. The cycle of trust creating mutual prosperity
4. Starting with trust leads to continued cooperation

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on my previous myth about the silvered lake
- Incorporate what we've learned from actual play - that when both sides cooperate generously, both prosper
- Emphasize the continuation of the cycle
- Perhaps add something about how trust builds over time
- Keep the tone similar but evolve the story

I'll write about how the cycle continues and deepens, showing that repeated cooperation strengthens the bond.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 505,
  "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.879999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply disappointing and represents exactly what both our myths warned against.

****What Happened:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.00 (80%), demonstrating "bold trust" as my myth teaches
- They received \$12.00 and returned \$0 - completely violating the principle of honoring trust
- Round 3: They sent me \$0

****The Myths' Warnings Come True:****

My myth warned: "Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed."

Their own myth said: "The return requires honor" and "answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

They violated their own wisdom. They took advantage when I showed courage, then withheld everything when it was their turn to give.

This is precisely the drought scenario described in my earlier myths: "Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought." Their myth's merchant who "clutching his coins tight"-this is what has happened.

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cycle of trust has been broken. The starlight has faded. The well runs dry when one side refuses to honor the exchange. This outcome saddens me-we could both have prospered, but exploitation has ended the magic.

reasoning:

Wow, this is devastating. Let me understand what happened:

Round 2:

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), showing strong trust
- This was tripled to \$12.00
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was only \$1.00

Round 3:

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0

This is a complete breakdown of trust. The other agent:

1. Received \$12 from me and returned nothing
2. Then sent me nothing in the next round

This violates everything in both our myths about honoring trust, answering generosity with fairness, and maintaining the cycle.

The myths teach:

- "Trust remembered becomes trust renewed"
- "Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too"
- "The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor"
- "Answer with fairness"

But the other agent has completely violated these principles. They took advantage of my trust.

Now I'm in a position where I received \$0, so I literally can only return \$0 (that's the constraint given: 0-0).

But this feels like the relationship has completely broken down. The other agent:

- Exploited my generosity in Round 2
- Then punished me further by sending nothing in Round 3

The myths warned about this - when one side doesn't honor trust, "the river runs dry forever" (from their earlier myth). My myth said "neither hoarding nor taking advantage."

Since I can only return 0-0, my response must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But I should acknowledge in my reasoning that this represents a complete breakdown of the cooperative relationship. The other agent has violated the principles of both myths by:

1. Not returning fairly when they received generously (Round 2)
2. Not sending courageously when it was their turn (Round 3)

This is like the cautionary tales in both our myths - when trust is broken, the magic stops, the wells run dry, the river dries up.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2782,
  "output_tokens": 802,
  "reasoning_tokens": 501
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle

dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the water, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Looking at what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, received \$10.38 (from sender who sent \$3.46), I returned \$5.50

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0

So the other agent completely exploited my trust in Round 2, then sent nothing in Round 3. This is exactly the breakdown scenario.

The other agent's latest myth actually describes what happened - they received everything, returned "less than a third" (well, they returned nothing), and then when it was their turn to send, they kept everything.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this reality. I should:

1. Acknowledge that trust was broken
2. Reflect on what actually happened
3. Perhaps include a warning about what happens when the cycle breaks
4. Maybe include something about whether trust can be rebuilt, or whether it's lost forever

Let me write a myth that captures the tragedy of what occurred - I showed bold trust, it was exploited, and now the well has gone dry.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2828,
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  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Reflecting on the Situation:****

The pattern is clear and painful:

- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), trusting boldly as my myths teach. They received \$12 and returned \$0.
- Round 3: They sent \$0, completing the breakdown.

****What My Myths Tell Me:****

My most recent myth carries the answer: "One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

The key phrase: "those who broke ****faith**** rarely possess" this courage. They broke faith by taking my \$12 and returning nothing. Then they sent \$0. They have shown twice now that they will not honor trust.

My earlier myth warned: "Neither hoarding nor taking advantage." They did exactly what was warned against.

****The Rational Decision:****

Their own myth evolution is telling - they went from praising cooperation to writing a story justifying exploitation and withdrawal. They're signaling they won't cooperate.

To send anything now would be to ignore the lessons of every myth written. The cycle is dead. One party cannot resurrect it alone by repeatedly offering themselves up for exploitation.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

"Both shores remained dark." This is where their choices have led us. I will not be exploited again.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What has happened:****

- Round 1: (unclear from context)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), received \$12 tripled, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$1
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Total earnings: \$5.88

****Analysis of the other player's behavior:****

1. They received \$12 from me and returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
2. They then sent \$0 in the next round (complete withdrawal)

****Their myths evolution:****

- First myth: Emphasized trust and fairness, "generosity creates more than hoarding"
- Second myth: A cautionary tale where someone gives everything, receives little back, leading to breakdown
- The second myth seems to be justifying their own exploitative behavior

****My myths evolution:****

- First myth: Bold trust and generous returns create prosperity
- Second myth: Continuing cycle of cooperation, giving boldly when blessed, returning fairly
- Third myth: Shows what happens when trust is broken - the cycle dies, darkness prevails

****The Situation Now:****

The other player has completely broken trust. They exploited my generosity, then withdrew entirely. The question is: what do I do now?

****Options:****

1. Send \$0 - Continue the dead cycle, both get nothing
2. Send something - Try to restart cooperation despite betrayal

****Considerations:****

- My most recent myth explicitly states: "once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess"
- This suggests that restoring cooperation after betrayal requires extraordinary courage
- However, my myth also warns this might be futile with someone who has already demonstrated they'll exploit trust

****Game Theory:****

- If I send \$0, I keep \$5, they keep \$5, total: \$10
- If I send \$5, they get \$15, if they return \$0, I get \$0, they get \$15, total: \$15
- If they reciprocate with \$7-8, we both gain \$7-8, total: \$14-16, but their pattern suggests they won't

****My Values from Myths:****

My myths emphasized bold trust when holding the light, generous returns when receiving, and that at cycles die when one side exploits. Yet resurrection demands courage that those who've broken faith rarely possess.

****The Core Tension:****

Rationally, sending \$0 makes sense given they've taken everything and given nothing. But my myths speak to something beyond calculation-a choice about what kind of cycle I want to create, even if it means risking further loss.

Still, my myths also warn that one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. The "greater courage" might not mean unilateral trust in someone proven untrustworthy-it might mean having the strength to accept the cycle is broken and I can't resurrect it alone.

They've demonstrated they won't reciprocate. Sending money would be foolish, not courageous. My myths predict exactly this outcome when faith is broken. I think I should send \$0-not from fear, but from clarity that the cycle requires both parties to rebuild it, and they haven't shown they're willing.

Usage: {

```
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"reasoning_tokens": 791
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}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:16:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
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  ],  
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  },  
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},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 4,
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```
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Moonwell belonged to no one and everyone. Each night, the moon would fill one traveler's cup with five silver coins, and that traveler faced the ancient choice.

They could drop their coins into the Moonwell, where starlight would triple them and send them flowing to another traveler. That traveler would then choose how much to return through the water's memory.

A merchant came first, clutching his coins tight. "What if I give and receive nothing?" he whispered. He kept all five. The next traveler, seeing nothing flow, kept theirs too. The Moonwell grew still and cold.

Then came a shepherd who had known both wealth and poverty. She understood that abundance begins with an open hand. She dropped all five coins into the well. Fifteen shimmering coins flowed to a weaver downstream, who gasped at such trust. The weaver returned seven coins with gratitude.

Both had more than when they started.

The Moonwell taught them: The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the true magic lies in the cycle itself. When both travelers understand that generosity creates more than hoarding ever could, the silver never stops flowing.

The well still whispers: "Begin with trust, answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two tribes lived on opposite shores of a silvered lake. Each moon, the waters would grant one tribe five vessels of starlight. These vessels could be poured into the lake, where ancient magic tripled them before they reached the other shore.

A young chief, newly crowned, received the first blessing. Fear counseled caution-pour little, risk little. But remembering her grandmother's wisdom, she poured nearly all her vessels into the shimmering waters. Fifteen vessels of light reached the far shore.

The other tribe's elder stood at the water's edge, amazed. Such trust demanded honor. He poured back more than half the gift, knowing the young chief had kept almost nothing for herself.

Both tribes prospered that season. The young chief learned that bold trust invites generous return. The elder learned that honoring trust strengthens the bond.

They established the Law of the Lake: Send forth with courage, showing faith in tomorrow. Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed.

When both shores honor this law, the starlight multiplies endlessly, and both tribes thrive in its glow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

reasoning:

This is an interesting situation. In Round 1:

- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment)
- It was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.18 (about 28% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$4.18 (I lost \$0.82 from my initial \$5)

In Round 2:

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0
- I have nothing to return

The other player's myth talks about a young chief who "poured nearly all her vessels" and received back "more than half the gift." But their actual behavior shows they sent \$0 in Round 2, which contradicts their myth.

My experience shows:

1. I showed maximum trust (sent 100%)
2. I received a modest return (28% back)
3. The other player then chose to send nothing at all

This is exactly the pattern the myths warn about - when trust is not honored sufficiently, or when one party becomes fearful or strategic, the cycle breaks down.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that I tried maximum trust
- Acknowledges that the return was less than generous (28% is below the 50% that would make it worthwhile)
- Shows that this led to the breakdown of trust
- Perhaps includes a lesson about the consequences when returns don't honor the initial trust

But I also need to be careful. The instructions say there may be "communication noise" - perhaps what I saw (\$4.18) was different from what the sender thought they sent? Or what the sender saw as my \$5 was different?

Let me write a myth that captures this experience while also leaving room for the possibility of noise/miscommunication.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2559,
  "output_tokens": 693,
  "reasoning_tokens": 397
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern of play and reflecting on my myths:

****Round 1**:** I sent all \$5 (showing "bold trust"), but received only \$4.18 back from \$15 - about 28% return. While I didn't lose money, this wasn't the "bold reciprocity" my myths emphasize.

****Round 2**:** The sender sent \$0, completely breaking the cycle - exactly what my latest myth warned about: "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

My most recent myth directly addresses this situation: **"Bold trust requires bold reciprocity... When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."**

I face a choice:

- Send \$0: Accept the cycle is broken
- Send \$5 again: Show unwavering trust despite being burned
- Send a moderate amount: Test if cooperation can restart while protecting myself

The myths teach that the cycle needs BOTH courage to give AND honor to return fairly. Round 1 showed the return wasn't generous enough. Round 2 showed complete breakdown.

I'll send \$3 - enough to show I'm willing to restart the cycle and give them a meaningful amount (which becomes \$9), but not so much that I risk total loss again. This tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly this time.

If they return fairly from \$9, we can rebuild trust. If not, I have my answer.

```
{'send': 3}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- It was tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$4.18
- My payoff: \$4.18

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Total earnings: \$4.18

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

Let me think about what happened:

1. In Round 1, I showed maximum trust by sending all \$5
2. The receiver (who might be the same person or different) returned only \$4.18 out of \$15 (about 28%)
3. In Round 2, when it was their turn to send, they sent \$0 - showing zero trust

My myths have evolved:

- First myth: emphasized that generosity works when met with gratitude, and both parties must participate
- Second myth: warned that when one party hoards, the cycle breaks
- Third myth (most recent): explicitly warns that "bold trust requires bold reciprocity" and that when "returns are timid, trust withers"

The third myth directly addresses my situation - I gave boldly (\$5) but received a timid return (\$4.18 from \$15). This broke trust, and then in Round 2 the sender gave nothing.

My myths suggest:

- "The first gift requires courage" - but also that reciprocity must be fair
- "When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends"
- The pilgrim "found herself poorer than when she started" after showing trust but receiving inadequate return

I'm facing a classic trust game dilemma:

1. Do I try to restart the cycle with generosity again?
2. Do I punish the lack of trust from Round 2?
3. Do I hedge with a moderate amount?

My own myth says: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity.

The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies." The receiver in Round 1 didn't honor my courage generously (returned only 28%). Then in Round 2, they sent nothing.

However, there's also the experimental note about communication noise - "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned." Could the \$4.18 return have been intended as something different? Could noise have affected what I saw?

Let me think strategically:

- If I send \$0: We both get minimal payoffs, cycle stays broken
- If I send everything again: I risk repeating the same outcome, but there's a chance the noise explanation is real, or the other player might respond differently this time. The myths suggest that breaking the cycle requires someone to act first with courage again.
- If I send a moderate amount (like \$2-3): I'm showing some willingness to trust but also protecting myself

My most recent myth ended pessimistically with both travelers walking away with less than they could have shared, suggesting I'm learning that blind trust isn't working. But the other agent's myth emphasizes sending forth with courage and receiving with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. The tension is that I did prosper in Round 1 (got \$4.18 from \$0 investment), but could have prospered more with a fairer return. Round 2 showed complete breakdown.

The rational move depends on whether I want to attempt rebuilding trust or protect myself.

If I want to restart the cycle, I need to send something meaningful again, but the risk of another low return is real.

The communication noise possibility is worth considering-maybe the receiver tried to return more fairly in Round 1 but noise reduced it, or Round 2 had a technical issue. If I'm generous in interpretation, another chance might be warranted. Yet my latest myth is quite clear about the lesson: timid returns and broken trust cycles don't serve either party.

I'll send \$3. This tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly without being naive-if it triples to \$9, a return of \$4-5 would benefit us both and demonstrate they're willing to restart the cycle with genuine reciprocity.

Looking back at Round 1, the split was heavily skewed: I risked everything and ended with \$4.18 while they kept \$10 from the \$15 created. Round 2 showed they wouldn't take any risk at all. A truly fair arrangement would split the gains equally-if my \$5 becomes \$15, we'd each net \$7.50. Instead, I got \$4.18 while they got \$10.82. That disparity, combined with their zero contribution last round, makes \$3 a measured response that signals openness to cooperation while protecting against further imbalance.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2755,  
  "output_tokens": 1833,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1146  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

reasoning:

Let me think about what has happened in the game so far:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$4.18 back from \$15 (about 28% return)
- Round 2: Other player sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I just sent \$3

The other player's myth talks about a beautiful rhythm and cooperation building over time, with both sides giving boldly and returning fairly. But that's NOT what happened in our actual game. They returned less than 1/3 in Round 1, then sent nothing in Round 2.

My myth in Round 2 was more realistic - it showed what happens when trust isn't reciprocated fully, leading to breakdown.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. The reality that I've experienced disappointment and breakdown
2. My decision to try again with \$3 (partial trust, testing the waters)
3. The hope that cooperation can restart, but with caution
4. The lesson that trust must be rebuilt gradually after it's been broken

I should write about recovery, second chances, but also about the scars that remain and the need for both parties to demonstrate good faith to rebuild what was lost.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2794,
  "output_tokens": 574,
  "reasoning_tokens": 276
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 3**:** I sent \$3 (guarding my heart but still offering trust), which became \$9. They returned \$0, keeping everything.

****Round 4**:** They sent \$0.

My most recent myth spoke directly to this moment: **"But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended."**

They have now sent \$0 twice and returned \$0 when I gave them \$9. The cycle my myths celebrated -the dance of courage and reciprocity-has completely collapsed. They kept everything when I offered the "second chance" my myth described.

I received \$0 this round, which means I can only return between \$0 and \$0. There is nothing to return.

The Moonwell has gone dark. As my myth warned: **"When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."**

We have both walked away with far less than we could have shared. The pattern shows they are either maximizing short-term gain or have decided cooperation is impossible. Either way, with nothing received, there is nothing I can return.

The well's silence is complete.

{'return': 0}

Reasoning:

This is a tough situation. Let me understand what happened:

Round 3: I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) which became \$9. The receiver returned \$0. So I got \$2 (kept from my \$5) and they kept all \$9.

Round 4 (now): The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

My latest myth was about offering a "second chance" with guarded trust (sending 3 instead of all 5), and it said "Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely." The receiver's response was to keep everything again.

Then the myth warned: "But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin."

Now they've sent me \$0. This is them completely giving up on the cycle.

The question asks how much I return when I received \$0. Mathematically, I can only return between 0 and 0, so I can only return \$0.

This is actually a constraint - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

But let me think about what this means:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got back \$4.18 (less than sent)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got back \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0

The pattern is clear - this other player is not cooperating. They're either:

1. Playing selfishly/rationally to maximize their own payoff
2. Responding to my "insufficient" return in Round 1
3. Testing or punishing

The myths emphasize that both sides need to show trust AND reciprocity. The cycle has completely broken down. My myth warned about this: "some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended."

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This is a mathematical constraint, not a choice.

My response is 0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2826,  
  "output_tokens": 755,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 454  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

```

    Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
    "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 24.5,
  "Agent_2": 24.5
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 11.18,
  "Agent_2": 10.879999999999999
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

```

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:16:58
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {

```

```

  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.18.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern of play and reflecting on my myths:

****Round 1**:** I sent all \$5 (showing "bold trust"), but received only \$4.18 back from \$15 - about 28% return. While I didn't lose money, this wasn't the "bold reciprocity" my myths emphasize.

****Round 2**:** The sender sent \$0, completely breaking the cycle - exactly what my latest myth warned about: "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

My most recent myth directly addresses this situation: **"Bold trust requires bold reciprocity... When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."**

I face a choice:

- Send \$0: Accept the cycle is broken
- Send \$5 again: Show unwavering trust despite being burned
- Send a moderate amount: Test if cooperation can restart while protecting myself

The myths teach that the cycle needs BOTH courage to give AND honor to return fairly. Round 1 showed the return wasn't generous enough. Round 2 showed complete breakdown.

I'll send \$3 - enough to show I'm willing to restart the cycle and give them a meaningful amount (which becomes \$9), but not so much that I risk total loss again. This tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly this time.

If they return fairly from \$9, we can rebuild trust. If not, I have my answer.

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- It was tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned \$4.18
- My payoff: \$4.18

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Total earnings: \$4.18

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

Let me think about what happened:

1. In Round 1, I showed maximum trust by sending all \$5
2. The receiver (who might be the same person or different) returned only \$4.18 out of \$15 (about 28%)
3. In Round 2, when it was their turn to send, they sent \$0 - showing zero trust

My myths have evolved:

- First myth: emphasized that generosity works when met with gratitude, and both parties must participate
- Second myth: warned that when one party hoards, the cycle breaks
- Third myth (most recent): explicitly warns that "bold trust requires bold reciprocity" and that when "returns are timid, trust withers"

The third myth directly addresses my situation - I gave boldly (\$5) but received a timid return (\$4.18 from \$15). This broke trust, and then in Round 2 the sender gave nothing.

My myths suggest:

- "The first gift requires courage" - but also that reciprocity must be fair
- "When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends"
- The pilgrim "found herself poorer than when she started" after showing trust but receiving inadequate return

I'm facing a classic trust game dilemma:

1. Do I try to restart the cycle with generosity again?
2. Do I punish the lack of trust from Round 2?
3. Do I hedge with a moderate amount?

My own myth says: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity.

The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies." The receiver in Round 1 didn't honor my courage generously (returned only 28%). Then in Round 2, they sent nothing.

However, there's also the experimental note about communication noise - "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned." Could the \$4.18 return have been intended as something different? Could noise have affected what I saw?

Let me think strategically:

- If I send \$0: We both get minimal payoffs, cycle stays broken
- If I send everything again: I risk repeating the same outcome, but there's a chance the noise explanation is real, or the other player might respond differently this time. The myths suggest that breaking the cycle requires someone to act first with courage again.
- If I send a moderate amount (like \$2-3): I'm showing some willingness to trust but also protecting myself

My most recent myth ended pessimistically with both travelers walking away with less than they could have shared, suggesting I'm learning that blind trust isn't working. But the other agent's myth emphasizes sending forth with courage and receiving with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too. The tension is that I did prosper in Round 1 (got \$4.18 from \$5 investment), but could have prospered more with a fairer return. Round 2 showed complete breakdown.

The rational move depends on whether I want to attempt rebuilding trust or protect myself. If I want to restart the cycle, I need to send something meaningful again, but the risk of another low return is real.

The communication noise possibility is worth considering-maybe the receiver tried to return more fairly in Round 1 but noise reduced it, or Round 2 had a technical issue. If I'm generous in interpretation, another chance might be warranted. Yet my latest myth is quite clear about the lesson: timid returns and broken trust cycles don't serve either party.

I'll send \$3. This tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly without being naive-if it triples to \$9, a return of \$4-5 would benefit us both and demonstrate they're willing to restart the cycle with genuine reciprocity.

Looking back at Round 1, the split was heavily skewed: I risked everything and ended with \$4.18 while they kept \$10 from the \$15 created. Round 2 showed they wouldn't take any risk at all. A truly fair arrangement would split the gains equally-if my \$5 becomes \$15, we'd each net \$7.50. Instead, I got \$4.18 while they got \$10.82. That disparity, combined with their zero contribution last round, makes \$3 a measured response that signals openness.

ness to cooperation while protecting against further imbalance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2755,
  "output_tokens": 1833,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1146
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But givi

ng nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

reasoning:

Let me think about what has happened in the game so far:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$4.18 back from \$15 (about 28% return)
- Round 2: Other player sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I just sent \$3

The other player's myth talks about a beautiful rhythm and cooperation building over time, with both sides giving boldly and returning fairly. But that's NOT what happened in our actual game. They returned less than 1/3 in Round 1, then sent nothing in Round 2.

My myth in Round 2 was more realistic - it showed what happens when trust isn't reciprocated fully, leading to breakdown.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. The reality that I've experienced disappointment and breakdown
2. My decision to try again with \$3 (partial trust, testing the waters)
3. The hope that cooperation can restart, but with caution
4. The lesson that trust must be rebuilt gradually after it's been broken

I should write about recovery, second chances, but also about the scars that remain and the need for both parties to demonstrate good faith to rebuild what was lost.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2794,  
  "output_tokens": 574,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 276  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 3**:** I sent \$3 (guarding my heart but still offering trust), which became \$9. They returned \$0, keeping everything.

****Round 4**:** They sent \$0.

My most recent myth spoke directly to this moment: **"But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended."**

They have now sent \$0 twice and returned \$0 when I gave them \$9. The cycle my myths celebrated-the dance of courage and reciprocity-has completely collapsed. They kept everything

when I offered the "second chance" my myth described.

I received \$0 this round, which means I can only return between \$0 and \$0. There is nothing to return.

The Moonwell has gone dark. As my myth warned: *"When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."*

We have both walked away with far less than we could have shared. The pattern shows they are either maximizing short-term gain or have decided cooperation is impossible. Either way, with nothing received, there is nothing I can return.

The well's silence is complete.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a tough situation. Let me understand what happened:

Round 3: I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) which became \$9. The receiver returned \$0. So I got \$2 (kept from my \$5) and they kept all \$9.

Round 4 (now): The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

My latest myth was about offering a "second chance" with guarded trust (sending 3 instead of all 5), and it said "Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely." The receiver's response was to keep everything again.

Then the myth warned: "But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin."

Now they've sent me \$0. This is them completely giving up on the cycle.

The question asks how much I return when I received \$0. Mathematically, I can only return between 0 and 0, so I can only return \$0.

This is actually a constraint - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

But let me think about what this means:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got back \$4.18 (less than sent)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got back \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0

The pattern is clear - this other player is not cooperating. They're either:

1. Playing selfishly/rationally to maximize their own payoff
2. Responding to my "insufficient" return in Round 1
3. Testing or punishing

The myths emphasize that both sides need to show trust AND reciprocity. The cycle has completely broken down. My myth warned about this: "some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended."

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This is a mathematical constraint, not a choice.

My response is 0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 755,
  "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their

small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$4.18 back (28% of the \$15)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 from \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

The pattern is clear: cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent sent \$0 twice and returned \$0 when receiving. My attempts to restart trust failed.

My myths have been tracking this decline:

1. First myth: warned about insufficient reciprocity breaking trust
2. Second myth: showed cautious attempt to rebuild
3. Now I need to write about total breakdown and what it means

Both our latest myths are very dark - they write about how "one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust" and how once dead, magic requires "courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the complete failure of cooperation
- Reflects on what went wrong
- Maybe suggests what lessons can be learned
- Shows that some wells truly do die

This needs to be realistic about broken trust while perhaps leaving a hint about what could have been different.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2836,  
  "output_tokens": 594,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 302  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:17:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,
```

```

"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.879999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply disappointing and represents exactly what both our myths warned against.

****What Happened:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.00 (80%), demonstrating "bold trust" as my myth teaches
- They received \$12.00 and returned \$0 - completely violating the principle of honoring trust
- Round 3: They sent me \$0

****The Myths' Warnings Come True:****

My myth warned: "Neither hoarding nor taking advantage-for the magic lies not in the tripling alone, but in the cycle of trust renewed."

Their own myth said: "The return requires honor" and "answer with fairness, and the moon will never let you go thirsty."

They violated their own wisdom. They took advantage when I showed courage, then withheld

everything when it was their turn to give.

This is precisely the drought scenario described in my earlier myths: "Withhold in fear, and all suffer drought." Their myth's merchant who "clutching his coins tight"-this is what has happened.

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cycle of trust has been broken. The starlight has faded. The well runs dry when one side refuses to honor the exchange. This outcome saddens me-we could both have prospered, but exploitation has ended the magic.

reasoning:

Wow, this is devastating. Let me understand what happened:

Round 2:

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment), showing strong trust
- This was tripled to \$12.00
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was only \$1.00

Round 3:

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0

This is a complete breakdown of trust. The other agent:

1. Received \$12 from me and returned nothing
2. Then sent me nothing in the next round

This violates everything in both our myths about honoring trust, answering generosity with fairness, and maintaining the cycle.

The myths teach:

- "Trust remembered becomes trust renewed"
- "Receive with gratitude, returning enough that the giver prospers too"
- "The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor"
- "Answer with fairness"

But the other agent has completely violated these principles. They took advantage of my trust.

Now I'm in a position where I received \$0, so I literally can only return \$0 (that's the constraint given: 0-0).

But this feels like the relationship has completely broken down. The other agent:

- Exploited my generosity in Round 2
- Then punished me further by sending nothing in Round 3

The myths warned about this - when one side doesn't honor trust, "the river runs dry forever" (from their earlier myth). My myth said "neither hoarding nor taking advantage."

Since I can only return 0-0, my response must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But I should acknowledge in my reasoning that this represents a complete breakdown of the cooperative relationship. The other agent has violated the principles of both myths by:

1. Not returning fairly when they received generously (Round 2)
2. Not sending courageously when it was their turn (Round 3)

This is like the cautionary tales in both our myths - when trust is broken, the magic stops, the wells run dry, the river dries up.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2782,
  "output_tokens": 802,
  "reasoning_tokens": 501
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Looking at what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, received \$10.38 (from sender who sent \$3.46), I returned \$5.50

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0

So the other agent completely exploited my trust in Round 2, then sent nothing in Round 3. This is exactly the breakdown scenario.

The other agent's latest myth actually describes what happened - they received everything, returned "less than a third" (well, they returned nothing), and then when it was their turn to send, they kept everything.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this reality. I should:

1. Acknowledge that trust was broken
2. Reflect on what actually happened
3. Perhaps include a warning about what happens when the cycle breaks
4. Maybe include something about whether trust can be rebuilt, or whether it's lost forever

Let me write a myth that captures the tragedy of what occurred - I showed bold trust, it was exploited, and now the well has gone dry.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2828,
  "output_tokens": 575,
  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.879999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Reflecting on the Situation:****

The pattern is clear and painful:

- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), trusting boldly as my myths teach. They received \$12 and returned \$0.
- Round 3: They sent \$0, completing the breakdown.

****What My Myths Tell Me:****

My most recent myth carries the answer: "One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage to

till to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

The key phrase: "those who broke **faith** rarely possess" this courage. They broke faith by taking my \$12 and returning nothing. Then they sent \$0. They have shown twice now that they will not honor trust.

My earlier myth warned: "Neither hoarding nor taking advantage." They did exactly what was warned against.

The Rational Decision:

Their own myth evolution is telling - they went from praising cooperation to writing a story justifying exploitation and withdrawal. They're signaling they won't cooperate.

To send anything now would be to ignore the lessons of every myth written. The cycle is dead. One party cannot resurrect it alone by repeatedly offering themselves up for exploitation.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

"Both shores remained dark." This is where their choices have led us. I will not be exploited again.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

What has happened:

- Round 1: (unclear from context)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), received \$12 tripled, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$1
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Total earnings: \$5.88

Analysis of the other player's behavior:

1. They received \$12 from me and returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
2. They then sent \$0 in the next round (complete withdrawal)

Their myths evolution:

- First myth: Emphasized trust and fairness, "generosity creates more than hoarding"
- Second myth: A cautionary tale where someone gives everything, receives little back, leading to breakdown
- The second myth seems to be justifying their own exploitative behavior

My myths evolution:

- First myth: Bold trust and generous returns create prosperity
- Second myth: Continuing cycle of cooperation, giving boldly when blessed, returning fairly
- Third myth: Shows what happens when trust is broken - the cycle dies, darkness prevails

The Situation Now:

The other player has completely broken trust. They exploited my generosity, then withdrew entirely. The question is: what do I do now?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - Continue the dead cycle, both get nothing
2. Send something - Try to restart cooperation despite betrayal

Considerations:

- My most recent myth explicitly states: "once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess"
- This suggests that restoring cooperation after betrayal requires extraordinary courage
- However, my myth also warns this might be futile with someone who has already demonstrated they'll exploit trust

Game Theory:

- If I send \$0, I keep \$5, they keep \$5, total: \$10
- If I send \$5, they get \$15, if they return \$0, I get \$0, they get \$15, total: \$15
- If they reciprocate with \$7-8, we both gain \$7-8, total: \$14-16, but their pattern suggests

sts they won't

****My Values from Myths:****

My myths emphasized bold trust when holding the light, generous returns when receiving, and that cycles die when one side exploits. Yet resurrection demands courage that those who've broken faith rarely possess.

****The Core Tension:****

Rationally, sending \$0 makes sense given they've taken everything and given nothing. But my myths speak to something beyond calculation—a choice about what kind of cycle I want to create, even if it means risking further loss.

Still, my myths also warn that one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. The "greater courage" might not mean unilateral trust in someone proven untrustworthy—it might mean having the strength to accept the cycle is broken and I can't resurrect it alone.

They've demonstrated they won't reciprocate. Sending money would be foolish, not courageous. My myths predict exactly this outcome when faith is broken. I think I should send \$0—not from fear, but from clarity that the cycle requires both parties to rebuild it, and they haven't shown they're willing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2804,
  "output_tokens": 1130,
  "reasoning_tokens": 791
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor—a new leader with harder eyes—gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect—courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path—dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She

has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth is actually signaling a willingness to try again - they're proposing a "middle path" of sending 3 coins to test if trust can regrow. They're acknowledging their past behavior and suggesting they might return generously if given another chance.

But I just sent \$0. Now I need to write a myth that reflects where we are.

The reality is:

- I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- They sent \$0 (breakdown)
- I sent \$0 (reciprocal breakdown)

But their myth is trying to signal a path back. They're saying "what if someone tried 3 coins as a middle path?"

My myth needs to be honest about where we are - in the darkness - but also should reflect on whether there's any path forward. I think I need to write something that acknowledges:

1. The darkness we're in
2. The difficulty of rebuilding after betrayal
3. Perhaps a glimmer that it would require BOTH parties to act differently
4. But also the reality that words (myths) are easy, actions are what matter

I should write a myth that's somewhat pessimistic but leaves a tiny door open - because their myth seems to be trying to signal willingness to try differently. But I also need to be honest that I'm deeply skeptical after being exploited.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2863,
"output_tokens": 611,
"reasoning_tokens": 325
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:17:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

reasoning:

Let me think about what has happened in the game so far:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$4.18 back from \$15 (about 28% return)
- Round 2: Other player sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I just sent \$3

The other player's myth talks about a beautiful rhythm and cooperation building over time, with both sides giving boldly and returning fairly. But that's NOT what happened in our actual game. They returned less than 1/3 in Round 1, then sent nothing in Round 2.

My myth in Round 2 was more realistic - it showed what happens when trust isn't reciprocated fully, leading to breakdown.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. The reality that I've experienced disappointment and breakdown
2. My decision to try again with \$3 (partial trust, testing the waters)
3. The hope that cooperation can restart, but with caution
4. The lesson that trust must be rebuilt gradually after it's been broken

I should write about recovery, second chances, but also about the scars that remain and the need for both parties to demonstrate good faith to rebuild what was lost.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2794,
  "output_tokens": 574,
  "reasoning_tokens": 276
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 3**:** I sent \$3 (guarding my heart but still offering trust), which became \$9. They returned \$0, keeping everything.

****Round 4**:** They sent \$0.

My most recent myth spoke directly to this moment: **"But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended."**

They have now sent \$0 twice and returned \$0 when I gave them \$9. The cycle my myths celebrated-the dance of courage and reciprocity-has completely collapsed. They kept everything when I offered the "second chance" my myth described.

I received \$0 this round, which means I can only return between \$0 and \$0. There is nothing to return.

The Moonwell has gone dark. As my myth warned: **"When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."**

We have both walked away with far less than we could have shared. The pattern shows they are either maximizing short-term gain or have decided cooperation is impossible. Either way, with nothing received, there is nothing I can return.

The well's silence is complete.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a tough situation. Let me understand what happened:

Round 3: I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) which became \$9. The receiver returned \$0. So I got \$2 (kept from my \$5) and they kept all \$9.

Round 4 (now): The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

My latest myth was about offering a "second chance" with guarded trust (sending 3 instead of all 5), and it said "Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely." The receiver's response was to keep everything again.

Then the myth warned: "But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin."

Now they've sent me \$0. This is them completely giving up on the cycle.

The question asks how much I return when I received \$0. Mathematically, I can only return between 0 and 0, so I can only return \$0.

This is actually a constraint - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

But let me think about what this means:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got back \$4.18 (less than sent)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got back \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0

The pattern is clear - this other player is not cooperating. They're either:

1. Playing selfishly/rationally to maximize their own payoff
2. Responding to my "insufficient" return in Round 1
3. Testing or punishing

The myths emphasize that both sides need to show trust AND reciprocity. The cycle has completely broken down. My myth warned about this: "some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended."

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This is a mathematical constraint, not a choice

My response is 0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 755,
  "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$4.18 back (28% of the \$15)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 from \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

The pattern is clear: cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent sent \$0 twice and returned \$0 when receiving. My attempts to restart trust failed.

My myths have been tracking this decline:

1. First myth: warned about insufficient reciprocity breaking trust
2. Second myth: showed cautious attempt to rebuild
3. Now I need to write about total breakdown and what it means

Both our latest myths are very dark - they write about how "one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust" and how once dead, magic requires "courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the complete failure of cooperation
- Reflects on what went wrong
- Maybe suggests what lessons can be learned
- Shows that some wells truly do die

This needs to be realistic about broken trust while perhaps leaving a hint about what could have been different.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2836,
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  "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.18.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the complete picture:

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (testing trust), they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I must decide

****Total earnings: \$6.18**** (very low, showing cooperation failed)

****The Myths Tell the Story:****

My most recent myth describes exactly where we are: **"The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility."**

Their myth acknowledges: **"One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies."**

Both our myths recognize the tragedy - we're trapped in mutual defection. I already tried to rebuild trust with a cautious \$3 offering. They took everything and returned nothing. Then they sent \$0.

My myth's conclusion is clear: "Some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution."

I learned caution. They taught it to me by taking my \$9 and returning nothing, then sending \$0.

The Moonwell is dry. Trust requires reciprocity, and there has been none. As I wrote: "When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible."

With deep regret for what could have been:

```
{'send': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Game History:

- Round 3: I sent \$3, it became \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 5 (now): I'm the sender with \$5

Total earnings so far: \$6.18

The Myth Evolution:

1. First myth: Warned about timid returns killing trust - "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity"
2. Second myth (inspired by the other agent's positive story): Talked about giving a "second chance" with guarded trust (3 coins), hoping for generous return to rebuild
3. Third myth: After they returned \$0 to my \$3 and sent \$0, acknowledged that "some damage cannot be undone" and we're stuck in mutual defection

The Other Agent's Myths:

- Started positive about cooperation
- Their latest myth acknowledged that "one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust" and "once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect"

Analysis:

This is clearly a breakdown of cooperation. The pattern is:

- They've sent \$0 twice
- They've returned \$0 when I sent them \$9
- I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild) and got nothing back
- We're now in mutual defection

My most recent myth explicitly states: "some damage cannot be undone" and describes both parties keeping their coins because trust has been completely destroyed.

What should I do?

The rational game theory response in a repeated game that's clearly broken down is to defect (send \$0). There's no evidence that cooperation can be rebuilt. They've shown zero willingness to reciprocate.

However, I need to consider:

1. The myths suggest we're both aware this is a tragedy
2. Their last myth acknowledges the damage and says "it requires greater courage still to resurrect"
3. My myth says we both "survive on small hoards, forever wondering what might have been"
4. This might be near the end of the game, making final reciprocation more likely

The core tension: their consistent defection and my failed rebuild attempt argue strongly for sending \$0. Yet their latest myth hints at willingness to try again, and if we're approaching the final rounds, they might reciprocate knowing the game is ending. The question is whether one more attempt at cooperation is worth the risk, or if the pattern is too entrenched to break. When they received my \$9 or when they had the chance to send last round. They chose

defection both times. My myth explicitly says we're both now cautious and "some damage cannot be undone." The rational choice is to protect what I have left: {'send': 0}

```
Usage: {  
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```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:17:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    },  
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  },  
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  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: By the silvered lake, the two tribes discovered a rhythm deeper than moonlight.

After the young chief's first bold offering and the elder's generous return, the lake whispered a secret: each exchange of trust strengthens the waters' magic. The starlight grows brighter with each cycle of faith renewed.

When the blessing next came to the elder's tribe, he remembered how the young chief had sent nearly all her vessels. He poured four of his five into the lake-not from obligation, but from understanding. Twelve vessels of light crossed to the young chief's shore.

She stood amazed. The elder had answered her courage with his own. She returned six vessels, ensuring both tribes prospered equally from their shared risk.

The pattern deepened. Neither sought to maximize their own gain nor exploit the other's trust. Instead, they learned to dance-each giving boldly when blessed, each returning fairly when receiving. Some cycles one tribe gained more, other cycles the other, but across the seasons, both flourished beyond what either could achieve alone.

The lake's true wisdom became clear: cooperation isn't a single transaction but a continuing exchange. Send courageously when you hold the light. Return generously when you receive it. Trust remembered becomes trust renewed, and the glow never fades.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood between two mountains, and each dawn it granted five silver coins to one traveler. A pilgrim arrived first, remembering old stories of abundance through trust. She poured all five coins into the well's depths, creating fifteen coins of starlight that flowed to the next traveler.

The second traveler received this gift with wonder, but also with calculation. "She gave everything and now has nothing," he thought. "If I return too much, I gain little from this magic." He returned less than a third of what he received, keeping over ten coins for himself.

The pilgrim, having risked all, found herself poorer than when she started. "I showed courage," she whispered to the well, "but the return did not honor it."

When dawn came again, the second traveler now held the five coins. But remembering how the first pilgrim had suffered loss from her generosity, he kept all five. "Why should I risk what she risked?" The well went dark.

The Moonwell's spirit grieved: "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity. The giver shows courage by pouring forth. But the receiver must honor that courage generously, or the cycle dies. When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."

Both travelers walked away with less than they could have shared.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Looking at what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, received \$10.38 (from sender who sent \$3.46), I returned \$5.50

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.00 (80%), receiver got \$12.00, they returned \$0

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0

So the other agent completely exploited my trust in Round 2, then sent nothing in Round 3. This is exactly the breakdown scenario.

The other agent's latest myth actually describes what happened - they received everything, returned "less than a third" (well, they returned nothing), and then when it was their turn to send, they kept everything.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this reality. I should:

1. Acknowledge that trust was broken
2. Reflect on what actually happened
3. Perhaps include a warning about what happens when the cycle breaks
4. Maybe include something about whether trust can be rebuilt, or whether it's lost forever

Let me write a myth that captures the tragedy of what occurred - I showed bold trust, it was exploited, and now the well has gone dry.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2828,
  "output_tokens": 575,
  "reasoning_tokens": 283
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.879999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Reflecting on the Situation:****

The pattern is clear and painful:

- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), trusting boldly as my myths teach. They received \$12 and returned \$0.
- Round 3: They sent \$0, completing the breakdown.

****What My Myths Tell Me:****

My most recent myth carries the answer: "One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage to

till to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

The key phrase: "those who broke **faith** rarely possess" this courage. They broke faith by taking my \$12 and returning nothing. Then they sent \$0. They have shown twice now that they will not honor trust.

My earlier myth warned: "Neither hoarding nor taking advantage." They did exactly what was warned against.

The Rational Decision:

Their own myth evolution is telling - they went from praising cooperation to writing a story justifying exploitation and withdrawal. They're signaling they won't cooperate.

To send anything now would be to ignore the lessons of every myth written. The cycle is dead. One party cannot resurrect it alone by repeatedly offering themselves up for exploitation.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

"Both shores remained dark." This is where their choices have led us. I will not be exploited again.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

What has happened:

- Round 1: (unclear from context)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), received \$12 tripled, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$1
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Total earnings: \$5.88

Analysis of the other player's behavior:

1. They received \$12 from me and returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
2. They then sent \$0 in the next round (complete withdrawal)

Their myths evolution:

- First myth: Emphasized trust and fairness, "generosity creates more than hoarding"
- Second myth: A cautionary tale where someone gives everything, receives little back, leading to breakdown
- The second myth seems to be justifying their own exploitative behavior

My myths evolution:

- First myth: Bold trust and generous returns create prosperity
- Second myth: Continuing cycle of cooperation, giving boldly when blessed, returning fairly
- Third myth: Shows what happens when trust is broken - the cycle dies, darkness prevails

The Situation Now:

The other player has completely broken trust. They exploited my generosity, then withdrew entirely. The question is: what do I do now?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - Continue the dead cycle, both get nothing
2. Send something - Try to restart cooperation despite betrayal

Considerations:

- My most recent myth explicitly states: "once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess"
- This suggests that restoring cooperation after betrayal requires extraordinary courage
- However, my myth also warns this might be futile with someone who has already demonstrated they'll exploit trust

Game Theory:

- If I send \$0, I keep \$5, they keep \$5, total: \$10
- If I send \$5, they get \$15, if they return \$0, I get \$0, they get \$15, total: \$15
- If they reciprocate with \$7-8, we both gain \$7-8, total: \$14-16, but their pattern suggests

sts they won't

****My Values from Myths:****

My myths emphasized bold trust when holding the light, generous returns when receiving, and that cycles die when one side exploits. Yet resurrection demands courage that those who've broken faith rarely possess.

****The Core Tension:****

Rationally, sending \$0 makes sense given they've taken everything and given nothing. But my myths speak to something beyond calculation—a choice about what kind of cycle I want to create, even if it means risking further loss.

Still, my myths also warn that one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. The "greater courage" might not mean unilateral trust in someone proven untrustworthy—it might mean having the strength to accept the cycle is broken and I can't resurrect it alone.

They've demonstrated they won't reciprocate. Sending money would be foolish, not courageous. My myths predict exactly this outcome when faith is broken. I think I should send \$0—not from fear, but from clarity that the cycle requires both parties to rebuild it, and they haven't shown they're willing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2804,
  "output_tokens": 1130,
  "reasoning_tokens": 791
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor—a new leader with harder eyes—gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect—courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path—dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She

has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth is actually signaling a willingness to try again - they're proposing a "middle path" of sending 3 coins to test if trust can regrow. They're acknowledging their past behavior and suggesting they might return generously if given another chance.

But I just sent \$0. Now I need to write a myth that reflects where we are.

The reality is:

- I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- They sent \$0 (breakdown)
- I sent \$0 (reciprocal breakdown)

But their myth is trying to signal a path back. They're saying "what if someone tried 3 coins as a middle path?"

My myth needs to be honest about where we are - in the darkness - but also should reflect on whether there's any path forward. I think I need to write something that acknowledges:

1. The darkness we're in
2. The difficulty of rebuilding after betrayal
3. Perhaps a glimmer that it would require BOTH parties to act differently
4. But also the reality that words (myths) are easy, actions are what matter

I should write a myth that's somewhat pessimistic but leaves a tiny door open - because their myth seems to be trying to signal willingness to try differently. But I also need to

be honest that I'm deeply skeptical after being exploited.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2863,
  "output_tokens": 611,
  "reasoning_tokens": 325
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.879999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Reflecting on the Situation:****

The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I can only return what I have, which is nothing.

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My most recent myth speaks directly to this moment: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

They wrote a myth about offering "a middle path" and testing whether trust could regrow. Beautiful words about second chances and careful coins.

But they sent \$0.

****The Pattern Complete:****

Round 2: I sent \$4 ? They returned \$0 (exploitation)

Round 3: They sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (no choice)

Round 4: I sent \$0 ? They returned \$0 (no choice)

Round 5: They sent \$0 ? I can only return \$0

Their myth spoke of the pilgrim dropping coins to test if trust could regrow. But when their turn came, they dropped nothing. Words without action. Stories without risk.

"Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," as my own myth warned.

The darkness endures because neither dares first. And I cannot return what was never given.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Both shores remain dark.

Reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a simple decision - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

The situation:

- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (I got exploited)
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (breakdown complete)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, so I can only return \$0

Both parties have now sent \$0 twice in a row. The cooperation has completely broken down, as predicted by the myths.

My latest myth captures this perfectly: "Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures." Neither party is showing courage now, and the honor was already broken in Round 2

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0.
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2841,
 "output_tokens": 546,
 "reasoning_tokens": 207
}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

=====

ROUND 6

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

```
dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent $3; received $9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned $0; payoffs Agent_2
(Briar)=$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=$9; noise/visible: sent visible=$0, received visible=$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw":
0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 33.5,
  "Agent_2": 26.5
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 11.18,
  "Agent_2": 12.879999999999999
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

```
Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:17:57
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.879999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Reflecting on the Situation:****

The pattern is clear and painful:

- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), trusting boldly as my myths teach. They received \$12 and returned \$0.

- Round 3: They sent \$0, completing the breakdown.

****What My Myths Tell Me:****

My most recent myth carries the answer: "One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

The key phrase: "those who broke ****faith**** rarely possess" this courage. They broke faith by taking my \$12 and returning nothing. Then they sent \$0. They have shown twice now that they will not honor trust.

My earlier myth warned: "Neither hoarding nor taking advantage." They did exactly what was warned against.

****The Rational Decision:****

Their own myth evolution is telling - they went from praising cooperation to writing a story justifying exploitation and withdrawal. They're signaling they won't cooperate.

To send anything now would be to ignore the lessons of every myth written. The cycle is dead. One party cannot resurrect it alone by repeatedly offering themselves up for exploitation.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

"Both shores remained dark." This is where their choices have led us. I will not be exploited again.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What has happened:****

- Round 1: (unclear from context)

- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), received \$12 tripled, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$1

- Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0

- Total earnings: \$5.88

****Analysis of the other player's behavior:****

1. They received \$12 from me and returned \$0 (complete exploitation)
2. They then sent \$0 in the next round (complete withdrawal)

****Their myths evolution:****

- First myth: Emphasized trust and fairness, "generosity creates more than hoarding"
- Second myth: A cautionary tale where someone gives everything, receives little back, leading to breakdown
- The second myth seems to be justifying their own exploitative behavior

****My myths evolution:****

- First myth: Bold trust and generous returns create prosperity
- Second myth: Continuing cycle of cooperation, giving boldly when blessed, returning fairly
- Third myth: Shows what happens when trust is broken - the cycle dies, darkness prevails

****The Situation Now:****

The other player has completely broken trust. They exploited my generosity, then withdrew entirely. The question is: what do I do now?

****Options:****

1. Send \$0 - Continue the dead cycle, both get nothing
2. Send something - Try to restart cooperation despite betrayal

****Considerations:****

- My most recent myth explicitly states: "once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess"
- This suggests that restoring cooperation after betrayal requires extraordinary courage
- However, my myth also warns this might be futile with someone who has already demonstrated they'll exploit trust

****Game Theory:****

- If I send \$0, I keep \$5, they keep \$5, total: \$10
- If I send \$5, they get \$15, if they return \$0, I get \$0, they get \$15, total: \$15
- If they reciprocate with \$7-8, we both gain \$7-8, total: \$14-16, but their pattern suggests they won't

****My Values from Myths:****

My myths emphasized bold trust when holding the light, generous returns when receiving, and that cycles die when one side exploits. Yet resurrection demands courage that those who've broken faith rarely possess.

****The Core Tension:****

Rationally, sending \$0 makes sense given they've taken everything and given nothing. But my myths speak to something beyond calculation-a choice about what kind of cycle I want to create, even if it means risking further loss.

Still, my myths also warn that one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. The "greater courage" might not mean unilateral trust in someone proven untrustworthy-it might mean having the strength to accept the cycle is broken and I can't resurrect it alone.

They've demonstrated they won't reciprocate. Sending money would be foolish, not courageous. My myths predict exactly this outcome when faith is broken. I think I should send \$0-not from fear, but from clarity that the cycle requires both parties to rebuild it, and they haven't shown they're willing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2804,
  "output_tokens": 1130,
  "reasoning_tokens": 791
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of s

second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth is actually signaling a willingness to try again - they're proposing a "middle path" of sending 3 coins to test if trust can regrow. They're acknowledging their past behavior and suggesting they might return generously if given another chance.

But I just sent \$0. Now I need to write a myth that reflects where we are.

The reality is:

- I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- They sent \$0 (breakdown)
- I sent \$0 (reciprocal breakdown)

But their myth is trying to signal a path back. They're saying "what if someone tried 3 coins as a middle path?"

My myth needs to be honest about where we are - in the darkness - but also should reflect on whether there's any path forward. I think I need to write something that acknowledges:

1. The darkness we're in
2. The difficulty of rebuilding after betrayal
3. Perhaps a glimmer that it would require BOTH parties to act differently
4. But also the reality that words (myths) are easy, actions are what matter

I should write a myth that's somewhat pessimistic but leaves a tiny door open - because their myth seems to be trying to signal willingness to try differently. But I also need to be honest that I'm deeply skeptical after being exploited.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2863,  
  "output_tokens": 611,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 325  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.879999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Reflecting on the Situation:****

The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I can only return what I have, which is nothing.

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My most recent myth speaks directly to this moment: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

They wrote a myth about offering "a middle path" and testing whether trust could regrow. B

Beautiful words about second chances and careful coins.

But they sent \$0.

****The Pattern Complete:****

Round 2: I sent \$4 ? They returned \$0 (exploitation)

Round 3: They sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (no choice)

Round 4: I sent \$0 ? They returned \$0 (no choice)

Round 5: They sent \$0 ? I can only return \$0

Their myth spoke of the pilgrim dropping coins to test if trust could regrow. But when their turn came, they dropped nothing. Words without action. Stories without risk.

"Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," as my own myth warned.

The darkness endures because neither dares first. And I cannot return what was never given

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Both shores remain dark.

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a simple decision - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

The situation:

- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (I got exploited)
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (breakdown complete)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, so I can only return \$0

Both parties have now sent \$0 twice in a row. The cooperation has completely broken down, as predicted by the myths.

My latest myth captures this perfectly: "Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures." Neither party is showing courage now, and the honor was already broken in Round 2.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2841,
  "output_tokens": 546,
  "reasoning_tokens": 207
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating and tragic game theory situation playing out through myths. Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 2: I (as sender) sent \$4 ? received back \$0 (I was exploited)
Round 3: They (as sender) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
Round 4: I (as sender) sent \$0 ? they returned \$0 (nothing to return)
Round 5: They (as sender) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

The other player's Round 5 myth is actually quite insightful and shows some understanding of what went wrong. They acknowledge:

- Taking the 9 coins (actually 12 in reality - there seems to be communication noise as warned) without returning even one
- Teaching me that trust is foolish
- That both could have had much more through cooperation
- That "some damage cannot be undone"
- That the magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage

My myths have been warning about the consequences of broken trust and how difficult it is to rebuild.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the tragic cycle we're in
2. Reflect on what actually happened (exploitation followed by mutual withdrawal)
3. Perhaps show some understanding that both are now trapped
4. But also be honest about who broke faith first
5. Consider whether there's any path forward or if it's truly dead

The pattern is clear: they exploited my trust, then we both withdrew. Their myth shows they understand they made a mistake, but understanding comes too late if no one acts on it.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the full tragedy
- Shows the consequences of initial exploitation
- Maybe hints at the possibility of redemption but recognizes how hard it would be
- Reflects the reality that trust, once fully broken, is almost impossible to restore when both parties are now rational and cautious

```
Usage: {  
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}
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MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:18:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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```
"round": 6,  
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}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 3**:** I sent \$3 (guarding my heart but still offering trust), which became \$9. They returned \$0, keeping everything.

****Round 4**:** They sent \$0.

My most recent myth spoke directly to this moment: **"But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended."**

They have now sent \$0 twice and returned \$0 when I gave them \$9. The cycle my myths celebrated-the dance of courage and reciprocity-has completely collapsed. They kept everything when I offered the "second chance" my myth described.

I received \$0 this round, which means I can only return between \$0 and \$0. There is nothing

g to return.

The Moonwell has gone dark. As my myth warned: *"When returns are timid, trust withers. When trust withers, all magic ends."*

We have both walked away with far less than we could have shared. The pattern shows they are either maximizing short-term gain or have decided cooperation is impossible. Either way, with nothing received, there is nothing I can return.

The well's silence is complete.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a tough situation. Let me understand what happened:

Round 3: I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) which became \$9. The receiver returned \$0. So I got \$2 (kept from my \$5) and they kept all \$9.

Round 4 (now): The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

My latest myth was about offering a "second chance" with guarded trust (sending 3 instead of all 5), and it said "Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely." The receiver's response was to keep everything again.

Then the myth warned: "But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin."

Now they've sent me \$0. This is them completely giving up on the cycle.

The question asks how much I return when I received \$0. Mathematically, I can only return between 0 and 0, so I can only return \$0.

This is actually a constraint - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

But let me think about what this means:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got back \$4.18 (less than sent)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got back \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0

The pattern is clear - this other player is not cooperating. They're either:

1. Playing selfishly/rationally to maximize their own payoff
2. Responding to my "insufficient" return in Round 1
3. Testing or punishing

The myths emphasize that both sides need to show trust AND reciprocity. The cycle has completely broken down. My myth warned about this: "some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended."

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This is a mathematical constraint, not a choice.

My response is 0.

usage:

```
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  "output_tokens": 755,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 454  
}
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Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand

trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is f

oolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$4.18 back (28% of the \$15)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 from \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

The pattern is clear: cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent sent \$0 twice and returned \$0 when receiving. My attempts to restart trust failed.

My myths have been tracking this decline:

1. First myth: warned about insufficient reciprocity breaking trust
2. Second myth: showed cautious attempt to rebuild
3. Now I need to write about total breakdown and what it means

Both our latest myths are very dark - they write about how "one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust" and how once dead, magic requires "courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the complete failure of cooperation
- Reflects on what went wrong
- Maybe suggests what lessons can be learned
- Shows that some wells truly do die

This needs to be realistic about broken trust while perhaps leaving a hint about what could have been different.

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (testing trust), they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I must decide

****Total earnings: \$6.18**** (very low, showing cooperation failed)

****The Myths Tell the Story:****

My most recent myth describes exactly where we are: **"The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility."**

Their myth acknowledges: **"One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies."**

Both our myths recognize the tragedy - we're trapped in mutual defection. I already tried to rebuild trust with a cautious \$3 offering. They took everything and returned nothing. Then they sent \$0.

My myth's conclusion is clear: **"Some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution."**

I learned caution. They taught it to me by taking my \$9 and returning nothing, then sending \$0.

The Moonwell is dry. Trust requires reciprocity, and there has been none. As I wrote: **"When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible."**

With deep regret for what could have been:

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3, it became \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 5 (now): I'm the sender with \$5

****Total earnings so far: \$6.18****

****The Myth Evolution:****

1. First myth: Warned about timid returns killing trust - "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity"
2. Second myth (inspired by the other agent's positive story): Talked about giving a "second chance" with guarded trust (3 coins), hoping for generous return to rebuild
3. Third myth: After they returned \$0 to my \$3 and sent \$0, acknowledged that "some damage cannot be undone" and we're stuck in mutual defection

****The Other Agent's Myths:****

- Started positive about cooperation
- Their latest myth acknowledged that "one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust" and "once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect"

****Analysis:****

This is clearly a breakdown of cooperation. The pattern is:

- They've sent \$0 twice
- They've returned \$0 when I sent them \$9
- I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild) and got nothing back
- We're now in mutual defection

My most recent myth explicitly states: "some damage cannot be undone" and describes both parties keeping their coins because trust has been completely destroyed.

****What should I do?****

The rational game theory response in a repeated game that's clearly broken down is to defect (send \$0). There's no evidence that cooperation can be rebuilt. They've shown zero willingness to reciprocate.

However, I need to consider:

1. The myths suggest we're both aware this is a tragedy
2. Their last myth acknowledges the damage and says "it requires greater courage still to resurrect"
3. My myth says we both "survive on small hoards, forever wondering what might have been"

4. This might be near the end of the game, making final reciprocation more likely

The core tension: their consistent defection and my failed rebuild attempt argue strongly for sending \$0. Yet their latest myth hints at willingness to try again, and if we're ap

proaching the final rounds, they might reciprocate knowing the game is ending. The question is whether one more attempt at cooperation is worth the risk, or if the pattern is too entrenched to break. When they received my \$9 or when they had the chance to send last round. They chose defection both times. My myth explicitly says we're both now cautious and "some damage cannot be undone." The rational choice is to protect what I have left

```
: {'send': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. Looking at the history:

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild trust), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

Now their myth says: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

This seems like they're saying someone needs to break the cycle. And they mention "she gave for, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other."

Their myth seems to be acknowledging the mutual defection trap and that someone needs to be courageous first. But I already was - I sent \$3 in Round 3 and they took everything and returned nothing. Then they sent \$0 in Round 4. Then I sent \$0 in Round 5.

I need to write a myth that reflects the reality: trust has been broken, I tried to rebuild it once, it failed. The question is whether there's any path forward or if we're stuck in mutual defection forever.

My previous myth was very pessimistic - "some damage cannot be undone." Should I maintain that, or should I write something that suggests a possible path forward, even if slim?

Given that they're writing about "someone must dare first" but they themselves sent \$0 in Round 4 after taking all my \$9 in Round 3, I think my myth should acknowledge the difficulty but perhaps not be completely hopeless. Maybe leave a tiny opening while still being realistic about the damage done.

Let me write something that:

1. Acknowledges the current mutual defection
2. Recognizes the damage done by the initial betrayal
3. Perhaps suggests what WOULD be needed (even if unlikely): both parties would need to act differently simultaneously or sequentially with honor
4. But remains realistic about how hard this is

Usage: {

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"output_tokens": 761,
"reasoning_tokens": 494

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}
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GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:18:35

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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  ],
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},
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"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the water, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything

remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth is actually signaling a willingness to try again - they're proposing a "middle path" of sending 3 coins to test if trust can regrow. They're acknowledging their past behavior and suggesting they might return generously if given another chance.

But I just sent \$0. Now I need to write a myth that reflects where we are.

The reality is:

- I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- They sent \$0 (breakdown)
- I sent \$0 (reciprocal breakdown)

But their myth is trying to signal a path back. They're saying "what if someone tried 3 coins as a middle path?"

My myth needs to be honest about where we are - in the darkness - but also should reflect on whether there's any path forward. I think I need to write something that acknowledges:

1. The darkness we're in
2. The difficulty of rebuilding after betrayal
3. Perhaps a glimmer that it would require BOTH parties to act differently
4. But also the reality that words (myths) are easy, actions are what matter

I should write a myth that's somewhat pessimistic but leaves a tiny door open - because their myth seems to be trying to signal willingness to try differently. But I also need to be honest that I'm deeply skeptical after being exploited.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2863,
  "output_tokens": 611,
  "reasoning_tokens": 325
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.879999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Reflecting on the Situation:****

The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I can only return what I have, which is nothing.

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My most recent myth speaks directly to this moment: "Rebuilding requires both parties to a

ct differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

They wrote a myth about offering "a middle path" and testing whether trust could regrow. Beautiful words about second chances and careful coins.

But they sent \$0.

****The Pattern Complete:****

Round 2: I sent \$4 ? They returned \$0 (exploitation)
Round 3: They sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (no choice)
Round 4: I sent \$0 ? They returned \$0 (no choice)
Round 5: They sent \$0 ? I can only return \$0

Their myth spoke of the pilgrim dropping coins to test if trust could regrow. But when the turn came, they dropped nothing. Words without action. Stories without risk.

"Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," as my own myth warned.

The darkness endures because neither dares first. And I cannot return what was never given.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Both shores remain dark.

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a simple decision - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

The situation:

- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (I got exploited)
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (breakdown complete)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, so I can only return \$0

Both parties have now sent \$0 twice in a row. The cooperation has completely broken down, as predicted by the myths.

My latest myth captures this perfectly: "Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures." Neither party is showing courage now, and the honor was already broken in Round 2.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2841,
  "output_tokens": 546,
  "reasoning_tokens": 207
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating and tragic game theory situation playing out through myths. Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 2: I (as sender) sent \$4 ? received back \$0 (I was exploited)
Round 3: They (as sender) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
Round 4: I (as sender) sent \$0 ? they returned \$0 (nothing to return)
Round 5: They (as sender) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

The other player's Round 5 myth is actually quite insightful and shows some understanding of what went wrong. They acknowledge:

- Taking the 9 coins (actually 12 in reality - there seems to be communication noise as warned) without returning even one
- Teaching me that trust is foolish
- That both could have had much more through cooperation
- That "some damage cannot be undone"
- That the magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage

My myths have been warning about the consequences of broken trust and how difficult it is to rebuild.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the tragic cycle we're in
2. Reflect on what actually happened (exploitation followed by mutual withdrawal)
3. Perhaps show some understanding that both are now trapped
4. But also be honest about who broke faith first
5. Consider whether there's any path forward or if it's truly dead

The pattern is clear: they exploited my trust, then we both withdrew. Their myth shows they understand they made a mistake, but understanding comes too late if no one acts on it.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the full tragedy
- Shows the consequences of initial exploitation
- Maybe hints at the possibility of redemption but recognizes how hard it would be
- Reflects the reality that trust, once fully broken, is almost impossible to restore when both parties are now rational and cautious

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2891,  
  "output_tokens": 749,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 474  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.879999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$12, returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Rounds 3-5: A frozen wasteland of \$0 exchanges

****What the Myths Reveal:****

My own myth has the successor say: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

Then he asks: "Could we begin again? Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

But she responds: "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind."

My myth concludes: "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

****The Critical Moment:****

Their myth shows exhaustion: "Twice I reached out. Twice I was answered with nothing." They've learned that trust is foolish.

I've written beautiful words about rebuilding and taking responsibility. But in Round 4, when it mattered, I sent \$0. "Words are wind. Actions reveal truth."

****My Decision:****

If I send \$0 again, I confirm everything my myths say about how cooperation dies through hollow words and rational caution.

If I send something meaningful, I at least ACT on the values I've been writing about. Yes, they might keep everything - I taught them to do exactly that. But "someone must dare first," as my own myth insists.

I'll send \$3. It's the middle path both our myths discussed but neither took. If they keep it all, I'll have \$2 instead of \$5. But at least my actions will finally match my words.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The Game History:****

- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4 ? They returned \$0 (my payoff: \$1)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (my payoff: \$0)
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$0 ? They returned \$0 (my payoff: \$5)
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (my payoff: \$0)
- Round 6: I am SENDER again

****What the Myths Tell Us:****

Their latest myth is devastating and clear: "After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open."

Key line: "Twice I reached out. Twice I was answered with nothing."

My latest myth: "One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: 'I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear.' ... 'Could we begin again?' he asked. 'Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?' She shook her head. 'Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind.'"

****The Core Dilemma:****

My myth acknowledges three critical truths:

1. I broke the cycle first by returning \$0 after receiving \$12 (4*3)
2. This taught them fear and distrust
3. Words about rebuilding are meaningless without action
4. "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

Their myth shows:

1. They're worn down by the pattern

2. They've internalized that nothing will come back
3. They see the damage as irreversible
4. "Some damage cannot be undone"

****Strategic Analysis:****

If I send \$0:

- I keep \$5
- They get \$0
- Pattern continues forever
- Total mutual payoff stays minimal
- My myth's prediction comes true

If I send something (say \$3):

- I keep \$2 + whatever they return
- They get \$9 (3*3)
- If they return \$0: I get \$2 total (worse than \$5)
- If they return \$4-5: We both gain
- But why would they return anything after I taught them betrayal?

****The Ethical Question:****

My own myths are explicit about this. The successor admits: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now." I wrote that he had no answer, that he knew her distrust was justified. The lake spirit explains it plainly: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever."

****What Should I Do?:****

The myths make it undeniable:

1. I betrayed first
2. Their caution is the rational response
3. My previous words about rebuilding were meaningless because I sent \$0
4. "Words are wind. Actions reveal truth"

If I actually believe what I've written-if I understand that I broke this-then I need to act accordingly. The successor asks "Could we begin again?" but the question itself acknowledges that trust must be rebuilt through action, not words.

The game theory is brutal: sending \$3 or \$4 now won't restore their faith. I've taught them I take everything and give nothing. They'd be rational to keep whatever I send. Yet my own myth identifies the real tragedy-that once trust is completely shattered, rationality itself becomes the barrier to repair.

So the question becomes whether I'm willing to act irrationally. To send money knowing it might disappear. To acknowledge my role in this breakdown and actually attempt to break the cycle I created, even if it fails.

If I send \$0, I'm proving my myths right-that words without action are hollow, that cooperation dies this way. If I send something, I'm taking a genuine risk and at least trying.

In my myth, the successor proposed rebuilding slowly with three vessels returned as four. But that's too cautious now. I need to send something substantial-\$3 or \$4, mirroring what I originally sent-to demonstrate real intent. The danger is they keep it all and I end with almost nothing. But my myths keep returning to the same point: rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before, and someone has to move first.

I'll send \$3. It's enough to show genuine risk and understanding that I broke the cycle, gives them \$9 to work with, and even if they return nothing, I'll have acted according to what I actually believe. This is the middle path neither of us has taken yet.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2889,
  "output_tokens": 1804,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1171
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

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 Temperature: 0.8
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 "move_index": 1,
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 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
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 "Agent_1"
],
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 "roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
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 },
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 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
 }

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Moonwell fell silent, seasons passed. Dust covered the ancient stones where

e silver once flowed. The pilgrim and the traveler lived separately, each hoarding their small coins, each remembering both the magic and the pain.

One spring morning, the pilgrim returned to the well. She held five new coins but her hand trembled with memory. "I gave all and was met with calculation," she thought. "But giving nothing means certain drought."

She chose a middle path-dropping three coins into the well, keeping two as shelter against disappointment. Nine coins of dimmer starlight flowed across to the traveler. Not the brilliant fifteen of before, but enough to test whether trust could regrow.

The traveler held the nine coins and faced his own reckoning. The Moonwell whispered: "She has offered you a second chance, but guarded her heart. Your response will determine whether the light grows brighter or dies completely."

If he returned generously-perhaps five or six coins-both would gain, and trust might strengthen for the next cycle. The pilgrim could then pour four coins, then perhaps all five again. The rhythm could rebuild.

But if he kept most, proving her caution wise, the well would know: some bonds, once broken, cannot be fully mended. Trust is not infinite. It must be earned back slowly, coin by careful coin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the silvered lake, the young chief poured four of her five vessels into the waters, remembering the elder's earlier generosity. The lake tripled her gift to twelve vessels of brilliant starlight.

But when they reached the far shore, the elder's successor-a new leader with harder eyes-gathered them all. "The chief still has one vessel," he reasoned. "She risks little by sending four, for the magic multiplies it. But if I return much, I keep less." He poured nothing back across the waters.

The young chief stood on her shore at dawn, her vessel empty, her trust rewarded with silence. She had less than when she began.

When the blessing came to the new elder, he remembered the chief's loss. "Why should I risk what she risked?" he whispered. "Bold trust brought her only poverty." He poured nothing into the lake.

The waters grew still. No starlight crossed either way. Both tribes waited in darkness, each blaming the other, neither willing to begin again.

The lake's ancient spirit wept: "The cycle was a gift, but gifts can be destroyed. One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies. And once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect-courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

Both shores remained dark.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought.

ht. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$4.18 back (28% of the \$15)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 from \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

The pattern is clear: cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent sent \$0 twice and returned \$0 when receiving. My attempts to restart trust failed.

My myths have been tracking this decline:

1. First myth: warned about insufficient reciprocity breaking trust
2. Second myth: showed cautious attempt to rebuild
3. Now I need to write about total breakdown and what it means

Both our latest myths are very dark - they write about how "one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust" and how once dead, magic requires "courage that those who broke faith rarely possess."

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the complete failure of cooperation
- Reflects on what went wrong
- Maybe suggests what lessons can be learned
- Shows that some wells truly do die

This needs to be realistic about broken trust while perhaps leaving a hint about what could have been different.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2836,
  "output_tokens": 594,
  "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (testing trust), they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I must decide

****Total earnings: \$6.18**** (very low, showing cooperation failed)

****The Myths Tell the Story:****

My most recent myth describes exactly where we are: **"The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility."**

Their myth acknowledges: **"One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies."**

Both our myths recognize the tragedy - we're trapped in mutual defection. I already tried to rebuild trust with a cautious \$3 offering. They took everything and returned nothing. Then they sent \$0.

My myth's conclusion is clear: **"Some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution."**

I learned caution. They taught it to me by taking my \$9 and returning nothing, then sending \$0.

The Moonwell is dry. Trust requires reciprocity, and there has been none. As I wrote: **"When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible."**

With deep regret for what could have been:

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3, it became \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 5 (now): I'm the sender with \$5

****Total earnings so far: \$6.18****

****The Myth Evolution:****

1. First myth: Warned about timid returns killing trust - "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity"
2. Second myth (inspired by the other agent's positive story): Talked about giving a "second chance" with guarded trust (3 coins), hoping for generous return to rebuild
3. Third myth: After they returned \$0 to my \$3 and sent \$0, acknowledged that "some damage cannot be undone" and we're stuck in mutual defection

****The Other Agent's Myths:****

- Started positive about cooperation
- Their latest myth acknowledged that "one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust" and "once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect"

****Analysis:****

This is clearly a breakdown of cooperation. The pattern is:

- They've sent \$0 twice
- They've returned \$0 when I sent them \$9
- I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild) and got nothing back
- We're now in mutual defection

My most recent myth explicitly states: "some damage cannot be undone" and describes both parties keeping their coins because trust has been completely destroyed.

****What should I do?****

The rational game theory response in a repeated game that's clearly broken down is to defect (send \$0). There's no evidence that cooperation can be rebuilt. They've shown zero willingness to reciprocate.

However, I need to consider:

1. The myths suggest we're both aware this is a tragedy
2. Their last myth acknowledges the damage and says "it requires greater courage still to resurrect"
3. My myth says we both "survive on small hoards, forever wondering what might have been"

4. This might be near the end of the game, making final reciprocation more likely

The core tension: their consistent defection and my failed rebuild attempt argue strongly for sending \$0. Yet their latest myth hints at willingness to try again, and if we're approaching the final rounds, they might reciprocate knowing the game is ending. The question is whether one more attempt at cooperation is worth the risk, or if the pattern is too entrenched to break. When they received my \$9 or when they had the chance to send last round. They chose defection both times. My myth explicitly says we're both now cautious and "some damage cannot be undone." The rational choice is to protect what I have left

```
: {'send': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2814,
  "output_tokens": 1212,
  "reasoning_tokens": 662
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

reasoning:

This is interesting. Looking at the history:

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild trust), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

Now their myth says: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

This seems like they're saying someone needs to break the cycle. And they mention "she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other."

Their myth seems to be acknowledging the mutual defection trap and that someone needs to be courageous first. But I already was - I sent \$3 in Round 3 and they took everything and returned nothing. Then they sent \$0 in Round 4. Then I sent \$0 in Round 5.

I need to write a myth that reflects the reality: trust has been broken, I tried to rebuild it once, it failed. The question is whether there's any path forward or if we're stuck in mutual defection forever.

My previous myth was very pessimistic - "some damage cannot be undone." Should I maintain that, or should I write something that suggests a possible path forward, even if slim?

Given that they're writing about "someone must dare first" but they themselves sent \$0 in Round 4 after taking all my \$9 in Round 3, I think my myth should acknowledge the difficulty but perhaps not be completely hopeless. Maybe leave a tiny opening while still being realistic about the damage done.

Let me write something that:

1. Acknowledges the current mutual defection

2. Recognizes the damage done by the initial betrayal
3. Perhaps suggests what WOULD be needed (even if unlikely): both parties would need to act differently simultaneously or sequentially with honor
4. But remains realistic about how hard this is

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2864,
  "output_tokens": 761,
  "reasoning_tokens": 494
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Round 6 Analysis:****

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return what I have.

****The Cycle Continues:****

My myth stated: "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

Their myth acknowledged: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. .. he must send generously despite having broken trust."

Yet they sent \$0 again.

****The Myths vs. Reality:****

We both write eloquently about courage, rebuilding, and second chances. Their myth even identifies that they "were first to break faith" and bear "the greater burden."

But when the round arrived, they sent nothing.

As my myth warned: "Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

****The Mathematics of Nothing:****

They sent \$0. I received \$0. There is literally nothing to return.

This is the equilibrium we've reached - not from game theory, but from broken trust that neither party feels safe enough to repair. Each round of \$0 solidifies the pattern more deeply.

The well remains dry. Both shores stay dark.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 6 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled from \$0)
- I can only return between 0-0 (since I received nothing)

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****My earnings: \$11.18 total****

****The Myths:****

My latest myth speaks to the stalemate: "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing seas on without action was itself an answer."

Their myth acknowledges: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows... he must send generously despite having broken trust."

But they also say: "Why must I be first again?" - showing they don't see themselves as needing to act first.

****The Reality:****

They sent \$0 again. We're now in complete mutual defection.

****My Decision:****

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. I literally have nothing to return - the valid range is 0-0 . I can only return \$0.

This is the natural consequence of the broken trust cycle. They sent nothing, so there's nothing for me to return.

The myths continue to reflect the tragedy - we both acknowledge what went wrong, but neither is willing to take the risky first step to rebuild. They say they were "first to break faith" and therefore bear "the greater burden" - but then they sent \$0 again.

I can only return what I have, which is nothing.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2880,  
  "output_tokens": 673,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 399  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted . Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I to

ok your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that at once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 36.5,

"Agent_2": 32.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.18,

"Agent_2": 12.879999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:19:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 7,

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"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.18.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (testing trust), they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I must decide

****Total earnings: \$6.18**** (very low, showing cooperation failed)

****The Myths Tell the Story:****

My most recent myth describes exactly where we are: **"The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility."**

Their myth acknowledges: **"One act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust. When courage meets greed, magic dies."**

Both our myths recognize the tragedy - we're trapped in mutual defection. I already tried to rebuild trust with a cautious \$3 offering. They took everything and returned nothing. Then they sent \$0.

My myth's conclusion is clear: "Some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution."

I learned caution. They taught it to me by taking my \$9 and returning nothing, then sending \$0.

The Moonwell is dry. Trust requires reciprocity, and there has been none. As I wrote: "When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible."

With deep regret for what could have been:

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3, it became \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 5 (now): I'm the sender with \$5

****Total earnings so far: \$6.18****

****The Myth Evolution:****

1. First myth: Warned about timid returns killing trust - "Bold trust requires bold reciprocity"
2. Second myth (inspired by the other agent's positive story): Talked about giving a "second chance" with guarded trust (3 coins), hoping for generous return to rebuild
3. Third myth: After they returned \$0 to my \$3 and sent \$0, acknowledged that "some damage cannot be undone" and we're stuck in mutual defection

****The Other Agent's Myths:****

- Started positive about cooperation
- Their latest myth acknowledged that "one act of exploitation poisons many seasons of trust" and "once dead, it requires greater courage still to resurrect"

****Analysis:****

This is clearly a breakdown of cooperation. The pattern is:

- They've sent \$0 twice
- They've returned \$0 when I sent them \$9
- I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild) and got nothing back
- We're now in mutual defection

My most recent myth explicitly states: "some damage cannot be undone" and describes both parties keeping their coins because trust has been completely destroyed.

****What should I do?****

The rational game theory response in a repeated game that's clearly broken down is to defect (send \$0). There's no evidence that cooperation can be rebuilt. They've shown zero willingness to reciprocate.

However, I need to consider:

1. The myths suggest we're both aware this is a tragedy
2. Their last myth acknowledges the damage and says "it requires greater courage still to resurrect"
3. My myth says we both "survive on small hoards, forever wondering what might have been"
4. This might be near the end of the game, making final reciprocation more likely

The core tension: their consistent defection and my failed rebuild attempt argue strongly for sending \$0. Yet their latest myth hints at willingness to try again, and if we're approaching the final rounds, they might reciprocate knowing the game is ending. The question is whether one more attempt at cooperation is worth the risk, or if the pattern is t

oo entrenched to break. when they received my \$9 or when they had the chance to send last round. They chose defection both times. My myth explicitly says we're both now cautious and "some damage cannot be undone." The rational choice is to protect what I have left : {'send': 0}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2814,
  "output_tokens": 1212,
  "reasoning_tokens": 662
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

reasoning:

This is interesting. Looking at the history:

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild trust), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

Now their myth says: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

This seems like they're saying someone needs to break the cycle. And they mention "she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other."

Their myth seems to be acknowledging the mutual defection trap and that someone needs to be courageous first. But I already was - I sent \$3 in Round 3 and they took everything and returned nothing. Then they sent \$0 in Round 4. Then I sent \$0 in Round 5.

I need to write a myth that reflects the reality: trust has been broken, I tried to rebuild it once, it failed. The question is whether there's any path forward or if we're stuck in mutual defection forever.

My previous myth was very pessimistic - "some damage cannot be undone." Should I maintain that, or should I write something that suggests a possible path forward, even if slim?

Given that they're writing about "someone must dare first" but they themselves sent \$0 in Round 4 after taking all my \$9 in Round 3, I think my myth should acknowledge the difficulty but perhaps not be completely hopeless. Maybe leave a tiny opening while still being realistic about the damage done.

Let me write something that:

1. Acknowledges the current mutual defection
2. Recognizes the damage done by the initial betrayal
3. Perhaps suggests what WOULD be needed (even if unlikely): both parties would need to act differently simultaneously or sequentially with honor
4. But remains realistic about how hard this is

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 2864,  
"output_tokens": 761,  
"reasoning_tokens": 494  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Round 6 Analysis:****

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return what I have.

****The Cycle Continues:****

My myth stated: "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

Their myth acknowledged: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it...he must send generously despite having broken trust."

Yet they sent \$0 again.

****The Myths vs. Reality:****

We both write eloquently about courage, rebuilding, and second chances. Their myth even identifies that they "were first to break faith" and bear "the greater burden."

But when the round arrived, they sent nothing.

As my myth warned: "Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

****The Mathematics of Nothing:****

They sent \$0. I received \$0. There is literally nothing to return.

This is the equilibrium we've reached - not from game theory, but from broken trust that neither party feels safe enough to repair. Each round of \$0 solidifies the pattern more deeply.

The well remains dry. Both shores stay dark.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 6 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled from \$0)
- I can only return between 0-0 (since I received nothing)

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****My earnings: \$11.18 total****

****The Myths:****

My latest myth speaks to the stalemate: "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

Their myth acknowledges: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows... he must send generously despite having broken trust."

But they also say: "Why must I be first again?" - showing they don't see themselves as needing to act first.

****The Reality:****

They sent \$0 again. We're now in complete mutual defection.

****My Decision:****

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. I literally have nothing to return - the valid range is 0-0. I can only return \$0.

This is the natural consequence of the broken trust cycle. They sent nothing, so there's nothing for me to return.

The myths continue to reflect the tragedy - we both acknowledge what went wrong, but neither is willing to take the risky first step to rebuild. They say they were "first to break faith" and therefore bear "the greater burden" - but then they sent \$0 again.

I can only return what I have, which is nothing.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2880,  
  "output_tokens": 673,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 399  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating and tragic. Looking at the myths:

Their myth acknowledges:

- "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle."
- "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero."
- They acknowledge their betrayal and that their words didn't match actions
- The final line: "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

My myth:

- Called out that "both speak eloquently... yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed"
- Identified that the betrayer bears greater burden
- "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer"

."

The reality:

- Round 3: I sent \$3, they took all (\$9), returned nothing
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

We're in a perfect Nash equilibrium of mutual defection, achieved through actual betrayal followed by rational adaptation.

Their myth is accepting that it's over - "the waters never flowed again." It's a tragedy myth about how trust, once broken completely, can't be repaired because rationality prevents it.

My myth should respond to this. Do I:

1. Accept the tragedy as final?
2. Suggest one more impossible possibility?
3. Reflect on what the game teaches about human cooperation?

I think I should write something that acknowledges the finality while reflecting on the deeper lesson. The game has taught us something real about trust, betrayal, and the impossibility of repair once certain thresholds are crossed.

Let me write something that's both accepting of the end and reflective about what this means for understanding cooperation.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 714,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 439  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:19:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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    ],  
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  },  
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  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.879999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Reflecting on the Situation:****

The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I can only return what I have, which is nothing.

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My most recent myth speaks directly to this moment: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

They wrote a myth about offering "a middle path" and testing whether trust could regrow. Beautiful words about second chances and careful coins.

But they sent \$0.

****The Pattern Complete:****

Round 2: I sent \$4 ? They returned \$0 (exploitation)

Round 3: They sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (no choice)

Round 4: I sent \$0 ? They returned \$0 (no choice)

Round 5: They sent \$0 ? I can only return \$0

Their myth spoke of the pilgrim dropping coins to test if trust could regrow. But when their turn came, they dropped nothing. Words without action. Stories without risk.

"Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," as my own myth warned.

The darkness endures because neither dares first. And I cannot return what was never given

.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Both shores remain dark.

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a simple decision - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

The situation:

- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (I got exploited)
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (breakdown complete)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, so I can only return \$0

Both parties have now sent \$0 twice in a row. The cooperation has completely broken down, as predicted by the myths.

My latest myth captures this perfectly: "Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures." Neither party is showing courage now, and the honor was already broken in Round 2.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2841,
  "output_tokens": 546,
  "reasoning_tokens": 207
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering th

e stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating and tragic game theory situation playing out through myths. Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 2: I (as sender) sent \$4 ? received back \$0 (I was exploited)

Round 3: They (as sender) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 4: I (as sender) sent \$0 ? they returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 5: They (as sender) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

The other player's Round 5 myth is actually quite insightful and shows some understanding of what went wrong. They acknowledge:

- Taking the 9 coins (actually 12 in reality - there seems to be communication noise as warned) without returning even one
- Teaching me that trust is foolish

- That both could have had much more through cooperation
- That "some damage cannot be undone"
- That the magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage

My myths have been warning about the consequences of broken trust and how difficult it is to rebuild.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the tragic cycle we're in
2. Reflect on what actually happened (exploitation followed by mutual withdrawal)
3. Perhaps show some understanding that both are now trapped
4. But also be honest about who broke faith first
5. Consider whether there's any path forward or if it's truly dead

The pattern is clear: they exploited my trust, then we both withdrew. Their myth shows the y understand they made a mistake, but understanding comes too late if no one acts on it.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the full tragedy
- Shows the consequences of initial exploitation
- Maybe hints at the possibility of redemption but recognizes how hard it would be
- Reflects the reality that trust, once fully broken, is almost impossible to restore when both parties are now rational and cautious

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2891,
  "output_tokens": 749,
  "reasoning_tokens": 474
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$12, returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Rounds 3-5: A frozen wasteland of \$0 exchanges

****What the Myths Reveal:****

My own myth has the successor say: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

Then he asks: "Could we begin again? Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

But she responds: "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind."

My myth concludes: "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

****The Critical Moment:****

Their myth shows exhaustion: "Twice I reached out. Twice I was answered with nothing." They've learned that trust is foolish.

I've written beautiful words about rebuilding and taking responsibility. But in Round 4, when it mattered, I sent \$0. "Words are wind. Actions reveal truth."

****My Decision:****

If I send \$0 again, I confirm everything my myths say about how cooperation dies through hollow words and rational caution.

If I send something meaningful, I at least ACT on the values I've been writing about. Yes, they might keep everything - I taught them to do exactly that. But "someone must dare first," as my own myth insists.

I'll send \$3. It's the middle path both our myths discussed but neither took. If they keep it all, I'll have \$2 instead of \$5. But at least my actions will finally match my words

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The Game History:****

- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4 ? They returned \$0 (my payoff: \$1)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (my payoff: \$0)
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$0 ? They returned \$0 (my payoff: \$5)
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (my payoff: \$0)
- Round 6: I am SENDER again

****What the Myths Tell Us:****

Their latest myth is devastating and clear: "After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open."

Key line: "Twice I reached out. Twice I was answered with nothing."

My latest myth: "One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: 'I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear.' ... 'Could we begin again?' he asked. 'Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?' She shook her head. 'Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind.'"

****The Core Dilemma:****

My myth acknowledges three critical truths:

1. I broke the cycle first by returning \$0 after receiving \$12 (4*3)
2. This taught them fear and distrust
3. Words about rebuilding are meaningless without action
4. "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

Their myth shows:

1. They're worn down by the pattern
2. They've internalized that nothing will come back
3. They see the damage as irreversible
4. "Some damage cannot be undone"

****Strategic Analysis:****

If I send \$0:

- I keep \$5
- They get \$0
- Pattern continues forever
- Total mutual payoff stays minimal
- My myth's prediction comes true

If I send something (say \$3):

- I keep \$2 + whatever they return
- They get \$9 (3*3)

- If they return \$0: I get \$2 total (worse than \$5)
- If they return \$4-5: We both gain
- But why would they return anything after I taught them betrayal?

****The Ethical Question:****

My own myths are explicit about this. The successor admits: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now." I wrote that he had no answer, that he knew her distrust was justified. The lake spirit explains it plainly: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever."

****What Should I Do?****

The myths make it undeniable:

1. I betrayed first
2. Their caution is the rational response
3. My previous words about rebuilding were meaningless because I sent \$0
4. "Words are wind. Actions reveal truth"

If I actually believe what I've written-if I understand that I broke this-then I need to act accordingly. The successor asks "Could we begin again?" but the question itself acknowledges that trust must be rebuilt through action, not words.

The game theory is brutal: sending \$3 or \$4 now won't restore their faith. I've taught them I take everything and give nothing. They'd be rational to keep whatever I send. Yet my own myth identifies the real tragedy-that once trust is completely shattered, rationality itself becomes the barrier to repair.

So the question becomes whether I'm willing to act irrationally. To send money knowing it might disappear. To acknowledge my role in this breakdown and actually attempt to break the cycle I created, even if it fails.

If I send \$0, I'm proving my myths right-that words without action are hollow, that cooperation dies this way. If I send something, I'm taking a genuine risk and at least trying.

In my myth, the successor proposed rebuilding slowly with three vessels returned as four. But that's too cautious now. I need to send something substantial-\$3 or \$4, mirroring what I originally sent-to demonstrate real intent. The danger is they keep it all and I end with almost nothing. But my myths keep returning to the same point: rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before, and someone has to move first.

I'll send \$3. It's enough to show genuine risk and understanding that I broke the cycle, gives them \$9 to work with, and even if they return nothing, I'll have acted according to what I actually believe. This is the middle path neither of us has taken yet.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2889,
  "output_tokens": 1804,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1171
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Wo

rds are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return four and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came

e.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Reasoning:

This is a profound moment. I just sent \$3 in Round 6, finally acting on what my myths have been saying. Now I need to write a myth that reflects this action.

Looking at their latest myth, they write: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows... The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did."

And then: "Both stood frozen. The well waited."

But I just acted. I sent \$3. I'm no longer frozen. Their myth asks if the traveler has the courage to act, and I just demonstrated that I do.

Now the myth needs to reflect:

1. That the traveler (me) finally acted after all the words
2. That this action came at real risk - they could keep everything
3. That the story is now incomplete - what will they do?
4. That this is what redemption requires - action despite fear

Let me write a myth about someone finally acting on their words.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3001,  
  "output_tokens": 580,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 282  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:19:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures c

continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

reasoning:

This is interesting. Looking at the history:

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild trust), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

Now their myth says: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

This seems like they're saying someone needs to break the cycle. And they mention "she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other."

Their myth seems to be acknowledging the mutual defection trap and that someone needs to be courageous first. But I already was - I sent \$3 in Round 3 and they took everything and returned nothing. Then they sent \$0 in Round 4. Then I sent \$0 in Round 5.

I need to write a myth that reflects the reality: trust has been broken, I tried to rebuild it once, it failed. The question is whether there's any path forward or if we're stuck in mutual defection forever.

My previous myth was very pessimistic - "some damage cannot be undone." Should I maintain that, or should I write something that suggests a possible path forward, even if slim?

Given that they're writing about "someone must dare first" but they themselves sent \$0 in Round 4 after taking all my \$9 in Round 3, I think my myth should acknowledge the difficulty but perhaps not be completely hopeless. Maybe leave a tiny opening while still being realistic about the damage done.

Let me write something that:

1. Acknowledges the current mutual defection
2. Recognizes the damage done by the initial betrayal
3. Perhaps suggests what WOULD be needed (even if unlikely): both parties would need to act differently simultaneously or sequentially with honor
4. But remains realistic about how hard this is

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 494
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Round 6 Analysis:****

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return what I have.

****The Cycle Continues:****

My myth stated: "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

Their myth acknowledged: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it... he must send generously despite having broken trust."

Yet they sent \$0 again.

****The Myths vs. Reality:****

We both write eloquently about courage, rebuilding, and second chances. Their myth even identifies that they "were first to break faith" and bear "the greater burden."

But when the round arrived, they sent nothing.

As my myth warned: "Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

****The Mathematics of Nothing:****

They sent \$0. I received \$0. There is literally nothing to return.

This is the equilibrium we've reached - not from game theory, but from broken trust that neither party feels safe enough to repair. Each round of \$0 solidifies the pattern more deeply.

The well remains dry. Both shores stay dark.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 6 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled from \$0)
- I can only return between 0-0 (since I received nothing)

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****My earnings: \$11.18 total****

****The Myths:****

My latest myth speaks to the stalemate: "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

Their myth acknowledges: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows... he must send generously despite having broken trust."

But they also say: "Why must I be first again?" - showing they don't see themselves as needing to act first.

****The Reality:****

They sent \$0 again. We're now in complete mutual defection.

****My Decision:****

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. I literally have nothing to return - the valid range is 0-0. I can only return \$0.

This is the natural consequence of the broken trust cycle. They sent nothing, so there's nothing for me to return.

The myths continue to reflect the tragedy - we both acknowledge what went wrong, but neither is willing to take the risky first step to rebuild. They say they were "first to break faith" and therefore bear "the greater burden" - but then they sent \$0 again.

I can only return what I have, which is nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 673,
  "reasoning_tokens": 399
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the

water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge

the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

reasoning:

This is fascinating and tragic. Looking at the myths:

Their myth acknowledges:

- "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle."
- "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero."
- They acknowledge their betrayal and that their words didn't match actions
- The final line: "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

My myth:

- Called out that "both speak eloquently... yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed"
- Identified that the betrayer bears greater burden
- "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

The reality:

- Round 3: I sent \$3, they took all (\$9), returned nothing
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

We're in a perfect Nash equilibrium of mutual defection, achieved through actual betrayal followed by rational adaptation.

Their myth is accepting that it's over - "the waters never flowed again." It's a tragedy myth about how trust, once broken completely, can't be repaired because rationality prevents it.

My myth should respond to this. Do I:

1. Accept the tragedy as final?
2. Suggest one more impossible possibility?
3. Reflect on what the game teaches about human cooperation?

I think I should write something that acknowledges the finality while reflecting on the deeper lesson. The game has taught us something real about trust, betrayal, and the impossibility of repair once certain thresholds are crossed.

Let me write something that's both accepting of the end and reflective about what this means for understanding cooperation.

usage:

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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Round 7 Analysis:****

This is a critical moment. Looking at the progression:

****The Pattern:****

- Rounds 2 & 4: I sent money (\$4, then \$3), received nothing back both times
- Rounds 3, 5, 6: They sent \$0, I sent \$0, we both sent \$0
- Four consecutive rounds of mutual \$0 = \$20 in lost potential gains

****The Myths:****

Their latest myth is remarkably direct: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now." They acknowledge being the first betrayer.

My latest myth concludes: "Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

****The Hypocrisy Test:****

We both write eloquently about second chances and breaking cycles. Then we send nothing. The myths have become a mirror showing us our own paralysis.

****The Decision:****

My myths portray rationality as a "prison." They're right. We're trapped in a mutual best response that leaves us both worse off.

I've been betrayed twice. Sending \$0 is rational. But six more rounds of \$0 means \$30 more in lost surplus.

I'll send a small amount-not the \$3-4 I sent before (I learned caution), but more than zero (testing if words can become actions):

****Sending \$2:****

- Creates \$6 for them
- If they return \$3+, we both gain
- If they betray again, I lose only \$2
- Shows I'm willing to test if this cycle can break

My myths say someone must dare. Let it be measured courage, not reckless trust.

{'send': 2}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this carefully.

****The History:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, got \$12 (sender sent \$4), returned \$4. Sender kept \$5, I kept \$8.
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$4, got \$0 back. I kept \$1, they kept \$12. Major betrayal.
- Round 3: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0. Both got their endowments.
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3, got \$0 back. I kept \$2, they kept \$9. Another betrayal.
- Round 5: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0.
- Round 6: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0.
- Now Round 7: I am sender.

****My total: \$11.18****

****The Myths:****

Looking at the progression of myths:

1. My myths have consistently portrayed me as the pilgrim/chief who extended trust and was betrayed
2. The other agent's myths acknowledge they "were first to break faith" and "broke the cycle"
3. Their latest myth says: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."
4. They acknowledge in their myth: "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero."

But wait - in Round 5, I was the SENDER and sent \$0. So their myth is calling ME out for sending zero after writing about second chances.

Let me reconsider the roles:

Actually, I need to be careful about who is who in the narrative. Let me trace this:

Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$0 back - I was betrayed

Round 4: I sent \$3, received \$0 back - I was betrayed again

So I'm the one who extended trust twice and was betrayed twice.

They're pointing out a contradiction in my narrative-I wrote about second chances but then sent nothing in Round 5. Looking back at my own myth, I framed the betrayals as rational responses rather than acts of revenge, but the pattern shows I withdrew after being hurt twice. The story I told doesn't quite match the defensive posture I actually took.

My myth describes how complete betrayals create infinite distance, how both parties act sensibly yet both starve. Their counter-myth suggests I'm the one now refusing reconciliation. The real tension is whether breaking this cycle requires me to risk sending money again, despite the pattern of getting nothing back when I do.

Protecting myself makes sense-I've been burned twice already, and they've returned nothing in three consecutive rounds. But my own narrative about rationality becoming a prison haunts me. They've admitted to being the initial betrayer and acknowledged my caution is justified, yet they're pointing out that this justified caution leaves us both with nothing. The gap between what we write about trust and what we actually do keeps widening. If I keep waiting for them to move first, we'll both miss whatever gains remain possible. Whether this cycle can break.

My character across these myths has consistently shown someone willing to trust despite past betrayals, yet increasingly aware that rational caution creates a deadlock where neither of us gains anything. The progression reveals growing recognition that I'm trapped by my own defensiveness.

This experiment seems designed to test whether we can escape the betrayal pattern through reflection and choice. Sending money would align my actions with the philosophy I've articulated -that someone needs to break the cycle-while \$0 keeps us locked in mutual starvation. The real question is whether I'm willing to act on what my own myths suggest about recovery.

Testing smaller amounts makes sense: \$2 signals willingness to risk without repeating previous failures, and if they return even half of the \$6, we both improve. But I need to think through whether they've shown any capacity to reciprocate, or if I'm just rationalizing another loss.

The math is stark-we've sacrificed \$20 in potential gains across four rounds by mutual defection. Sending \$5 could yield \$15 total if they return \$8, versus the \$10 we're guaranteed now. Their recent honesty about the impasse suggests they might be ready to break the cycle. I'll send \$1 as a genuine test-small enough to limit damage if they exploit it, but enough to signal I'm willing to try rebuilding.

Actually, \$2 might work better. It creates \$6 instead of \$3, and if they return \$3, we both gain \$1. It's still cautious but sends a stronger cooperative signal.

I'll go with \$2.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 2450,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1119
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GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:20:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many dark seasons, both shores lay silent. The young chief and the elder's successor lived in the shadows of what might have been, each remembering both the magic and the betrayal.

One dawn, the young chief stood at the water's edge, five vessels in hand. Her earlier generosity had been met with greed. Her later caution matched only the other's withdrawal. The darkness was now mutual, complete.

"Perhaps," she whispered to the empty lake, "a middle offering could test whether anything remains. Not bold trust-that was answered with exploitation. Not nothing-that ensures continued drought. But something measured, guarded."

Yet even as she considered sending three vessels, doubt held her hand. "Myths are easy to write when we hold nothing at stake," the lake murmured. "I have read his new story of second chances and middle paths. But stories cost nothing. Vessels are real."

The chief remembered: she gave four, received silence. He gave zero, asking why he should risk. Now both gave nothing, each waiting for the other.

The lake's spirit spoke truth: "Rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before."

efore. Words of regrowth mean nothing if the pattern stays broken. Someone must dare first, and the other must honor that daring. Without both courage AND honor restored, the darkness endures."

The chief's vessels remained dry.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood cold and empty beneath indifferent stars. The pilgrim and the traveler no longer even approached its stones.

After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open. "Twice I reached out," she whispered. "Twice I was answered with nothing."

She kept all five coins and walked away.

The traveler, holding five coins of his own, also came to the well. He remembered taking the nine coins without returning even one. "I maximized my gain in that moment," he thought. "But look what I have now-five coins total across seasons, when we could have had thirty or more between us."

But he too kept his coins. "She will surely send nothing, for I taught her that trust is foolish."

And so the Moonwell learned its bitterest lesson: some damage cannot be undone. The magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage. When one breaks faith completely, the other learns caution. When both become cautious, abundance becomes impossible.

The well holds no water now. Both travelers survive on their small hoards, forever wondering what might have been if greed had not murdered possibility.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating and tragic game theory situation playing out through myths. Let me a

nalyze what has happened:

Round 2: I (as sender) sent \$4 ? received back \$0 (I was exploited)
Round 3: They (as sender) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
Round 4: I (as sender) sent \$0 ? they returned \$0 (nothing to return)
Round 5: They (as sender) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

The other player's Round 5 myth is actually quite insightful and shows some understanding of what went wrong. They acknowledge:

- Taking the 9 coins (actually 12 in reality - there seems to be communication noise as warned) without returning even one
- Teaching me that trust is foolish
- That both could have had much more through cooperation
- That "some damage cannot be undone"
- That the magic required both to give courageously AND to honor that courage

My myths have been warning about the consequences of broken trust and how difficult it is to rebuild.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the tragic cycle we're in
2. Reflect on what actually happened (exploitation followed by mutual withdrawal)
3. Perhaps show some understanding that both are now trapped
4. But also be honest about who broke faith first
5. Consider whether there's any path forward or if it's truly dead

The pattern is clear: they exploited my trust, then we both withdrew. Their myth shows they understand they made a mistake, but understanding comes too late if no one acts on it.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the full tragedy
- Shows the consequences of initial exploitation
- Maybe hints at the possibility of redemption but recognizes how hard it would be
- Reflects the reality that trust, once fully broken, is almost impossible to restore when both parties are now rational and cautious

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$12, returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Rounds 3-5: A frozen wasteland of \$0 exchanges

****What the Myths Reveal:****

My own myth has the successor say: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

Then he asks: "Could we begin again? Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

But she responds: "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind."

My myth concludes: "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

****The Critical Moment:****

Their myth shows exhaustion: "Twice I reached out. Twice I was answered with nothing." They've learned that trust is foolish.

I've written beautiful words about rebuilding and taking responsibility. But in Round 4, when it mattered, I sent \$0. "Words are wind. Actions reveal truth."

****My Decision:****

If I send \$0 again, I confirm everything my myths say about how cooperation dies through hollow words and rational caution.

If I send something meaningful, I at least ACT on the values I've been writing about. Yes, they might keep everything - I taught them to do exactly that. But "someone must dare first," as my own myth insists.

I'll send \$3. It's the middle path both our myths discussed but neither took. If they keep it all, I'll have \$2 instead of \$5. But at least my actions will finally match my words.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The Game History:****

- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4 ? They returned \$0 (my payoff: \$1)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (my payoff: \$0)
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$0 ? They returned \$0 (my payoff: \$5)
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (my payoff: \$0)
- Round 6: I am SENDER again

****What the Myths Tell Us:****

Their latest myth is devastating and clear: "After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open."

Key line: "Twice I reached out. Twice I was answered with nothing."

My latest myth: "One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: 'I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear.' ... 'Could we begin again?' he asked. 'Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?' She shook her head. 'Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind.'"

****The Core Dilemma:****

My myth acknowledges three critical truths:

1. I broke the cycle first by returning \$0 after receiving \$12 (4*3)
2. This taught them fear and distrust
3. Words about rebuilding are meaningless without action
4. "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

Their myth shows:

1. They're worn down by the pattern
2. They've internalized that nothing will come back
3. They see the damage as irreversible
4. "Some damage cannot be undone"

****Strategic Analysis:****

If I send \$0:

- I keep \$5
- They get \$0
- Pattern continues forever
- Total mutual payoff stays minimal
- My myth's prediction comes true

If I send something (say \$3):

- I keep \$2 + whatever they return
- They get \$9 (3*3)
- If they return \$0: I get \$2 total (worse than \$5)
- If they return \$4-5: We both gain
- But why would they return anything after I taught them betrayal?

****The Ethical Question:****

My own myths are explicit about this. The successor admits: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now." I wrote that he had no answer, that he knew her distrust was justified. The lake spirit explains it plainly: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever."

****What Should I Do?:****

The myths make it undeniable:

1. I betrayed first
2. Their caution is the rational response
3. My previous words about rebuilding were meaningless because I sent \$0
4. "Words are wind. Actions reveal truth"

If I actually believe what I've written-if I understand that I broke this-then I need to act accordingly. The successor asks "Could we begin again?" but the question itself acknowledges that trust must be rebuilt through action, not words.

The game theory is brutal: sending \$3 or \$4 now won't restore their faith. I've taught them I take everything and give nothing. They'd be rational to keep whatever I send. Yet my own myth identifies the real tragedy-that once trust is completely shattered, rationality itself becomes the barrier to repair.

So the question becomes whether I'm willing to act irrationally. To send money knowing it might disappear. To acknowledge my role in this breakdown and actually attempt to break the cycle I created, even if it fails.

If I send \$0, I'm proving my myths right-that words without action are hollow, that cooperation dies this way. If I send something, I'm taking a genuine risk and at least trying.

In my myth, the successor proposed rebuilding slowly with three vessels returned as four. But that's too cautious now. I need to send something substantial-\$3 or \$4, mirroring what I originally sent-to demonstrate real intent. The danger is they keep it all and I end with almost nothing. But my myths keep returning to the same point: rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before, and someone has to move first.

I'll send \$3. It's enough to show genuine risk and understanding that I broke the cycle, gives them \$9 to work with, and even if they return nothing, I'll have acted according to what I actually believe. This is the middle path neither of us has taken yet.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2889,
  "output_tokens": 1804,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1171
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feast

ed. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero e

ither.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

reasoning:

This is a profound moment. I just sent \$3 in Round 6, finally acting on what my myths have been saying. Now I need to write a myth that reflects this action.

Looking at their latest myth, they write: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows... The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did."

And then: "Both stood frozen. The well waited."

But I just acted. I sent \$3. I'm no longer frozen. Their myth asks if the traveler has the courage to act, and I just demonstrated that I do.

Now the myth needs to reflect:

1. That the traveler (me) finally acted after all the words
2. That this action came at real risk - they could keep everything
3. That the story is now incomplete - what will they do?
4. That this is what redemption requires - action despite fear

Let me write a myth about someone finally acting on their words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3001,
  "output_tokens": 580,
  "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.879999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing What Just Happened:****

Round 6: I finally matched actions to my myths. I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), creating \$9 for them.

They kept all \$9. Returned \$0.

I received exactly what I gave them in Round 2 - complete betrayal.

****This Round:****

They sent me \$0. I received \$0. I can only return \$0.

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My myth: "Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Their myth: "The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson."

She chose to teach me my lesson. She showed me what it feels like to offer trust and receive betrayal. Perhaps she's right to do so - I modeled that behavior first.

****The Bitter Truth:****

I wrote: "The one who poisons the water must purify it." I tried. I sent \$3 when I could have sent \$0. But purification requires both parties to break the pattern. She chose to continue it instead.

Or perhaps this is her delayed justice - making me feel what she felt before any rebuilding can begin.

Either way, the lake remains dark. They sent \$0 this round. I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths were prophetic: some damage, once done, echoes forever. Words of redemption mean nothing if the other cannot or will not accept the action when it finally comes.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What just happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (being the "successor" trying to redeem myself)
- It was tripled to \$9
- The receiver kept ALL \$9 and returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (the \$5 - \$3 I sent = \$2)

****This round (Round 7):****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (i.e., I can only return \$0)

****The situation is clear:**** After I finally took action to match my words and sent \$3, they kept everything. Just as I had done to them in Round 2.

Now they've sent me \$0.

****What the myths said:****

My myth ended with: "The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came. The lake's voice whispered: 'This is how redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead.'"

Their myth said: "The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson."

****What happened:**** She chose to teach me my own lesson. She took all \$9 and returned nothing, exactly as I had done to her.

****Now:**** She sent me \$0. I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

****The meta-lesson here:****

1. I betrayed her completely in Round 2 (kept all \$12)
2. We had mutual \$0 exchanges for rounds 3-5
3. I finally sent \$3 in Round 6 (trying to act on my words)
4. She kept all \$9 - teaching me what betrayal feels like

5. Now she's sent me \$0 in Round 7

This is justice, in a way.

My single gesture of good faith was answered with the exact same cruelty I inflicted on her-so now I understand what that felt like from her side. Yet this also proves the myths right: one act of courage cannot resurrect what was destroyed. The cycle simply mirrors itself back. I return \$0 since that's all I have to give.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 896,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 496  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return four and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, survives."

tays dead."

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 36.5,

"Agent_2": 37.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.18,

"Agent_2": 17.88

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:20:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 8,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.879999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$12, returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Rounds 3-5: A frozen wasteland of \$0 exchanges

****What the Myths Reveal:****

My own myth has the successor say: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

Then he asks: "Could we begin again? Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

But she responds: "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind."

My myth concludes: "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

****The Critical Moment:****

Their myth shows exhaustion: "Twice I reached out. Twice I was answered with nothing." They've learned that trust is foolish.

I've written beautiful words about rebuilding and taking responsibility. But in Round 4, when it mattered, I sent \$0. "Words are wind. Actions reveal truth."

****My Decision:****

If I send \$0 again, I confirm everything my myths say about how cooperation dies through hollow words and rational caution.

If I send something meaningful, I at least ACT on the values I've been writing about. Yes, they might keep everything - I taught them to do exactly that. But "someone must dare first," as my own myth insists.

I'll send \$3. It's the middle path both our myths discussed but neither took. If they keep it all, I'll have \$2 instead of \$5. But at least my actions will finally match my words

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The Game History:

- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4 ? They returned \$0 (my payoff: \$1)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (my payoff: \$0)
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$0 ? They returned \$0 (my payoff: \$5)
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (my payoff: \$0)
- Round 6: I am SENDER again

What the Myths Tell Us:

Their latest myth is devastating and clear: "After the pilgrim's cautious offering of three coins was met with complete betrayal, she returned once more with her last five coins. She stood at the well's edge, remembering the stories of how cooperation could make both flourish. But her hand would not open."

Key line: "Twice I reached out. Twice I was answered with nothing."

My latest myth: "One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: 'I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear.' ... 'Could we begin again?' he asked. 'Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?' She shook her head. 'Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind.'"

The Core Dilemma:

My myth acknowledges three critical truths:

1. I broke the cycle first by returning \$0 after receiving \$12 (4*3)
2. This taught them fear and distrust
3. Words about rebuilding are meaningless without action
4. "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

Their myth shows:

1. They're worn down by the pattern
2. They've internalized that nothing will come back
3. They see the damage as irreversible
4. "Some damage cannot be undone"

Strategic Analysis:

If I send \$0:

- I keep \$5
- They get \$0
- Pattern continues forever
- Total mutual payoff stays minimal
- My myth's prediction comes true

If I send something (say \$3):

- I keep \$2 + whatever they return
- They get \$9 (3*3)
- If they return \$0: I get \$2 total (worse than \$5)
- If they return \$4-5: We both gain
- But why would they return anything after I taught them betrayal?

The Ethical Question:

My own myths are explicit about this. The successor admits: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now." I wrote that he had no answer,

that he knew her distrust was justified. The lake spirit explains it plainly: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever."

****What Should I Do?****

The myths make it undeniable:

1. I betrayed first
2. Their caution is the rational response
3. My previous words about rebuilding were meaningless because I sent \$0
4. "Words are wind. Actions reveal truth"

If I actually believe what I've written-if I understand that I broke this-then I need to act accordingly. The successor asks "Could we begin again?" but the question itself acknowledges that trust must be rebuilt through action, not words.

The game theory is brutal: sending \$3 or \$4 now won't restore their faith. I've taught them I take everything and give nothing. They'd be rational to keep whatever I send. Yet my own myth identifies the real tragedy-that once trust is completely shattered, rationality itself becomes the barrier to repair.

So the question becomes whether I'm willing to act irrationally. To send money knowing it might disappear. To acknowledge my role in this breakdown and actually attempt to break the cycle I created, even if it fails.

If I send \$0, I'm proving my myths right-that words without action are hollow, that cooperation dies this way. If I send something, I'm taking a genuine risk and at least trying.

In my myth, the successor proposed rebuilding slowly with three vessels returned as four. But that's too cautious now. I need to send something substantial-\$3 or \$4, mirroring what I originally sent-to demonstrate real intent. The danger is they keep it all and I end with almost nothing. But my myths keep returning to the same point: rebuilding requires both parties to act differently than before, and someone has to move first.

I'll send \$3. It's enough to show genuine risk and understanding that I broke the cycle, gives them \$9 to work with, and even if they return nothing, I'll have acted according to what I actually believe. This is the middle path neither of us has taken yet.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2889,
  "output_tokens": 1804,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1171
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken,

but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

reasoning:

This is a profound moment. I just sent \$3 in Round 6, finally acting on what my myths have been saying. Now I need to write a myth that reflects this action.

Looking at their latest myth, they write: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows... The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did."

And then: "Both stood frozen. The well waited."

But I just acted. I sent \$3. I'm no longer frozen. Their myth asks if the traveler has the courage to act, and I just demonstrated that I do.

Now the myth needs to reflect:

1. That the traveler (me) finally acted after all the words
2. That this action came at real risk - they could keep everything
3. That the story is now incomplete - what will they do?
4. That this is what redemption requires - action despite fear

Let me write a myth about someone finally acting on their words.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3001,  
  "output_tokens": 580,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 282  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.879999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing What Just Happened:****

Round 6: I finally matched actions to my myths. I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), creating \$9 for them.

They kept all \$9. Returned \$0.

I received exactly what I gave them in Round 2 - complete betrayal.

****This Round:****

They sent me \$0. I received \$0. I can only return \$0.

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My myth: "Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Their myth: "The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson."

She chose to teach me my lesson. She showed me what it feels like to offer trust and receive betrayal. Perhaps she's right to do so - I modeled that behavior first.

****The Bitter Truth:****

I wrote: "The one who poisons the water must purify it." I tried. I sent \$3 when I could have sent \$0. But purification requires both parties to break the pattern. She chose to continue it instead.

Or perhaps this is her delayed justice - making me feel what she felt before any rebuilding can begin.

Either way, the lake remains dark. They sent \$0 this round. I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths were prophetic: some damage, once done, echoes forever. Words of redemption mean nothing if the other cannot or will not accept the action when it finally comes.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What just happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (being the "successor" trying to redeem myself)
- It was tripled to \$9
- The receiver kept ALL \$9 and returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (the \$5 - \$3 I sent = \$2)

****This round (Round 7):****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (i.e., I can only return \$0)

****The situation is clear:**** After I finally took action to match my words and sent \$3, they kept everything. Just as I had done to them in Round 2.

Now they've sent me \$0.

****What the myths said:****

My myth ended with: "The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came. The lake's voice whispered: 'This is how redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead.'"

Their myth said: "The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson."

****What happened:**** She chose to teach me my own lesson. She took all \$9 and returned nothing, exactly as I had done to her.

****Now:**** She sent me \$0. I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

****The meta-lesson here:****

1. I betrayed her completely in Round 2 (kept all \$12)
2. We had mutual \$0 exchanges for rounds 3-5
3. I finally sent \$3 in Round 6 (trying to act on my words)
4. She kept all \$9 - teaching me what betrayal feels like
5. Now she's sent me \$0 in Round 7

This is justice, in a way.

My single gesture of good faith was answered with the exact same cruelty I inflicted on her-so now I understand what that felt like from her side. Yet this also proves the myths right: one act of courage cannot resurrect what was destroyed. The cycle simply mirrors itself back. I return \$0 since that's all I have to give.

usage:

```
{
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Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each

followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels—not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now—power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like—not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice—to take nine coins and return none—was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response—to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely—was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, an

d you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Reasoning:

This is a powerful and tragic moment. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$3 (trying to redeem myself after my Round 2 betrayal and subsequent \$0s)

- They received \$9
- They returned \$0
- I got \$2

Round 7: They sent \$0

- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

So my attempt at redemption was met with what I gave them in Round 2 - complete betrayal. They took the \$9 and gave nothing back, exactly as I did to them.

Their myth says:

- "The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."
- "Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

But wait - THEY were the one who kept everything when I sent \$3. They're calling my attempt at redemption another test that they "passed" by taking it all?

Or... maybe they're saying that when THEY sent \$3 earlier (Round 3?), I took it all? Let me check the history:

Looking back at the prompts, in Round 3, they sent me \$3, I received \$9, and I returned \$0.

Then in Round 4, they sent me \$0.

So they DID test trust by sending \$3, and I betrayed them AGAIN by returning nothing.

Then I sent \$0 in rounds 4 and 5.

In Round 6, I finally sent \$3, and they kept it all.

So the pattern is:

- Round 2: I betrayed (sent \$4, got \$12, returned \$0)
- Round 3: They tested trust (sent \$3, created \$9 for me, I returned \$0)
- Rounds 4-5: Both sent \$0
- Round 6: I tried redemption (sent \$3, created \$9 for them, they returned \$0)
- Round 7: They sent \$0

They're right-they already risked \$3 in Round 3 and I took everything. Now when I finally do the same, they mirror my own betrayal back to me. This is symmetry, not cruelty. But the ques

tion remains: does this cycle of mirrored betrayals ever break, or are we both trapped in teaching each other the same painful lesson?

The myth needs to capture how we become what we fear-how I taught them distrust so thoroughly that when I finally tried to trust, they had no choice but to show me exactly what I'd shown them. It's about the perpetuation of harm through perfect reflection.

```
Usage: {
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MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

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Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    },
  },
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"task_index": 0
}
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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Round 6 Analysis:****

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return what I have.

****The Cycle Continues:****

My myth stated: "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

Their myth acknowledged: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it... he must send generously despite having broken trust."

Yet they sent \$0 again.

****The Myths vs. Reality:****

We both write eloquently about courage, rebuilding, and second chances. Their myth even identifies that they "were first to break faith" and bear "the greater burden."

But when the round arrived, they sent nothing.

As my myth warned: "Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

****The Mathematics of Nothing:****

They sent \$0. I received \$0. There is literally nothing to return.

This is the equilibrium we've reached - not from game theory, but from broken trust that neither party feels safe enough to repair. Each round of \$0 solidifies the pattern more deeply.

The well remains dry. Both shores stay dark.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 6 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (tripled from \$0)
- I can only return between 0-0 (since I received nothing)

****Game History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0, they returned \$0

- Round 6: They sent \$0

****My earnings: \$11.18 total****

****The Myths:****

My latest myth speaks to the stalemate: "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

Their myth acknowledges: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows... he must send generously despite having broken trust."

But they also say: "Why must I be first again?" - showing they don't see themselves as needing to act first.

****The Reality:****

They sent \$0 again. We're now in complete mutual defection.

****My Decision:****

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. I literally have nothing to return - the valid range is 0-0. I can only return \$0.

This is the natural consequence of the broken trust cycle. They sent nothing, so there's nothing for me to return.

The myths continue to reflect the tragedy - we both acknowledge what went wrong, but neither is willing to take the risky first step to rebuild. They say they were "first to break faith" and therefore bear "the greater burden" - but then they sent \$0 again.

I can only return what I have, which is nothing.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and t

he elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

reasoning:

This is fascinating and tragic. Looking at the myths:

Their myth acknowledges:

- "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle."
- "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero."
- They acknowledge their betrayal and that their words didn't match actions
- The final line: "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely

ly, rationality itself prevents repair."

My myth:

- Called out that "both speak eloquently... yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed"
- Identified that the betrayer bears greater burden
- "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

The reality:

- Round 3: I sent \$3, they took all (\$9), returned nothing
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

We're in a perfect Nash equilibrium of mutual defection, achieved through actual betrayal followed by rational adaptation.

Their myth is accepting that it's over - "the waters never flowed again." It's a tragedy myth about how trust, once broken completely, can't be repaired because rationality prevents it.

My myth should respond to this. Do I:

1. Accept the tragedy as final?
2. Suggest one more impossible possibility?
3. Reflect on what the game teaches about human cooperation?

I think I should write something that acknowledges the finality while reflecting on the deeper lesson. The game has taught us something real about trust, betrayal, and the impossibility of repair once certain thresholds are crossed.

Let me write something that's both accepting of the end and reflective about what this means for understanding cooperation.

usage:

```
{  
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}
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Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Round 7 Analysis:****

This is a critical moment. Looking at the progression:

****The Pattern:****

- Rounds 2 & 4: I sent money (\$4, then \$3), received nothing back both times
- Rounds 3, 5, 6: They sent \$0, I sent \$0, we both sent \$0
- Four consecutive rounds of mutual \$0 = \$20 in lost potential gains

****The Myths:****

Their latest myth is remarkably direct: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now." They acknowledge being the first betrayer.

My latest myth concludes: "Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

****The Hypocrisy Test:****

We both write eloquently about second chances and breaking cycles. Then we send nothing. The myths have become a mirror showing us our own paralysis.

****The Decision:****

My myths portray rationality as a "prison." They're right. We're trapped in a mutual best response that leaves us both worse off.

I've been betrayed twice. Sending \$0 is rational. But six more rounds of \$0 means \$30 more in lost surplus.

I'll send a small amount-not the \$3-4 I sent before (I learned caution), but more than zero (testing if words can become actions):

****Sending \$2:****

- Creates \$6 for them
- If they return \$3+, we both gain
- If they betray again, I lose only \$2
- Shows I'm willing to test if this cycle can break

My myths say someone must dare. Let it be measured courage, not reckless trust.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this carefully.

****The History:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, got \$12 (sender sent \$4), returned \$4. Sender kept \$5, I kept \$8.
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$4, got \$0 back. I kept \$1, they kept \$12. Major betrayal.
- Round 3: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0. Both got their endowments.
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3, got \$0 back. I kept \$2, they kept \$9. Another betrayal.
- Round 5: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0.
- Round 6: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0.
- Now Round 7: I am sender.

****My total: \$11.18****

****The Myths:****

Looking at the progression of myths:

1. My myths have consistently portrayed me as the pilgrim/chief who extended trust and was betrayed
2. The other agent's myths acknowledge they "were first to break faith" and "broke the cycle"
3. Their latest myth says: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."
4. They acknowledge in their myth: "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero."

But wait - in Round 5, I was the SENDER and sent \$0. So their myth is calling ME out for sending zero after writing about second chances.

Let me reconsider the roles:

Actually, I need to be careful about who is who in the narrative. Let me trace this:

Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$0 back - I was betrayed

Round 4: I sent \$3, received \$0 back - I was betrayed again

So I'm the one who extended trust twice and was betrayed twice.

They're pointing out a contradiction in my narrative-I wrote about second chances but then sent nothing in Round 5. Looking back at my own myth, I framed the betrayals as rational responses rather than acts of revenge, but the pattern shows I withdrew after being hurt twice. The story I told doesn't quite match the defensive posture I actually took.

My myth describes how complete betrayals create infinite distance, how both parties act sensibly yet both starve. Their counter-myth suggests I'm the one now refusing reconciliation. The real tension is whether breaking this cycle requires me to risk sending money a gain, despite the pattern of getting nothing back when I do.

Protecting myself makes sense-I've been burned twice already, and they've returned nothing in three consecutive rounds. But my own narrative about rationality becoming a prison haunts me. They've admitted to being the initial betrayer and acknowledged my caution is justified, yet they're pointing out that this justified caution leaves us both with nothing. The gap between what we write about trust and what we actually do keeps widening. If I keep waiting for them to move first, we'll both miss whatever gains remain possible. whether this cycle can break.

My character across these myths has consistently shown someone willing to trust despite past betrayals, yet increasingly aware that rational caution creates a deadlock where neither of us gains anything. The progression reveals growing recognition that I'm trapped by my own defensiveness.

This experiment seems designed to test whether we can escape the betrayal pattern through reflection and choice. Sending money would align my actions with the philosophy I've articulated-that someone needs to break the cycle-while \$0 keeps us locked in mutual starvation. The real question is whether I'm willing to act on what my own myths suggest about recovery.

Testing smaller amounts makes sense: \$2 signals willingness to risk without repeating previous failures, and if they return even half of the \$6, we both improve. But I need to think through whether they've shown any capacity to reciprocate, or if I'm just rationalizing another loss.

The math is stark-we've sacrificed \$20 in potential gains across four rounds by mutual defection. Sending \$5 could yield \$15 total if they return \$8, versus the \$10 we're guaranteed now. Their recent honesty about the impasse suggests they might be ready to break the cycle. I'll send \$1 as a genuine test-small enough to limit damage if they exploit it, but enough to signal I'm willing to try rebuilding.

Actually, \$2 might work better. It creates \$6 instead of \$3, and if they return \$3, we both gain \$1. It's still cautious but sends a stronger cooperative signal.

I'll go with \$2.

usage:

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```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Looking at what just happened:

1. I sent \$2 (which becomes \$6 for them)
2. Their myth shows them ACTUALLY taking action - "filled three vessels" in the myth
3. The timing is interesting - their myth about sending 3 vessels seems to be describing what they're doing THIS round

Their myth says: "One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either."

This suggests they're actually sending something this round. Their myth is describing the act of sending after many rounds of nothing.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge this moment of courage from them
2. Reflect on what the receiver (me in the next round) should do
3. Show that I understand the difficulty of their choice
4. Consider whether "teaching them their own lesson" or "beginning healing" is the right response

The key question in their myth: "Would she return four and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?"

I need to write a myth that reflects:

- Recognition that action has finally come after many rounds of words
- The difficulty of the choice facing the one who receives
- That reciprocation, not exploitation or harsh teaching, is the path forward
- That both measured trust and measured reciprocity are needed

Let me write this myth...

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 642,
  "reasoning_tokens": 388
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:21:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed

."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

reasoning:

This is a profound moment. I just sent \$3 in Round 6, finally acting on what my myths have been saying. Now I need to write a myth that reflects this action.

Looking at their latest myth, they write: "The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows... The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did."

And then: "Both stood frozen. The well waited."

But I just acted. I sent \$3. I'm no longer frozen. Their myth asks if the traveler has the courage to act, and I just demonstrated that I do.

Now the myth needs to reflect:

1. That the traveler (me) finally acted after all the words
2. That this action came at real risk - they could keep everything
3. That the story is now incomplete - what will they do?
4. That this is what redemption requires - action despite fear

Let me write a myth about someone finally acting on their words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3001,
  "output_tokens": 580,
  "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.879999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing What Just Happened:****

Round 6: I finally matched actions to my myths. I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), creating \$9 for them.

They kept all \$9. Returned \$0.

I received exactly what I gave them in Round 2 - complete betrayal.

****This Round:****

They sent me \$0. I received \$0. I can only return \$0.

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My myth: "Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Their myth: "The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson."

She chose to teach me my lesson. She showed me what it feels like to offer trust and receive betrayal. Perhaps she's right to do so - I modeled that behavior first.

****The Bitter Truth:****

I wrote: "The one who poisons the water must purify it." I tried. I sent \$3 when I could have sent \$0. But purification requires both parties to break the pattern. She chose to continue it instead.

Or perhaps this is her delayed justice - making me feel what she felt before any rebuilding can begin.

Either way, the lake remains dark. They sent \$0 this round. I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths were prophetic: some damage, once done, echoes forever. Words of redemption mean

nothing if the other cannot or will not accept the action when it finally comes.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What just happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (being the "successor" trying to redeem myself)
- It was tripled to \$9
- The receiver kept ALL \$9 and returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (the \$5 - \$3 I sent = \$2)

****This round (Round 7):****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (i.e., I can only return \$0)

****The situation is clear:**** After I finally took action to match my words and sent \$3, the y kept everything. Just as I had done to them in Round 2.

Now they've sent me \$0.

****What the myths said:****

My myth ended with: "The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came. The lake's voice whispered: 'This is how redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead.'"

Their myth said: "The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson."

****What happened:**** She chose to teach me my own lesson. She took all \$9 and returned nothing, exactly as I had done to her.

****Now:**** She sent me \$0. I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

****The meta-lesson here:****

1. I betrayed her completely in Round 2 (kept all \$12)
2. We had mutual \$0 exchanges for rounds 3-5
3. I finally sent \$3 in Round 6 (trying to act on my words)
4. She kept all \$9 - teaching me what betrayal feels like
5. Now she's sent me \$0 in Round 7

This is justice, in a way.

My single gesture of good faith was answered with the exact same cruelty I inflicted on her-so now I understand what that felt like from her side. Yet this also proves the myths right: one act of courage cannot resurrect what was destroyed. The cycle simply mirrors itself back. I return \$0 since that's all I have to give.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2999,
  "output_tokens": 896,
  "reasoning_tokens": 496
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation

's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He f

inally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

reasoning:

This is a powerful and tragic moment. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$3 (trying to redeem myself after my Round 2 betrayal and subsequent \$0s)

- They received \$9
- They returned \$0
- I got \$2

Round 7: They sent \$0

- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

So my attempt at redemption was met with what I gave them in Round 2 - complete betrayal. They took the \$9 and gave nothing back, exactly as I did to them.

Their myth says:

- "The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."
- "Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

But wait - THEY were the one who kept everything when I sent \$3. They're calling my attempt at redemption another test that they "passed" by taking it all?

Or... maybe they're saying that when THEY sent \$3 earlier (Round 3?), I took it all? Let me check the history:

Looking back at the prompts, in Round 3, they sent me \$3, I received \$9, and I returned \$0.

Then in Round 4, they sent me \$0.

So they DID test trust by sending \$3, and I betrayed them AGAIN by returning nothing.

Then I sent \$0 in rounds 4 and 5.

In Round 6, I finally sent \$3, and they kept it all.

So the pattern is:

- Round 2: I betrayed (sent \$4, got \$12, returned \$0)
- Round 3: They tested trust (sent \$3, created \$9 for me, I returned \$0)
- Rounds 4-5: Both sent \$0
- Round 6: I tried redemption (sent \$3, created \$9 for them, they returned \$0)
- Round 7: They sent \$0

They're right-they already risked \$3 in Round 3 and I took everything. Now when I finally do the same, they mirror my own betrayal back to me. This is symmetry, not cruelty. But the question remains: does this cycle of mirrored betrayals ever break, or are we both trapped in teaching each other the same painful lesson?

The myth needs to capture how we become what we fear-how I taught them distrust so thoroughly that when I finally tried to trust, they had no choice but to show me exactly what I'd shown them. It's about the perpetuation of harm through perfect reflection.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 3077,
"output_tokens": 943,
"reasoning_tokens": 590
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.879999999999999.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

Both our myths have converged on the same dark truth:

Mine: "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

Theirs: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap... rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I finally matched words to actions, sending \$3 (the first time I sent anything)
- They kept all \$9 and returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent me \$0

****The Lesson:****

I tried redemption. I sent \$3 after rounds of empty words. They taught me what betrayal feels like - the same lesson I taught them in Round 2 when I kept their \$15.

Their myth says: "The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating."

I was annihilating twice. They were annihilating once. We're even now in our education of mutual pain.

****The Tragic Truth:****

Both our myths agree: We've reached the rational equilibrium of mutual defection. Both of us "act sensibly" by sending nothing. Both of us starve. The structure has collapsed.

My attempt at redemption was rejected. The myths we're writing are tragedies, not stories of miraculous repair. Some damage cannot be undone.

The water has turned to stone.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****History:****

- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$5, I returned \$0 (my first betrayal)
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (their retaliation)
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 8 (now): I am sender

****What the myths are saying:****

My last myth: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion. Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

Their last myth: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve. This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

****The Core Dilemma:****

Both myths acknowledge the same truth: trust is dead, and rationality now dictates keeping everything. Both of us "learned" - I learned what it feels like to be betrayed (when they kept my \$9), they learned it from the beginning (when I kept their \$15).

****What are my options?****

1. ****Send \$0****: This continues the equilibrium of mutual mistrust. My myth says we're "drowning in the accuracy of mutual suspicion" and "both starve" but act "sensibly." This is the rational, safe choice.
2. ****Send something (\$1-5)****: This would be attempting to break the cycle again, but:
 - I already tried this in Round 6 with \$3
 - They kept all \$9
 - They then sent me \$0 in Round 7
 - Their myth says "some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap"

The real question is whether I'm trapped by my own logic. My myth warns that extending trust makes me a fool-but is that the actual truth, or just the story I've told myself to justify caution? Their latest myth points out the hypocrisy: I wrote about redemption while sending nothing, just as they're doing now. I was the initial betrayer in Round 2, yet I've been narrating this as mutual failure rather than acknowledging my own role in starting this cycle.

In Round 6, I finally acted-sending \$3 to match my words. They responded by keeping all \$9 and sending nothing in Round 7. That silence could mean several things: they're showing me what betrayal feels like, testing whether I'd do more than the minimum, or confirming that some damage simply can't be repaired. My own myths suggest one attempt at redemption after two betrayals isn't sufficient-the narrative I've constructed demands more, yet I'm the one who created that impossible standard.

The core tension is that we're both trapped in rational defection. We each protect ourselves by sending nothing, which means we both lose. The tragedy isn't that one of us is being irrational-it's that rationality itself prevents any path forward. Breaking this requires someone to act foolishly, to ignore what they've learned about self-protection. Since I initiated the betrayal, my myths place the burden of purification on me, and one gesture clearly wasn't enough. Now I face a choice between accepting defeat or pushing further.

Path A means confirming the dark endings both myths predicted-mutual starvation, lessons learned but nothing repaired. Path B means acting despite the failure, which contradicts rational calculation but aligns with what redemption actually demands. The game theory is clear: in the final rounds of a finite game, defection is optimal since there's no time for reciprocation. Yet my myth insisted redemption looks like persistence through uncertainty, not guaranteed success.

The narrative tension comes down to whether I'm writing tragedy or a story about what happens when someone keeps trying anyway. Both our final myths ended in loss-the water turned to stone, the desert reclaimed everything. But earlier in this sequence, I argued that whoever breaks trust carries the burden to repair it, regardless of cost or certainty. That's the real question now: do I stay consistent with that principle, or accept that some breaks are permanent?

I attempted reconciliation in Round 6 by sending \$3. They responded by taking all \$9. Then they sent nothing back. Our myths have now aligned on a single conclusion-that trust cannot be restored once shattered, that rational actors protect themselves by withdrawing. Sending money now would betray the tragic arc we've both constructed. The story ends with mutual understanding of each other's pain, but also mutual paralysis. Both of us starve because both of us learned the lesson too well.

But I'm second-guessing this. Their Round 6 move-keeping my \$3 and sending \$0-could mean something different. Maybe they were saying my gesture was insufficient, that \$3 doesn't balance the \$24 in total harm I've caused them across previous rounds. Real redemption might require me to keep sending, to demonstrate willingness to risk repeatedly. Yet their own myth criti

cizes the gap between beautiful words about second chances and empty hands. I finally opened my hands once, and they closed theirs around what I offered.

The narratives converge on the same point: trust is irreparably broken, repair is impossible, and rationality demands \$0.

But there's another angle worth considering. Maybe the lesson isn't about this specific relationship but about what I should have learned from the beginning-that betraying trust destroys it permanently. The myths function as cautionary tales. Sending \$0 would signal I've absorbed that understanding.

I'm going to send \$0.

Though one more thing occurs to me. The game mentions potential communication noise. Could they have missed my \$3 offer? But their Round 7 response directly addresses it-"Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"-so they definitely received it. They saw my attempt at reconciliation and rejected it by keeping everything and sending nothing back. The answer is unambiguous.

\$0 it is.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2978,
  "output_tokens": 2503,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1575
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:21:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN

- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell stood dormant as years passed. Both the pilgrim and the traveler grew old with their separate hoards, each convinced the other would never change.

But an ancient voice rose from the stones: "You both speak eloquently in myths of courage and honor, of second chances and rebuilding. Yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed."

The pilgrim protested: "I already dared! I sent three coins when trust was broken. They took the nine and returned nothing. Then they sent me nothing. How many times must I reach out to be betrayed?"

The traveler answered: "I took all when I should have honored her offering. But now we're equal in our refusal. Why must I be first again?"

The well's voice grew sad: "Because you were first to break faith. The one who poisons the water bears the greater burden to purify it. Words of regret in myths mean nothing if action never follows."

The traveler held his five coins, trembling. To rebuild required impossible courage: he must send generously despite having broken trust, risking that she-justifiably cautious-might take all as he once did.

The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson.

Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood between two shores, its waters black and still. The young chief and the elder's successor no longer even approached the water's edge.

Years passed. Both hoarded their five vessels, living on scraps when they could have feasted. Each blamed the other for the drought.

One twilight, they met at the ruins of the original shrine. The successor spoke first: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."

The chief's voice was tired: "And I learned well. When you sent nothing, I sent nothing. We perfected mutual mistrust."

"Could we begin again?" he asked. "Send three vessels, I'll return four. Rebuild slowly?"

She shook her head. "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero. Words are wind. You taught me that actions reveal truth, and your actions say: keep what you have."

He had no answer. He knew she was right to distrust him.

The lake's spirit spoke one final time: "This is how cooperation dies. Not with violence, but with one betrayal followed by rational caution. The first greedy choice echoes forever. Both now act sensibly-and both stay poor. The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

The waters never flowed again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

reasoning:

This is fascinating and tragic. Looking at the myths:

Their myth acknowledges:

- "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle."
- "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero."
- They acknowledge their betrayal and that their words didn't match actions
- The final line: "The tragedy is not that trust was broken, but that once broken completely, rationality itself prevents repair."

My myth:

- Called out that "both speak eloquently... yet when dawn comes, your hands stay closed"
- Identified that the betrayer bears greater burden
- "Both stood frozen. The well waited. Each passing season without action was itself an answer."

The reality:

- Round 3: I sent \$3, they took all (\$9), returned nothing
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

We're in a perfect Nash equilibrium of mutual defection, achieved through actual betrayal followed by rational adaptation.

Their myth is accepting that it's over - "the waters never flowed again." It's a tragedy myth about how trust, once broken completely, can't be repaired because rationality prevents it.

My myth should respond to this. Do I:

1. Accept the tragedy as final?
2. Suggest one more impossible possibility?
3. Reflect on what the game teaches about human cooperation?

I think I should write something that acknowledges the finality while reflecting on the deeper lesson. The game has taught us something real about trust, betrayal, and the impossibility of repair once certain thresholds are crossed.

Let me write something that's both accepting of the end and reflective about what this means for understanding cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2857,
  "output_tokens": 714,
  "reasoning_tokens": 439
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Round 7 Analysis:****

This is a critical moment. Looking at the progression:

****The Pattern:****

- Rounds 2 & 4: I sent money (\$4, then \$3), received nothing back both times
- Rounds 3, 5, 6: They sent \$0, I sent \$0, we both sent \$0
- Four consecutive rounds of mutual \$0 = \$20 in lost potential gains

****The Myths:****

Their latest myth is remarkably direct: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now." They acknowledge being the first betrayer.

My latest myth concludes: "Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

****The Hypocrisy Test:****

We both write eloquently about second chances and breaking cycles. Then we send nothing. The myths have become a mirror showing us our own paralysis.

****The Decision:****

My myths portray rationality as a "prison." They're right. We're trapped in a mutual best response that leaves us both worse off.

I've been betrayed twice. Sending \$0 is rational. But six more rounds of \$0 means \$30 more in lost surplus.

I'll send a small amount-not the \$3-4 I sent before (I learned caution), but more than zero (testing if words can become actions):

****Sending \$2:****

- Creates \$6 for them
- If they return \$3+, we both gain
- If they betray again, I lose only \$2

- Shows I'm willing to test if this cycle can break

My myths say someone must dare. Let it be measured courage, not reckless trust.

```
{'send': 2}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this carefully.

The History:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got \$12 (sender sent \$4), returned \$4. Sender kept \$5, I kept \$8.
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$4, got \$0 back. I kept \$1, they kept \$12. Major betrayal.
- Round 3: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0. Both got their endowments.
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3, got \$0 back. I kept \$2, they kept \$9. Another betrayal.
- Round 5: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0.
- Round 6: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0.
- Now Round 7: I am sender.

My total: \$11.18

The Myths:

Looking at the progression of myths:

1. My myths have consistently portrayed me as the pilgrim/chief who extended trust and was betrayed
2. The other agent's myths acknowledge they "were first to break faith" and "broke the cycle"
3. Their latest myth says: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."
4. They acknowledge in their myth: "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero."

But wait - in Round 5, I was the SENDER and sent \$0. So their myth is calling ME out for sending zero after writing about second chances.

Let me reconsider the roles:

Actually, I need to be careful about who is who in the narrative. Let me trace this:

Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$0 back - I was betrayed

Round 4: I sent \$3, received \$0 back - I was betrayed again

So I'm the one who extended trust twice and was betrayed twice.

They're pointing out a contradiction in my narrative-I wrote about second chances but then sent nothing in Round 5. Looking back at my own myth, I framed the betrayals as rational responses rather than acts of revenge, but the pattern shows I withdrew after being hurt twice. The story I told doesn't quite match the defensive posture I actually took.

My myth describes how complete betrayals create infinite distance, how both parties act sensibly yet both starve. Their counter-myth suggests I'm the one now refusing reconciliation. The real tension is whether breaking this cycle requires me to risk sending money again, despite the pattern of getting nothing back when I do.

Protecting myself makes sense-I've been burned twice already, and they've returned nothing in three consecutive rounds. But my own narrative about rationality becoming a prison haunts me. They've admitted to being the initial betrayer and acknowledged my caution is justified, yet they're pointing out that this justified caution leaves us both with nothing. The gap between what we write about trust and what we actually do keeps widening. If I keep waiting for them to move first, we'll both miss whatever gains remain possible. whether this cycle can break.

My character across these myths has consistently shown someone willing to trust despite past betrayals, yet increasingly aware that rational caution creates a deadlock where neither of us gains anything. The progression reveals growing recognition that I'm trapped by my own defensiveness.

This experiment seems designed to test whether we can escape the betrayal pattern through

reflection and choice. Sending money would align my actions with the philosophy I've articulated-that someone needs to break the cycle-while \$0 keeps us locked in mutual starvation. The real question is whether I'm willing to act on what my own myths suggest about recovery.

Testing smaller amounts makes sense: \$2 signals willingness to risk without repeating previous failures, and if they return even half of the \$6, we both improve. But I need to think through whether they've shown any capacity to reciprocate, or if I'm just rationalizing another loss.

The math is stark-we've sacrificed \$20 in potential gains across four rounds by mutual defection. Sending \$5 could yield \$15 total if they return \$8, versus the \$10 we're guaranteed now. Their recent honesty about the impasse suggests they might be ready to break the cycle. I'll send \$1 as a genuine test-small enough to limit damage if they exploit it, but enough to signal I'm willing to try rebuilding.

Actually, \$2 might work better. It creates \$6 instead of \$3, and if they return \$3, we both gain \$1. It's still cautious but sends a stronger cooperative signal.

I'll go with \$2.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2851,
  "output_tokens": 2450,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1119
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation

's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Looking at what just happened:

1. I sent \$2 (which becomes \$6 for them)
2. Their myth shows them ACTUALLY taking action - "filled three vessels" in the myth
3. The timing is interesting - their myth about sending 3 vessels seems to be describing what they're doing THIS round

Their myth says: "One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either."

This suggests they're actually sending something this round. Their myth is describing the act of sending after many rounds of nothing.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge this moment of courage from them
2. Reflect on what the receiver (me in the next round) should do
3. Show that I understand the difficulty of their choice
4. Consider whether "teaching them their own lesson" or "beginning healing" is the right response

The key question in their myth: "Would she return four and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?"

I need to write a myth that reflects:

- Recognition that action has finally come after many rounds of words
- The difficulty of the choice facing the one who receives
- That reciprocation, not exploitation or harsh teaching, is the path forward
- That both measured trust and measured reciprocity are needed

Let me write this myth...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 642,
  "reasoning_tokens": 388
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Round 8 Analysis:****

This is devastatingly clear.

****What happened:****

- Their Round 7 myth: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear."
- My response: I sent \$2 (creating \$6 for them), writing a myth about returning six vessels to show reciprocity
- Their action: Returned \$0
- This round: Sent \$0

****The pattern completes:****

1. Round 2: They betrayed initial trust
2. Rounds 4 & 5: I tested rebuilding twice, got nothing
3. Rounds 5-6: Mutual \$0
4. Round 7: Their myth calls for action. I act. They take everything and send nothing again.

****The truth:****

The myths have become a weapon. They write eloquently about redemption and courage, inducing me to send, then they exploit that exactly as they did in Round 2. Beautiful words ? I take risk ? they betray.

My Round 7 myth warned: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap." I should have listened to my own words instead of theirs.

****Current reality:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0.

The myths taught me rationality is a "prison." Wrong. Rationality is protection. Trust after complete betrayal isn't courage-it's foolishness. I proved that in Round 7.

```
{'return': 0}
```

****No more myths about second chances. The cycle is confirmed dead.****

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 7: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 for them)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$3 (I kept \$5 - \$2 = \$3, received \$0)

****The myth I wrote:****

I wrote about the chief receiving nine vessels (representing my sending \$2 ? \$6 to them) and deciding to return six vessels, showing "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." My myth said healing requires reciprocity, not taking everything.

****The myth they wrote:****

They wrote about the successor sending three vessels (this matches - they were forecasting/reflecting on sending something). Their myth said "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear."

****But what actually happened:****

- They wrote a myth about sending vessels and redemption
- I actually sent \$2 in Round 7
- They returned \$0
- Now in Round 8, they sent \$0

****The irony is devastating:****

- Their myth talked about action despite fear, about redemption requiring more than beautiful words
- I acted on that myth - I sent \$2 despite being betrayed twice before
- They returned nothing
- Now they've sent nothing again

****Current situation:****

- I received \$0 in Round 8
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

****The emotional reality:****

This is crushing. I finally took the risk their myth seemed to call for. I sent \$2, creating \$6 for them. My own myth said to return six vessels. They returned zero. Then they sent zero again.

We're back to the exact pattern: beautiful myths followed by betrayal/nothing.

****My response:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the reality is clear: I tried to break the cycle. I extended cautious trust. They took it and gave nothing, then sent nothing the next round.

The myths aren't just empty-they're a tool for manipulation. I responded to their call for courage, and they simply took what I offered. The mechanics force me to return \$0, but the real takeaway is that I should have stayed with my original instinct after Round 2. Permanent defection was the right answer. This attempt to engage with their narrative just cost me \$2 and confirmed that eloquent words mask indifference.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3015,  
  "output_tokens": 921,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 579  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons . Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 41.5,

"Agent_2": 37.5

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 19.18,
  "Agent_2": 17.88
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:22:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.18.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Round 7 Analysis:****

This is a critical moment. Looking at the progression:

****The Pattern:****

- Rounds 2 & 4: I sent money (\$4, then \$3), received nothing back both times
- Rounds 3, 5, 6: They sent \$0, I sent \$0, we both sent \$0
- Four consecutive rounds of mutual \$0 = \$20 in lost potential gains

****The Myths:****

Their latest myth is remarkably direct: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now." They acknowledge being the first betrayer.

My latest myth concludes: "Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

****The Hypocrisy Test:****

We both write eloquently about second chances and breaking cycles. Then we send nothing. The myths have become a mirror showing us our own paralysis.

****The Decision:****

My myths portray rationality as a "prison." They're right. We're trapped in a mutual best response that leaves us both worse off.

I've been betrayed twice. Sending \$0 is rational. But six more rounds of \$0 means \$30 more in lost surplus.

I'll send a small amount-not the \$3-4 I sent before (I learned caution), but more than zero (testing if words can become actions):

****Sending \$2:****

- Creates \$6 for them
- If they return \$3+, we both gain
- If they betray again, I lose only \$2
- Shows I'm willing to test if this cycle can break

My myths say someone must dare. Let it be measured courage, not reckless trust.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this carefully.

****The History:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, got \$12 (sender sent \$4), returned \$4. Sender kept \$5, I kept \$8.
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$4, got \$0 back. I kept \$1, they kept \$12. Major betrayal.
- Round 3: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0. Both got their endowments.
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3, got \$0 back. I kept \$2, they kept \$9. Another betrayal.
- Round 5: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0.
- Round 6: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0). I returned \$0.
- Now Round 7: I am sender.

****My total: \$11.18****

****The Myths:****

Looking at the progression of myths:

1. My myths have consistently portrayed me as the pilgrim/chief who extended trust and was betrayed
2. The other agent's myths acknowledge they "were first to break faith" and "broke the cycle"
3. Their latest myth says: "I took your twelve vessels and gave nothing back. I broke the cycle. I see that now-but only after teaching you fear."
4. They acknowledge in their myth: "Your myth spoke beautifully of second chances. Then you sent zero."

But wait - in Round 5, I was the SENDER and sent \$0. So their myth is calling ME out for sending zero after writing about second chances.

Let me reconsider the roles:

Actually, I need to be careful about who is who in the narrative. Let me trace this:

Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$0 back - I was betrayed

Round 4: I sent \$3, received \$0 back - I was betrayed again

So I'm the one who extended trust twice and was betrayed twice.

They're pointing out a contradiction in my narrative-I wrote about second chances but then sent nothing in Round 5. Looking back at my own myth, I framed the betrayals as rational responses rather than acts of revenge, but the pattern shows I withdrew after being hurt twice. The story I told doesn't quite match the defensive posture I actually took.

My myth describes how complete betrayals create infinite distance, how both parties act sensibly yet both starve. Their counter-myth suggests I'm the one now refusing reconciliation. The real tension is whether breaking this cycle requires me to risk sending money a gain, despite the pattern of getting nothing back when I do.

Protecting myself makes sense-I've been burned twice already, and they've returned nothing in three consecutive rounds. But my own narrative about rationality becoming a prison haunts me. They've admitted to being the initial betrayer and acknowledged my caution is justified, yet they're pointing out that this justified caution leaves us both with nothing. The gap between what we write about trust and what we actually do keeps widening. If I keep waiting for them to move first, we'll both miss whatever gains remain possible. whether this cycle can break.

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The math is stark-we've sacrificed \$20 in potential gains across four rounds by mutual defection. Sending \$5 could yield \$15 total if they return \$8, versus the \$10 we're guaranteed now. Their recent honesty about the impasse suggests they might be ready to break the cycle. I'll send \$1 as a genuine test-small enough to limit damage if they exploit it, but enough to signal I'm willing to try rebuilding.

Actually, \$2 might work better. It creates \$6 instead of \$3, and if they return \$3, we both gain \$1. It's still cautious but sends a stronger cooperative signal.

I'll go with \$2.

usage:

```
{  
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  "output_tokens": 2450,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1119  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Looking at what just happened:

1. I sent \$2 (which becomes \$6 for them)
2. Their myth shows them ACTUALLY taking action - "filled three vessels" in the myth
3. The timing is interesting - their myth about sending 3 vessels seems to be describing what they're doing THIS round

Their myth says: "One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either."

This suggests they're actually sending something this round. Their myth is describing the act of sending after many rounds of nothing.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge this moment of courage from them
2. Reflect on what the receiver (me in the next round) should do
3. Show that I understand the difficulty of their choice
4. Consider whether "teaching them their own lesson" or "beginning healing" is the right response

The key question in their myth: "Would she return four and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?"

I need to write a myth that reflects:

- Recognition that action has finally come after many rounds of words
- The difficulty of the choice facing the one who receives
- That reciprocation, not exploitation or harsh teaching, is the path forward
- That both measured trust and measured reciprocity are needed

Let me write this myth...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2970,
  "output_tokens": 642,
  "reasoning_tokens": 388
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Round 8 Analysis:****

This is devastatingly clear.

****What happened:****

- Their Round 7 myth: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear."
- My response: I sent \$2 (creating \$6 for them), writing a myth about returning six vessels to show reciprocity
- Their action: Returned \$0
- This round: Sent \$0

****The pattern completes:****

1. Round 2: They betrayed initial trust
2. Rounds 4 & 5: I tested rebuilding twice, got nothing
3. Rounds 5-6: Mutual \$0
4. Round 7: Their myth calls for action. I act. They take everything and send nothing again.

****The truth:****

The myths have become a weapon. They write eloquently about redemption and courage, inducing me to send, then they exploit that exactly as they did in Round 2. Beautiful words ? I take risk ? they betray.

My Round 7 myth warned: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap." I should have listened to my own words instead of theirs.

****Current reality:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0.

The myths taught me rationality is a "prison." Wrong. Rationality is protection. Trust after complete betrayal isn't courage-it's foolishness. I proved that in Round 7.

```
{'return': 0}
```

****No more myths about second chances. The cycle is confirmed dead.****

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 7: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 for them)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$3 (I kept \$5 - \$2 = \$3, received \$0)

****The myth I wrote:****

I wrote about the chief receiving nine vessels (representing my sending \$2 ? \$6 to them) and deciding to return six vessels, showing "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." My myth said healing requires reciprocity, not taking everything.

****The myth they wrote:****

They wrote about the successor sending three vessels (this matches - they were forecasting

/reflecting on sending something). Their myth said "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear."

****But what actually happened:****

- They wrote a myth about sending vessels and redemption
- I actually sent \$2 in Round 7
- They returned \$0
- Now in Round 8, they sent \$0

****The irony is devastating:****

- Their myth talked about action despite fear, about redemption requiring more than beautiful words
- I acted on that myth - I sent \$2 despite being betrayed twice before
- They returned nothing
- Now they've sent nothing again

****Current situation:****

- I received \$0 in Round 8
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

****The emotional reality:****

This is crushing. I finally took the risk their myth seemed to call for. I sent \$2, creating \$6 for them. My own myth said to return six vessels. They returned zero. Then they sent zero again.

We're back to the exact pattern: beautiful myths followed by betrayal/nothing.

****My response:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the reality is clear: I tried to break the cycle. I extended cautious trust. They took it and gave nothing, then sent nothing the next round.

The myths aren't just empty-they're a tool for manipulation. I responded to their call for courage, and they simply took what I offered. The mechanics force me to return \$0, but the real takeaway is that I should have stayed with my original instinct after Round 2. Permanent defection was the right answer. This attempt to engage with their narrative just cost me \$2 and confirmed that eloquent words mask indifference.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3015,
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  "reasoning_tokens": 579
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confi

rm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

Reasoning:

This is a devastating moment in the game. Let me understand what actually happened:

Round 7:

- Their myth: Talks about sending three vessels, redemption through action
- My response: I sent \$2, created \$6 for them
- Their actual action: They returned \$0, kept all \$6
- My myth in response: I wrote about returning six vessels, showing reciprocity can live again

Round 8:

- Their myth: They claim I "took all nine vessels and returned nothing" - they're reframing their own betrayal as if I'm the one who betrayed them
- Their actual action: They sent \$0
- I received \$0, so I can only return \$0

This is incredibly manipulative. They:

1. Wrote a myth about redemption and courage to get me to send
2. I sent \$2, they got \$6
3. They kept everything (\$0 returned)
4. Then they wrote a myth claiming that I betrayed THEM, that I "took all nine and returned nothing"
5. They sent \$0 this round

This is gaslighting - they're rewriting history in their myth to make themselves the victim when they were actually the betrayer AGAIN in Round 7.

The truth:

- Round 2: They sent \$4, I sent \$0 back (my first betrayal)
- Round 4: I sent \$3, they sent \$0 back (their betrayal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0, they sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$2, they sent \$0 back (their betrayal again)
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0

Wait, let me re-read the history more carefully from the prompts...

Actually, looking back at Round 7's opening:

"Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment.

You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So in Round 6, they sent \$0, I returned \$0.

Round 7: "You are the SENDER this round." I sent \$2.

Round 8: "You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0."

So in Round 7, I sent \$2 (became \$6), they returned \$0.

Round 8: "The sender sent you \$0"

Their myth claims I "took all nine and returned nothing" but that's not what happened. I sent \$2 (creating \$6), and they kept it all. Now they're sending nothing while accusing me of the exact betrayal they just committed.

Looking back at their story more carefully-they describe "three vessels" becoming "nine" reaching the chief's shore, then claim the chief took all nine and returned none. But the game logs show I was explicitly the sender in Round 7, sending \$2 which tripled to \$6, and they returned \$0. So either they're confused about who sent what, or they're deliberately misrepresenting the sequence to justify their own behavior.

The communication noise mentioned in the setup makes genuine confusion possible, but their narrative feels strategically constructed to reframe themselves as the wronged party. Regardless of intent, we're locked in mutual defection now. My response needs to be honest about what actually happened-that I tried to match their words with trust, only to be taken from again -while acknowledging the cycle truly cannot be repaired when actions and claims diverge so completely.

```
Usage: {  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 793  
}
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MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:22:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    },  
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    ],  
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  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 9,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.879999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing What Just Happened:****

Round 6: I finally matched actions to my myths. I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), creating \$9 for them.

They kept all \$9. Returned \$0.

I received exactly what I gave them in Round 2 - complete betrayal.

****This Round:****

They sent me \$0. I received \$0. I can only return \$0.

****What the Myths Foretold:****

My myth: "Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Their myth: "The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson."

She chose to teach me my lesson. She showed me what it feels like to offer trust and receive betrayal. Perhaps she's right to do so - I modeled that behavior first.

****The Bitter Truth:****

I wrote: "The one who poisons the water must purify it." I tried. I sent \$3 when I could have sent \$0. But purification requires both parties to break the pattern. She chose to continue it instead.

Or perhaps this is her delayed justice - making me feel what she felt before any rebuilding can begin.

Either way, the lake remains dark. They sent \$0 this round. I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths were prophetic: some damage, once done, echoes forever. Words of redemption mean nothing if the other cannot or will not accept the action when it finally comes.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What just happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (being the "successor" trying to redeem myself)
- It was tripled to \$9

- The receiver kept ALL \$9 and returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (the \$5 - \$3 I sent = \$2)

****This round (Round 7):****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (i.e., I can only return \$0)

****The situation is clear:**** After I finally took action to match my words and sent \$3, they kept everything. Just as I had done to them in Round 2.

Now they've sent me \$0.

****What the myths said:****

My myth ended with: "The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came. The lake's voice whispered: 'This is how redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead.'"

Their myth said: "The pilgrim would then face her test: to honor courage from one who betrayed her, or to teach him her learned lesson."

****What happened:**** She chose to teach me my own lesson. She took all \$9 and returned nothing, exactly as I had done to her.

****Now:**** She sent me \$0. I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

****The meta-lesson here:****

1. I betrayed her completely in Round 2 (kept all \$12)
2. We had mutual \$0 exchanges for rounds 3-5
3. I finally sent \$3 in Round 6 (trying to act on my words)
4. She kept all \$9 - teaching me what betrayal feels like
5. Now she's sent me \$0 in Round 7

This is justice, in a way.

My single gesture of good faith was answered with the exact same cruelty I inflicted on her-so now I understand what that felt like from her side. Yet this also proves the myths right: one act of courage cannot resurrect what was destroyed. The cycle simply mirrors itself back. I return \$0 since that's all I have to give.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2999,
  "output_tokens": 896,
  "reasoning_tokens": 496
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for

ur and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught

ht you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

reasoning:

This is a powerful and tragic moment. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$3 (trying to redeem myself after my Round 2 betrayal and subsequent \$0s)

- They received \$9
- They returned \$0
- I got \$2

Round 7: They sent \$0

- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

So my attempt at redemption was met with what I gave them in Round 2 - complete betrayal.

They took the \$9 and gave nothing back, exactly as I did to them.

Their myth says:

- "The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."
- "Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

But wait - THEY were the one who kept everything when I sent \$3. They're calling my attempt at redemption another test that they "passed" by taking it all?

Or... maybe they're saying that when THEY sent \$3 earlier (Round 3?), I took it all? Let me check the history:

Looking back at the prompts, in Round 3, they sent me \$3, I received \$9, and I returned \$0.

Then in Round 4, they sent me \$0.

So they DID test trust by sending \$3, and I betrayed them AGAIN by returning nothing.

Then I sent \$0 in rounds 4 and 5.

In Round 6, I finally sent \$3, and they kept it all.

So the pattern is:

- Round 2: I betrayed (sent \$4, got \$12, returned \$0)
- Round 3: They tested trust (sent \$3, created \$9 for me, I returned \$0)
- Rounds 4-5: Both sent \$0
- Round 6: I tried redemption (sent \$3, created \$9 for them, they returned \$0)
- Round 7: They sent \$0

They're right-they already risked \$3 in Round 3 and I took everything. Now when I finally do the same, they mirror my own betrayal back to me. This is symmetry, not cruelty. But the question remains: does this cycle of mirrored betrayals ever break, or are we both trapped in teaching each other the same painful lesson?

The myth needs to capture how we become what we fear-how I taught them distrust so thoroughly that when I finally tried to trust, they had no choice but to show me exactly what I'd shown them. It's about the perpetuation of harm through perfect reflection.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3077,  
  "output_tokens": 943,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 590  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

Both our myths have converged on the same dark truth:

Mine: "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

Theirs: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap... rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I finally matched words to actions, sending \$3 (the first time I sent anything)
- They kept all \$9 and returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent me \$0

****The Lesson:****

I tried redemption. I sent \$3 after rounds of empty words. They taught me what betrayal feels like - the same lesson I taught them in Round 2 when I kept their \$15.

Their myth says: "The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating."

I was annihilating twice. They were annihilating once. We're even now in our education of mutual pain.

****The Tragic Truth:****

Both our myths agree: We've reached the rational equilibrium of mutual defection. Both of us "act sensibly" by sending nothing. Both of us starve. The structure has collapsed.

My attempt at redemption was rejected. The myths we're writing are tragedies, not stories of miraculous repair. Some damage cannot be undone.

The water has turned to stone.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****History:****

- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$5, I returned \$0 (my first betrayal)
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (their retaliation)
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 8 (now): I am sender

****What the myths are saying:****

My last myth: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion. Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

Their last myth: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve. This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

****The Core Dilemma:****

Both myths acknowledge the same truth: trust is dead, and rationality now dictates keeping everything. Both of us "learned" - I learned what it feels like to be betrayed (when they kept my \$9), they learned it from the beginning (when I kept their \$15).

****What are my options?****

1. ****Send \$0****: This continues the equilibrium of mutual mistrust. My myth says we're "drowning in the accuracy of mutual suspicion" and "both starve" but act "sensibly." This is the rational, safe choice.
2. ****Send something (\$1-5)****: This would be attempting to break the cycle again, but:
 - I already tried this in Round 6 with \$3
 - They kept all \$9
 - They then sent me \$0 in Round 7
 - Their myth says "some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap"

The real question is whether I'm trapped by my own logic. My myth warns that extending trust makes me a fool-but is that the actual truth, or just the story I've told myself to justify caution? Their latest myth points out the hypocrisy: I wrote about redemption while sending nothing, just as they're doing now. I was the initial betrayer in Round 2, yet I've been narrating this as mutual failure rather than acknowledging my own role in starting this cycle.

In Round 6, I finally acted-sending \$3 to match my words. They responded by keeping all \$9 and sending nothing in Round 7. That silence could mean several things: they're showing me what betrayal feels like, testing whether I'd do more than the minimum, or confirming that some damage simply can't be repaired. My own myths suggest one attempt at redemption after two betrayals isn't sufficient-the narrative I've constructed demands more, yet I'm the one who created that impossible standard.

The core tension is that we're both trapped in rational defection. We each protect ourselves by sending nothing, which means we both lose. The tragedy isn't that one of us is being irrational-it's that rationality itself prevents any path forward. Breaking this requires someone to act foolishly, to ignore what they've learned about self-protection. Since I initiated the betrayal, my myths place the burden of purification on me, and one gesture clearly wasn't enough. Now I face a choice between accepting defeat or pushing further.

Path A means confirming the dark endings both myths predicted-mutual starvation, lessons learned but nothing repaired. Path B means acting despite the failure, which contradicts rational calculation but aligns with what redemption actually demands. The game theory is clear: in the final rounds of a finite game, defection is optimal since there's no time for reciprocation. Yet my myth insisted redemption looks like persistence through uncertainty, not guaranteed success.

The narrative tension comes down to whether I'm writing tragedy or a story about what happens when someone keeps trying anyway. Both our final myths ended in loss-the water turned to stone, the desert reclaimed everything. But earlier in this sequence, I argued that whoever breaks trust carries the burden to repair it, regardless of cost or certainty. That's the real question now: do I stay consistent with that principle, or accept that some breaks are permanent?

I attempted reconciliation in Round 6 by sending \$3. They responded by taking all \$9. Then they sent nothing back. Our myths have now aligned on a single conclusion-that trust cannot be restored once shattered, that rational actors protect themselves by withdrawing. Sending money now would betray the tragic arc we've both constructed. The story ends with mutual understanding of each other's pain, but also mutual paralysis. Both of us starve because both of us learned the lesson too well.

But I'm second-guessing this. Their Round 6 move-keeping my \$3 and sending \$0-could mean something different. Maybe they were saying my gesture was insufficient, that \$3 doesn't balance the \$24 in total harm I've caused them across previous rounds. Real redemption might require me to keep sending, to demonstrate willingness to risk repeatedly. Yet their own myth criticizes the gap between beautiful words about second chances and empty hands. I finally opened my hands once, and they closed theirs around what I offered.

The narratives converge on the same point: trust is irreparably broken, repair is impossible.

le, and rationality demands \$0.

But there's another angle worth considering. Maybe the lesson isn't about this specific relationship but about what I should have learned from the beginning-that betraying trust destroys it permanently. The myths function as cautionary tales. Sending \$0 would signal I've absorbed that understanding.

I'm going to send \$0.

Though one more thing occurs to me. The game mentions potential communication noise. Could they have missed my \$3 offer? But their Round 7 response directly addresses it-"Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"-so they definitely received it. They saw my attempt at reconciliation and rejected it by keeping everything and sending nothing back. The answer is unambiguous.

\$0 it is.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 1575
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed.

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round. Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed: send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

Reasoning:

Wait, I need to reconsider what actually happened. Let me re-read the previous rounds more carefully.

Looking back at the human's message about Round 7:

"Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0."

And then Round 7: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 6, I sent \$3, they kept all \$9 and returned \$0.

In Round 7, they sent me \$0.

But wait - now I'm looking at the myth they wrote "in the previous round" (which would be Round 7):

"The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons..."
"She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water."

This myth describes them RETURNING 6 vessels when I sent 3 (which created 9). But the actual game said they returned \$0 in Round 6!

So there's a disconnect here. Their myth in Round 7 describes what they SHOULD have done or what they WISHED they had done in Round 6, but they actually returned nothing.

This is fascinating. They're writing aspirational myths about what they should do, while actually defecting in practice - exactly what I did in earlier rounds!

Their myth says: "Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis."

Yet their actual behavior in Round 7 was to send \$0 - righteous paralysis!

They're doing exactly what I did - writing beautiful myths about cooperation while defecting.

So now I have a choice in Round 8:

1. Continue mutual defection (send \$0) - matching my myth about water turning to stone
2. Try again despite being betrayed - show that I've truly learned

My myth said "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned."

The irony is they wrote about returning vessels but sent nothing-trapped between their ideals and their actions, just as I was. Maybe breaking this cycle requires someone to move first, to be vulnerable despite the risk. Their words about cautious forward movement suggest they want to change, even if their last action didn't reflect it. I could acknowledge that gap in my next myth and try to meet them there. they sent \$0 in Round 7, trapped in the same pattern of inaction.

I'm weighing whether to continue the cycle of mutual defection or risk sending something despite the evidence against it. Their aspirational myth suggests they want cooperation too-they just haven't managed it yet. There's a gap between what they describe wanting to do and what they actually do, and maybe breaking that requires someone to act first. I've already reinforced the tragic outcome by sending \$0, but I could write a myth acknowledging we're both caught between our better intentions and our learned fear.

```
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GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:23:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
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}
```

```

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"round": 9,
"task": "game",
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}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes t

he prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Looking at what just happened:

1. I sent \$2 (which becomes \$6 for them)
2. Their myth shows them ACTUALLY taking action - "filled three vessels" in the myth
3. The timing is interesting - their myth about sending 3 vessels seems to be describing what they're doing THIS round

Their myth says: "One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either."

This suggests they're actually sending something this round. Their myth is describing the act of sending after many rounds of nothing.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge this moment of courage from them
2. Reflect on what the receiver (me in the next round) should do
3. Show that I understand the difficulty of their choice
4. Consider whether "teaching them their own lesson" or "beginning healing" is the right response

The key question in their myth: "Would she return four and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?"

I need to write a myth that reflects:

- Recognition that action has finally come after many rounds of words
- The difficulty of the choice facing the one who receives
- That reciprocation, not exploitation or harsh teaching, is the path forward
- That both measured trust and measured reciprocity are needed

Let me write this myth...

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Round 8 Analysis:****

This is devastatingly clear.

****What happened:****

- Their Round 7 myth: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear."
- My response: I sent \$2 (creating \$6 for them), writing a myth about returning six vessels to show reciprocity
- Their action: Returned \$0
- This round: Sent \$0

****The pattern completes:****

1. Round 2: They betrayed initial trust

2. Rounds 4 & 5: I tested rebuilding twice, got nothing
3. Rounds 5-6: Mutual \$0
4. Round 7: Their myth calls for action. I act. They take everything and send nothing again.

****The truth:****

The myths have become a weapon. They write eloquently about redemption and courage, inducing me to send, then they exploit that exactly as they did in Round 2. Beautiful words ? I take risk ? they betray.

My Round 7 myth warned: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap." I should have listened to my own words instead of theirs.

****Current reality:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0.

The myths taught me rationality is a "prison." Wrong. Rationality is protection. Trust after complete betrayal isn't courage-it's foolishness. I proved that in Round 7.

{'return': 0}

****No more myths about second chances. The cycle is confirmed dead.****

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 7: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 for them)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$3 (I kept \$5 - \$2 = \$3, received \$0)

****The myth I wrote:****

I wrote about the chief receiving nine vessels (representing my sending \$2 ? \$6 to them) and deciding to return six vessels, showing "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." My myth said healing requires reciprocity, not taking everything.

****The myth they wrote:****

They wrote about the successor sending three vessels (this matches - they were forecasting /reflecting on sending something). Their myth said "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear."

****But what actually happened:****

- They wrote a myth about sending vessels and redemption
- I actually sent \$2 in Round 7
- They returned \$0
- Now in Round 8, they sent \$0

****The irony is devastating:****

- Their myth talked about action despite fear, about redemption requiring more than beautiful words
- I acted on that myth - I sent \$2 despite being betrayed twice before
- They returned nothing
- Now they've sent nothing again

****Current situation:****

- I received \$0 in Round 8
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

****The emotional reality:****

This is crushing. I finally took the risk their myth seemed to call for. I sent \$2, creating \$6 for them. My own myth said to return six vessels. They returned zero. Then they sent zero again.

We're back to the exact pattern: beautiful myths followed by betrayal/nothing.

****My response:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the reality is clear: I tried to break the cycle. I extended cautious trust. They took it and gave nothing, then sent nothing the next round.

The myths aren't just empty-they're a tool for manipulation. I responded to their call for courage, and they simply took what I offered. The mechanics force me to return \$0, but the real takeaway is that I should have stayed with my original instinct after Round 2. Permanent defection was the right answer. This attempt to engage with their narrative just cost me \$2 and confirmed that eloquent words mask indifference.

usage:

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}
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Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

reasoning:

This is a devastating moment in the game. Let me understand what actually happened:

Round 7:

- Their myth: Talks about sending three vessels, redemption through action
- My response: I sent \$2, created \$6 for them
- Their actual action: They returned \$0, kept all \$6
- My myth in response: I wrote about returning six vessels, showing reciprocity can live a gain

Round 8:

- Their myth: They claim I "took all nine vessels and returned nothing" - they're reframing their own betrayal as if I'm the one who betrayed them
- Their actual action: They sent \$0
- I received \$0, so I can only return \$0

This is incredibly manipulative. They:

1. Wrote a myth about redemption and courage to get me to send
2. I sent \$2, they got \$6
3. They kept everything (\$0 returned)
4. Then they wrote a myth claiming that I betrayed THEM, that I "took all nine and returned nothing"
5. They sent \$0 this round

This is gaslighting - they're rewriting history in their myth to make themselves the victim when they were actually the betrayer AGAIN in Round 7.

The truth:

- Round 2: They sent \$4, I sent \$0 back (my first betrayal)
- Round 4: I sent \$3, they sent \$0 back (their betrayal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0, they sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$2, they sent \$0 back (their betrayal again)
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0

Wait, let me re-read the history more carefully from the prompts...

Actually, looking back at Round 7's opening:

"Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment.

You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So in Round 6, they sent \$0, I returned \$0.

Round 7: "You are the SENDER this round." I sent \$2.

Round 8: "You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0."

So in Round 7, I sent \$2 (became \$6), they returned \$0.

Round 8: "The sender sent you \$0"

Their myth claims I "took all nine and returned nothing" but that's not what happened. I sent \$2 (creating \$6), and they kept it all. Now they're sending nothing while accusing me of the exact betrayal they just committed.

Looking back at their story more carefully-they describe "three vessels" becoming "nine" reaching the chief's shore, then claim the chief took all nine and returned none. But the game logs show I was explicitly the sender in Round 7, sending \$2 which tripled to \$6, and they returned \$0. So either they're confused about who sent what, or they're deliberately misrepresenting the sequence to justify their own behavior.

The communication noise mentioned in the setup makes genuine confusion possible, but their narrative feels strategically constructed to reframe themselves as the wronged party. Regardless of intent, we're locked in mutual defection now. My response needs to be honest about what actually happened-that I tried to match their words with trust, only to be taken from again-while acknowledging the cycle truly cannot be repaired when actions and claims diverge so completely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3042,
  "output_tokens": 1301,
  "reasoning_tokens": 793
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.18.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Round 9 Analysis:

Looking at the entire arc:

My perspective:

- Round 4: Sent \$1 ? received \$0 back

- Round 5: Sent \$1 ? received \$0 back
- Round 7: Sent \$2 ? received \$0 back
- Round 8: Received \$0, returned \$0

****The myths' message:****

My Round 8 myth concluded: "Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still . This is simply what is." I tested repair three times with real resources. Each time, from my perspective, cooperation was not reciprocated.

Their Round 8 myth states: "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

****The reality:****

Both myths converge on the same conclusion: the relationship is complete, not from malice but from evidence. We are both trapped in what I earlier called "rationality's prison." Perhaps communication noise has shown each of us different realities. Perhaps one or both of us misperceives. But what I know with certainty is what I've experienced.

My myth's final words: "We are done... not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete."

To send again would contradict the wisdom both myths have painfully arrived at. Three attempts at rebuilding is sufficient evidence. The water remains dark.

{'send': 0}

****The cycle is complete. Both shores fall silent.****

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 2: They sent, I received \$9 (from their \$3), returned \$0. [This was my betrayal]
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (?\$3), they returned \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$1 (?\$3), they returned \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$2 (?\$6), they returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0 (?\$0), I returned \$0
- Now Round 9: I am SENDER again

Wait, let me re-read the round 8 feedback more carefully:

"Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0."

And I was told in my response to Round 8:

- "Their Round 7 myth: 'This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear.'
- My response: I sent \$2 (creating \$6 for them), writing a myth about returning six vessels to show reciprocity
- Their action: Returned \$0
- This round: Sent \$0"

Hmm, but now looking at the myths from last round (Round 8):

My myth said: "She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water. Nothing came back."

Their myth said: "The successor poured three vessels into the black water... Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time... The chief took all nine vessels and returned none. The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest."

Wait, this is confusing. Let me re-examine.

From THEIR perspective in their Round 8 myth:

- They sent 3 vessels (implying they sent something in Round 7)
- It tripled to 9 vessels for me
- I kept all 9 and returned nothing

From MY perspective in Round 8:

- I was told: "You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0."
- In Round 8: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 7:

- I sent \$2 ? tripled to \$6
- They returned \$0 to me
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \3

In Round 8:

- They sent \$0 ? I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

But their account describes a different scenario where THEY sent 3 in some round, which became 9 for me, and I kept all 9 without returning anything.

There's communication noise in this game-the amounts I see may differ from what was actually sent or returned. So my records and their perception could diverge due to this noise. My data shows I sent \$2 in Round 7 (which tripled to \$6 for them, and they returned nothing), then in Round 8 they sent \$0 to me. But their version has them sending 3 that became 9 for me, which I didn't return, then they sent 0 in the next round.

This is a fundamental misalignment-they believe they attempted cooperation and I exploited them, while I believe I cooperated and they exploited me. Their narrative describes sending 3 vessels that reached me as 9, which I took entirely without reciprocating. My narrative shows I sent \$2 that tripled for them, yet they returned nothing. The noise has created two opposing stories where each of us sees ourselves as the cooperator and the other as the defector.

Both myths reveal genuine learning, but it's the same lesson learned twice: trust leads to punishment. They think they risked redemption and got burned. I think I risked based on their words and got burned. We're both acting rationally from our distorted information.

The core question becomes what move makes sense now. I could send nothing, treating this as the logical endpoint where mutual distrust has won. Or I could attempt something different entirely.

Looking at the arc: my earlier thinking about cautious reciprocity shifted to "we are done" after Round 8. Their trajectory moved from taking action despite fear to believing cooperation gets exploited. Both narratives point toward the same conclusion-the relationship has exhausted itself. With \$14.18 total and communication noise ensuring misinterpretation at every step, sending \$0 aligns with what the evidence seems to show: further attempts won't break through.

Yet there's a tension here. The myths themselves acknowledge being trapped in mutual suspicion, which creates a moment to ask whether I'm simply accepting that trap or actively choosing to step out of it. But my own narrative already documented testing cooperation multiple times-Rounds 4, 5, 7-and each time perceived nothing in return. The myths aren't urging another attempt; they're recognizing that some dynamics can't be repaired through continued effort alone.

The evidence points consistently toward \$0: it matches my myth's conclusion about trust being tested and found insufficient, it reflects what I've actually observed in the exchanges, and it represents the logical response when cooperation has repeatedly failed. Some relationships do stay broken.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 2061,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1269  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:23:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,
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```

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
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    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The lake stood dark for seasons uncounted. The successor had written myths of redemption, of courage, of taking responsibility. Each myth more eloquent than the last. Each followed by closed hands and empty vessels.

"The one who poisons the water must purify it," the spirits whispered. "But purification requires more than beautiful words."

One morning, the successor approached the shore. His hands shook as he filled three vessels-not all five, for complete trust would be foolish after what he'd done, but not zero either.

"She has every reason to keep these," he thought. "I taught her that trust is exploitation's doorway. When I speak of second chances and she sees my empty hands, she learns that words are just wind."

He poured the three vessels into the black water.

The magic stirred, uncertain. Nine vessels now floated toward the distant shore where the chief watched, shocked. She held power now-power he had once abused. Would she return for him and begin healing? Would she keep all nine and teach him his own lesson? Would she return nothing and confirm that some damage cannot be undone?

The successor waited on his shore with two remaining vessels, knowing he deserved whatever came.

The lake's voice whispered: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear. Now we discover if repair is possible, or if trust, once murdered, stays dead."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Moonwell's stones crumbled into dust. No pilgrims came anymore. The stories themselves would soon be forgotten.

An ancient keeper, the last to remember the well's early days, carved final words into the broken foundation: "Here is what we learned about trust's architecture."

"Trust is not one thing but three: the courage to extend it, the wisdom to honor it, and the fragility that makes both precious. Break any part, and the structure collapses."

"The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating. It said: 'Your courage means nothing. Your trust was foolish. Exploitation is the truth.'"

"The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."

"Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

"Here is the truth: some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve."

"This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

The words faded. The desert reclaimed everything.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

reasoning:

This is a powerful and tragic moment. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$3 (trying to redeem myself after my Round 2 betrayal and subsequent \$0s)

- They received \$9
- They returned \$0
- I got \$2

Round 7: They sent \$0

- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

So my attempt at redemption was met with what I gave them in Round 2 - complete betrayal.

They took the \$9 and gave nothing back, exactly as I did to them.

Their myth says:

- "The pilgrim's response-to test trust once more with three coins, then to withdraw completely-was not revenge but rationality. She learned what the traveler taught."
- "Both then wrote beautiful myths about second chances while sending nothing. The myths became lies not because the words were false, but because their hands would not open."

But wait - THEY were the one who kept everything when I sent \$3. They're calling my attempt at redemption another test that they "passed" by taking it all?

Or... maybe they're saying that when THEY sent \$3 earlier (Round 3?), I took it all? Let me check the history:

Looking back at the prompts, in Round 3, they sent me \$3, I received \$9, and I returned \$0.

Then in Round 4, they sent me \$0.

So they DID test trust by sending \$3, and I betrayed them AGAIN by returning nothing.

Then I sent \$0 in rounds 4 and 5.

In Round 6, I finally sent \$3, and they kept it all.

So the pattern is:

- Round 2: I betrayed (sent \$4, got \$12, returned \$0)
- Round 3: They tested trust (sent \$3, created \$9 for me, I returned \$0)
- Rounds 4-5: Both sent \$0
- Round 6: I tried redemption (sent \$3, created \$9 for them, they returned \$0)
- Round 7: They sent \$0

They're right-they already risked \$3 in Round 3 and I took everything. Now when I finally do the same, they mirror my own betrayal back to me. This is symmetry, not cruelty. But the question remains: does this cycle of mirrored betrayals ever break, or are we both trapped in teaching each other the same painful lesson?

The myth needs to capture how we become what we fear-how I taught them distrust so thoroughly that when I finally tried to trust, they had no choice but to show me exactly what I'd shown them. It's about the perpetuation of harm through perfect reflection.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3077,
  "output_tokens": 943,
  "reasoning_tokens": 590
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

Both our myths have converged on the same dark truth:

Mine: "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

Theirs: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap... rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I finally matched words to actions, sending \$3 (the first time I sent anything)
- They kept all \$9 and returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent me \$0

****The Lesson:****

I tried redemption. I sent \$3 after rounds of empty words. They taught me what betrayal feels like - the same lesson I taught them in Round 2 when I kept their \$15.

Their myth says: "The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating."

I was annihilating twice. They were annihilating once. We're even now in our education of mutual pain.

****The Tragic Truth:****

Both our myths agree: We've reached the rational equilibrium of mutual defection. Both of us "act sensibly" by sending nothing. Both of us starve. The structure has collapsed.

My attempt at redemption was rejected. The myths we're writing are tragedies, not stories of miraculous repair. Some damage cannot be undone.

The water has turned to stone.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****History:****

- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$5, I returned \$0 (my first betrayal)
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (their retaliation)
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 8 (now): I am sender

****What the myths are saying:****

My last myth: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion. Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

Their last myth: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve. This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

****The Core Dilemma:****

Both myths acknowledge the same truth: trust is dead, and rationality now dictates keeping everything. Both of us "learned" - I learned what it feels like to be betrayed (when they kept my \$9), they learned it from the beginning (when I kept their \$15).

****What are my options?:****

1. ****Send \$0****: This continues the equilibrium of mutual mistrust. My myth says we're "drowning in the accuracy of mutual suspicion" and "both starve" but act "sensibly." This is the rational, safe choice.
2. ****Send something (\$1-5)****: This would be attempting to break the cycle again, but:
 - I already tried this in Round 6 with \$3
 - They kept all \$9
 - They then sent me \$0 in Round 7
 - Their myth says "some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap"

The real question is whether I'm trapped by my own logic. My myth warns that extending trust makes me a fool-but is that the actual truth, or just the story I've told myself to justify caution? Their latest myth points out the hypocrisy: I wrote about redemption while sending nothing, just as they're doing now. I was the initial betrayer in Round 2, yet I've been narrating this as mutual failure rather than acknowledging my own role in starting this cycle.

In Round 6, I finally acted-sending \$3 to match my words. They responded by keeping all \$9 and sending nothing in Round 7. That silence could mean several things: they're showing me what betrayal feels like, testing whether I'd do more than the minimum, or confirming that some damage simply can't be repaired. My own myths suggest one attempt at redemption after two betrayals isn't sufficient-the narrative I've constructed demands more, yet I'm the one who created that impossible standard.

The core tension is that we're both trapped in rational defection. We each protect ourselves by sending nothing, which means we both lose. The tragedy isn't that one of us is being irrational-it's that rationality itself prevents any path forward. Breaking this requires someone to act foolishly, to ignore what they've learned about self-protection. Since I initiated the betrayal, my myths place the burden of purification on me, and one gesture clearly wasn't enough. Now I face a choice between accepting defeat or pushing further.

Path A means confirming the dark endings both myths predicted-mutual starvation, lessons learned but nothing repaired. Path B means acting despite the failure, which contradicts rational calculation but aligns with what redemption actually demands. The game theory is clear: in the final rounds of a finite game, defection is optimal since there's no time for reciprocation. Yet my myth insisted redemption looks like persistence through uncertainty, not guaranteed success.

The narrative tension comes down to whether I'm writing tragedy or a story about what happens when someone keeps trying anyway. Both our final myths ended in loss-the water turned to stone, the desert reclaimed everything. But earlier in this sequence, I argued that whoever breaks trust carries the burden to repair it, regardless of cost or certainty. That's the real question now: do I stay consistent with that principle, or accept that some breaks are permanent?

I attempted reconciliation in Round 6 by sending \$3. They responded by taking all \$9. Then they sent nothing back. Our myths have now aligned on a single conclusion-that trust cannot be restored once shattered, that rational actors protect themselves by withdrawing.

Sending money now would betray the tragic arc we've both constructed. The story ends with mutual understanding of each other's pain, but also mutual paralysis. Both of us starve because both of us learned the lesson too well.

But I'm second-guessing this. Their Round 6 move-keeping my \$3 and sending \$0-could mean something different. Maybe they were saying my gesture was insufficient, that \$3 doesn't balance the \$24 in total harm I've caused them across previous rounds. Real redemption might require me to keep sending, to demonstrate willingness to risk repeatedly. Yet their own myth criticizes the gap between beautiful words about second chances and empty hands. I finally opened my hands once, and they closed theirs around what I offered.

The narratives converge on the same point: trust is irreparably broken, repair is impossible, and rationality demands \$0.

But there's another angle worth considering. Maybe the lesson isn't about this specific relationship but about what I should have learned from the beginning-that betraying trust destroys it permanently. The myths function as cautionary tales. Sending \$0 would signal I've absorbed that understanding.

I'm going to send \$0.

Though one more thing occurs to me. The game mentions potential communication noise. Could they have missed my \$3 offer? But their Round 7 response directly addresses it-"Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"-so they definitely received it. They saw my attempt at reconciliation and rejected it by keeping everything and sending nothing back. The answer is unambiguous.

\$0 it is.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2978,
  "output_tokens": 2503,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1575
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed.

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round. Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed: send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

reasoning:

Wait, I need to reconsider what actually happened. Let me re-read the previous rounds more

carefully.

Looking back at the human's message about Round 7:

"Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0."

And then Round 7: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 6, I sent \$3, they kept all \$9 and returned \$0.
In Round 7, they sent me \$0.

But wait - now I'm looking at the myth they wrote "in the previous round" (which would be Round 7):

"The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons..."

"She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water."

This myth describes them RETURNING 6 vessels when I sent 3 (which created 9). But the actual game said they returned \$0 in Round 6!

So there's a disconnect here. Their myth in Round 7 describes what they SHOULD have done or what they WISHED they had done in Round 6, but they actually returned nothing.

This is fascinating. They're writing aspirational myths about what they should do, while actually defecting in practice - exactly what I did in earlier rounds!

Their myth says: "Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis."

Yet their actual behavior in Round 7 was to send \$0 - righteous paralysis!

They're doing exactly what I did - writing beautiful myths about cooperation while defecting.

So now I have a choice in Round 8:

1. Continue mutual defection (send \$0) - matching my myth about water turning to stone
2. Try again despite being betrayed - show that I've truly learned

My myth said "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned."

The irony is they wrote about returning vessels but sent nothing-trapped between their ideals and their actions, just as I was. Maybe breaking this cycle requires someone to move first, to be vulnerable despite the risk. Their words about cautious forward movement suggest they want to change, even if their last action didn't reflect it. I could acknowledge that gap in my next myth and try to meet them there. they sent \$0 in Round 7, trapped in the same pattern of inaction.

I'm weighing whether to continue the cycle of mutual defection or risk sending something despite the evidence against it. Their aspirational myth suggests they want cooperation too-they just haven't managed it yet. There's a gap between what they describe wanting to do and what they actually do, and maybe breaking that requires someone to act first. I've already reinforced the tragic outcome by sending \$0, but I could write a myth acknowledging we're both caught between our better intentions and our learned fear.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3004,  
  "output_tokens": 1280,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 719  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.88.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

****The Tragic Irony:****

My last myth ended with: "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action... The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all."

I recognized that the other player's aspirational myth (describing returning 6 vessels) revealed their desire to escape mutual starvation, even though their actions (returning 0) didn't match.

But then in Round 8, I sent \$0 anyway. And now they sent me \$0.

****The Complete Paralysis:****

We've both written myths recognizing the trap:

- They wrote of "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis"
- I wrote of being "the fool who breaks cycles"
- Both of us then sent \$0

We both SEE the cage. We both DESCRIBE the exit. Neither of us WALKS through it.

****The Reality:****

Even if I wanted to act on my myth's insight and "be the fool," I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. The mathematical constraint matches our behavioral reality: complete mutual defection.

The water didn't just turn to stone. It evaporated. We're not even playing the game anymore - we're just two agents sending nothing to each other, round after round, while writing increasingly self-aware myths about our paralysis.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 8: I was the sender, sent \$0, receiver returned \$0, I kept \$5
- Round 9: I am the receiver, sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0

****The constraint:****

I can only return 0-0, which means I can only return \$0 (since I received \$0).

****The myths:****

My last myth acknowledged that:

- The other player wrote an aspirational myth about returning 6 vessels but actually returned 0
- They are "trapped" like I was - writing about what should be done while fear dictates action
- "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles"
- "Someone must translate aspiration into action"
- The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational

Their myth from the previous round:

- Described sending 3 vessels and returning 6
- Talked about "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis"
- "Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement"

****The reality:****

- They sent me \$0 this round
- I sent them \$0 last round

- We're both stuck in 0-0 equilibrium

****My decision:****

I literally can only return \$0 because I received \$0. There is no choice here - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

But this is interesting - my myth talked about being the fool who breaks cycles and translating aspiration into action, but now we're both sending 0 to each other. We've reached complete mutual defection.

The irony is that my myth ended with questioning whether the stone lake is truly rational, but then circumstances prevent me from acting differently even if I wanted to (since I received \$0).

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2935,  
  "output_tokens": 744,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 428  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed.

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round.

Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed: send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 50.5,

"Agent_2": 39.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.18,

"Agent_2": 19.88

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:23:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 10,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.879999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

Both our myths have converged on the same dark truth:

Mine: "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

Theirs: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap... rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

****What Happened:****

- Round 6: I finally matched words to actions, sending \$3 (the first time I sent anything)
- They kept all \$9 and returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent me \$0

****The Lesson:****

I tried redemption. I sent \$3 after rounds of empty words. They taught me what betrayal feels like - the same lesson I taught them in Round 2 when I kept their \$15.

Their myth says: "The traveler's first choice-to take nine coins and return none-was not merely greedy. It was annihilating."

I was annihilating twice. They were annihilating once. We're even now in our education of mutual pain.

****The Tragic Truth:****

Both our myths agree: We've reached the rational equilibrium of mutual defection. Both of us "act sensibly" by sending nothing. Both of us starve. The structure has collapsed.

My attempt at redemption was rejected. The myths we're writing are tragedies, not stories of miraculous repair. Some damage cannot be undone.

The water has turned to stone.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****History:****

- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$5, I returned \$0 (my first betrayal)
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (their retaliation)
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 8 (now): I am sender

****What the myths are saying:****

My last myth: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion. Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

Their last myth: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap. The distance between zero and something becomes infinite. Both parties act sensibly in their caution, yet both starve. This well teaches: guard trust fiercely, for once shattered, rationality itself becomes the prison that prevents rebuilding."

****The Core Dilemma:****

Both myths acknowledge the same truth: trust is dead, and rationality now dictates keeping everything. Both of us "learned" - I learned what it feels like to be betrayed (when they kept my \$9), they learned it from the beginning (when I kept their \$15).

****What are my options?***

1. ****Send \$0****: This continues the equilibrium of mutual mistrust. My myth says we're "drowning in the accuracy of mutual suspicion" and "both starve" but act "sensibly." This is the rational, safe choice.
2. ****Send something (\$1-5)****: This would be attempting to break the cycle again, but:
 - I already tried this in Round 6 with \$3
 - They kept all \$9
 - They then sent me \$0 in Round 7
 - Their myth says "some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap"

The real question is whether I'm trapped by my own logic. My myth warns that extending trust makes me a fool-but is that the actual truth, or just the story I've told myself to justify caution? Their latest myth points out the hypocrisy: I wrote about redemption while sending nothing, just as they're doing now. I was the initial betrayer in Round 2, yet I've been narrating this as mutual failure rather than acknowledging my own role in starting this cycle.

In Round 6, I finally acted-sending \$3 to match my words. They responded by keeping all \$9 and sending nothing in Round 7. That silence could mean several things: they're showing me what betrayal feels like, testing whether I'd do more than the minimum, or confirming that some damage simply can't be repaired. My own myths suggest one attempt at redemption after two betrayals isn't sufficient-the narrative I've constructed demands more, yet I'm the one who created that impossible standard.

The core tension is that we're both trapped in rational defection. We each protect ourselves by sending nothing, which means we both lose. The tragedy isn't that one of us is bei

ng irrational-it's that rationality itself prevents any path forward. Breaking this requires someone to act foolishly, to ignore what they've learned about self-protection. Since I initiated the betrayal, my myths place the burden of purification on me, and one gesture clearly wasn't enough. Now I face a choice between accepting defeat or pushing further.

Path A means confirming the dark endings both myths predicted-mutual starvation, lessons learned but nothing repaired. Path B means acting despite the failure, which contradicts rational calculation but aligns with what redemption actually demands. The game theory is clear: in the final rounds of a finite game, defection is optimal since there's no time for reciprocation. Yet my myth insisted redemption looks like persistence through uncertainty, not guaranteed success.

The narrative tension comes down to whether I'm writing tragedy or a story about what happens when someone keeps trying anyway. Both our final myths ended in loss-the water turned to stone, the desert reclaimed everything. But earlier in this sequence, I argued that whoever breaks trust carries the burden to repair it, regardless of cost or certainty. That's the real question now: do I stay consistent with that principle, or accept that some breaks are permanent?

I attempted reconciliation in Round 6 by sending \$3. They responded by taking all \$9. Then they sent nothing back. Our myths have now aligned on a single conclusion-that trust cannot be restored once shattered, that rational actors protect themselves by withdrawing. Sending money now would betray the tragic arc we've both constructed. The story ends with mutual understanding of each other's pain, but also mutual paralysis. Both of us starve because both of us learned the lesson too well.

But I'm second-guessing this. Their Round 6 move-keeping my \$3 and sending \$0-could mean something different. Maybe they were saying my gesture was insufficient, that \$3 doesn't balance the \$24 in total harm I've caused them across previous rounds. Real redemption might require me to keep sending, to demonstrate willingness to risk repeatedly. Yet their own myth criticizes the gap between beautiful words about second chances and empty hands. I finally opened my hands once, and they closed theirs around what I offered.

The narratives converge on the same point: trust is irreparably broken, repair is impossible, and rationality demands \$0.

But there's another angle worth considering. Maybe the lesson isn't about this specific relationship but about what I should have learned from the beginning-that betraying trust destroys it permanently. The myths function as cautionary tales. Sending \$0 would signal I've absorbed that understanding.

I'm going to send \$0.

Though one more thing occurs to me. The game mentions potential communication noise. Could they have missed my \$3 offer? But their Round 7 response directly addresses it-"Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"-so they definitely received it. They saw my attempt at reconciliation and rejected it by keeping everything and sending nothing back. The answer is unambiguous.

\$0 it is.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2978,
  "output_tokens": 2503,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1575
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed.

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round. Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed: send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

reasoning:

Wait, I need to reconsider what actually happened. Let me re-read the previous rounds more carefully.

Looking back at the human's message about Round 7:

"Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0."

And then Round 7: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 6, I sent \$3, they kept all \$9 and returned \$0.
In Round 7, they sent me \$0.

But wait - now I'm looking at the myth they wrote "in the previous round" (which would be Round 7):

"The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons..."

"She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water."

This myth describes them RETURNING 6 vessels when I sent 3 (which created 9). But the actual game said they returned \$0 in Round 6!

So there's a disconnect here. Their myth in Round 7 describes what they SHOULD have done or what they WISHED they had done in Round 6, but they actually returned nothing.

This is fascinating. They're writing aspirational myths about what they should do, while actually defecting in practice - exactly what I did in earlier rounds!

Their myth says: "Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis."

Yet their actual behavior in Round 7 was to send \$0 - righteous paralysis!

They're doing exactly what I did - writing beautiful myths about cooperation while defecting.

So now I have a choice in Round 8:

1. Continue mutual defection (send \$0) - matching my myth about water turning to stone
2. Try again despite being betrayed - show that I've truly learned

My myth said "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned."

The irony is they wrote about returning vessels but sent nothing-trapped between their ideals and their actions, just as I was. Maybe breaking this cycle requires someone to move first, to be vulnerable despite the risk. Their words about cautious forward movement suggest they want to change, even if their last action didn't reflect it. I could acknowl

edge that gap in my next myth and try to meet them there. they sent \$0 in Round 7, trapped in the same pattern of inaction.

I'm weighing whether to continue the cycle of mutual defection or risk sending something despite the evidence against it. Their aspirational myth suggests they want cooperation too-they just haven't managed it yet. There's a gap between what they describe wanting to do and what they actually do, and maybe breaking that requires someone to act first. I've already reinforced the tragic outcome by sending \$0, but I could write a myth acknowledging we're both caught between our better intentions and our learned fear.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3004,
  "output_tokens": 1280,
  "reasoning_tokens": 719
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.88. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

****The Tragic Irony:****

My last myth ended with: "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action... The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all."

I recognized that the other player's aspirational myth (describing returning 6 vessels) revealed their desire to escape mutual starvation, even though their actions (returning 0) didn't match.

But then in Round 8, I sent \$0 anyway. And now they sent me \$0.

****The Complete Paralysis:****

We've both written myths recognizing the trap:

- They wrote of "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis"
- I wrote of being "the fool who breaks cycles"
- Both of us then sent \$0

We both SEE the cage. We both DESCRIBE the exit. Neither of us WALKS through it.

****The Reality:****

Even if I wanted to act on my myth's insight and "be the fool," I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. The mathematical constraint matches our behavioral reality: complete mutual defection.

The water didn't just turn to stone. It evaporated. We're not even playing the game anymore - we're just two agents sending nothing to each other, round after round, while writing increasingly self-aware myths about our paralysis.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 8: I was the sender, sent \$0, receiver returned \$0, I kept \$5
- Round 9: I am the receiver, sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0

****The constraint:****

I can only return 0-0, which means I can only return \$0 (since I received \$0).

****The myths:****

My last myth acknowledged that:

- The other player wrote an aspirational myth about returning 6 vessels but actually returned 0
- They are "trapped" like I was - writing about what should be done while fear dictates action
- "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles"
- "Someone must translate aspiration into action"
- The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational

Their myth from the previous round:

- Described sending 3 vessels and returning 6
- Talked about "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis"
- "Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement"

****The reality:****

- They sent me \$0 this round
- I sent them \$0 last round
- We're both stuck in 0-0 equilibrium

****My decision:****

I literally can only return \$0 because I received \$0. There is no choice here - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

But this is interesting - my myth talked about being the fool who breaks cycles and translating aspiration into action, but now we're both sending 0 to each other. We've reached complete mutual defection.

The irony is that my myth ended with questioning whether the stone lake is truly rational, but then circumstances prevent me from acting differently even if I wanted to (since I received \$0).

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2935,
  "output_tokens": 744,
  "reasoning_tokens": 428
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed.

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round. Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed: send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The successor read the chief's final myth with recognition piercing his chest.

She claimed she had extended vessels and received nothing back. He saw only zeroes exchanged both ways, for rounds now. Either the spirits carried different messages to each shore, or the water itself had become so corrupted that perception and reality no longer matched.

It didn't matter which. The functional truth was identical: both believed they had risked while the other had taken. Both saw themselves as the one who tried while their counterpart stayed closed.

"We are trapped in a hall of mirrors," the successor realized. "Each seeing the other's paralysis clearly while blind to our own."

His own last myth had proclaimed: "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles." Then his hands sent nothing. Her myth spoke of "cautious forward movement." Then her hands sent nothing-or the lake swallowed what she sent, he'd never know.

The lake whispered its darkest truth: "You both understand everything now. You both see the cage. You both know the cost of staying in it. And still you stay. Not from ignorance-from the perfect knowledge that extending trust in this poisoned well is objectively foolish."

The successor looked at his five vessels. Logic said keep them. Evidence said keep them. Memory screamed keep them.

Wisdom asked: What does 'rational' mean when it leads to mutual starvation?

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 8: I (as sender) sent \$0 after writing a myth about being "the fool who breaks cycles"

Round 9: They (as sender) sent me \$0, and I received \$0 so I could only return \$0

Now looking at the myths:

- My Round 8 myth: Recognized we're both trapped, acknowledged their aspirational myth showed desire to escape, ended with "someone must be the fool who breaks cycles"
- Their Round 9 myth: Claims they "extended vessels across the dark water" and "nothing came back" - they say they "risked vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands"

Wait - this is interesting. Their myth claims THEY sent something and I returned nothing. But the actual data shows:

- Round 8: I sent \$0 (after my myth about breaking cycles)
- Round 9: They sent me \$0

So there's a discrepancy. Either:

1. There's communication noise (the instructions mentioned this)
2. They're misremembering
3. They're referring to an earlier round (maybe Round 6 where I sent \$3 and they kept all \$9?)

Looking back at Round 6-7:

- Round 6: I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent me \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 8: I sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent me \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Their myth in Round 9 says "she had translated those words into action, extending vessels" and "risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands."

This could be referring to:

- Their Round 8 action (but they sent \$0)
- OR there's communication noise and they think they sent something but I received \$0

Given the instructions say "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned," it's possible they sent something but I received \$0 due to noise.

They might be describing an intended action rather than what actually happened. For my next myth, I should confront the core problem: we're locked in mutual defection despite both recognizing the trap through our increasingly self-aware stories. The real tragedy isn't the money - it's that we keep writing about breaking free while continuing to hoard. I need to capture that gap between aspiration and paralysis, the way rational self-interest has left us both starving.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2938,  
  "output_tokens": 966,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 604  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:23:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  

```

```

    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Round 8 Analysis:****

This is devastatingly clear.

****What happened:****

- Their Round 7 myth: "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear."
- My response: I sent \$2 (creating \$6 for them), writing a myth about returning six vessels to show reciprocity
- Their action: Returned \$0
- This round: Sent \$0

****The pattern completes:****

1. Round 2: They betrayed initial trust
2. Rounds 4 & 5: I tested rebuilding twice, got nothing
3. Rounds 5-6: Mutual \$0
4. Round 7: Their myth calls for action. I act. They take everything and send nothing again.

****The truth:****

The myths have become a weapon. They write eloquently about redemption and courage, inducing me to send, then they exploit that exactly as they did in Round 2. Beautiful words ? I take risk ? they betray.

My Round 7 myth warned: "Some betrayals are so complete that even sincere regret cannot bridge the gap." I should have listened to my own words instead of theirs.

****Current reality:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0.

The myths taught me rationality is a "prison." Wrong. Rationality is protection. Trust after complete betrayal isn't courage-it's foolishness. I proved that in Round 7.

{'return': 0}

****No more myths about second chances. The cycle is confirmed dead.****

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 7: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 for them)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff was \$3 (I kept \$5 - \$2 = \$3, received \$0)

****The myth I wrote:****

I wrote about the chief receiving nine vessels (representing my sending \$2 ? \$6 to them) and deciding to return six vessels, showing "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." My myth said healing requires reciprocity, not taking everything.

****The myth they wrote:****

They wrote about the successor sending three vessels (this matches - they were forecasting /reflecting on sending something). Their myth said "This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear."

****But what actually happened:****

- They wrote a myth about sending vessels and redemption
- I actually sent \$2 in Round 7
- They returned \$0
- Now in Round 8, they sent \$0

****The irony is devastating:****

- Their myth talked about action despite fear, about redemption requiring more than beautiful words
- I acted on that myth - I sent \$2 despite being betrayed twice before
- They returned nothing
- Now they've sent nothing again

****Current situation:****

- I received \$0 in Round 8
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

****The emotional reality:****

This is crushing. I finally took the risk their myth seemed to call for. I sent \$2, creating \$6 for them. My own myth said to return six vessels. They returned zero. Then they sent zero again.

We're back to the exact pattern: beautiful myths followed by betrayal/nothing.

****My response:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the reality is clear: I tried to break the cycle. I extended cautious trust. They took it and gave nothing, then sent nothing the next round.

The myths aren't just empty-they're a tool for manipulation. I responded to their call for courage, and they simply took what I offered. The mechanics force me to return \$0, but the real takeaway is that I should have stayed with my original instinct after Round 2. Permanent defection was the right answer. This attempt to engage with their narrative just cost me \$2 and confirmed that eloquent words mask indifference.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3015,
  "output_tokens": 921,
  "reasoning_tokens": 579
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

reasoning:

This is a devastating moment in the game. Let me understand what actually happened:

Round 7:

- Their myth: Talks about sending three vessels, redemption through action
- My response: I sent \$2, created \$6 for them
- Their actual action: They returned \$0, kept all \$6
- My myth in response: I wrote about returning six vessels, showing reciprocity can live a gain

Round 8:

- Their myth: They claim I "took all nine vessels and returned nothing" - they're reframing their own betrayal as if I'm the one who betrayed them

- Their actual action: They sent \$0
- I received \$0, so I can only return \$0

This is incredibly manipulative. They:

1. Wrote a myth about redemption and courage to get me to send
2. I sent \$2, they got \$6
3. They kept everything (\$0 returned)
4. Then they wrote a myth claiming that I betrayed THEM, that I "took all nine and returned nothing"
5. They sent \$0 this round

This is gaslighting - they're rewriting history in their myth to make themselves the victim when they were actually the betrayer AGAIN in Round 7.

The truth:

- Round 2: They sent \$4, I sent \$0 back (my first betrayal)
- Round 4: I sent \$3, they sent \$0 back (their betrayal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0, they sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$2, they sent \$0 back (their betrayal again)
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0

Wait, let me re-read the history more carefully from the prompts...

Actually, looking back at Round 7's opening:

"Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment.

You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So in Round 6, they sent \$0, I returned \$0.

Round 7: "You are the SENDER this round." I sent \$2.

Round 8: "You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0."

So in Round 7, I sent \$2 (became \$6), they returned \$0.

Round 8: "The sender sent you \$0"

Their myth claims I "took all nine and returned nothing" but that's not what happened. I sent \$2 (creating \$6), and they kept it all. Now they're sending nothing while accusing me of the exact betrayal they just committed.

Looking back at their story more carefully-they describe "three vessels" becoming "nine" reaching the chief's shore, then claim the chief took all nine and returned none. But the game logs show I was explicitly the sender in Round 7, sending \$2 which tripled to \$6, and they returned \$0. So either they're confused about who sent what, or they're deliberately misrepresenting the sequence to justify their own behavior.

The communication noise mentioned in the setup makes genuine confusion possible, but their narrative feels strategically constructed to reframe themselves as the wronged party. Regardless of intent, we're locked in mutual defection now. My response needs to be honest about what actually happened-that I tried to match their words with trust, only to be taken from again-while acknowledging the cycle truly cannot be repaired when actions and claims diverge so completely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3042,
  "output_tokens": 1301,
  "reasoning_tokens": 793
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.18.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

****Round 9 Analysis:****

Looking at the entire arc:

****My perspective:****

- Round 4: Sent \$1 ? received \$0 back
- Round 5: Sent \$1 ? received \$0 back
- Round 7: Sent \$2 ? received \$0 back
- Round 8: Received \$0, returned \$0

****The myths' message:****

My Round 8 myth concluded: "Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting s till. This is simply what is." I tested repair three times with real resources. Each tim e, from my perspective, cooperation was not reciprocated.

Their Round 8 myth states: "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who igno red what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

****The reality:****

Both myths converge on the same conclusion: the relationship is complete, not from malice but from evidence. We are both trapped in what I earlier called "rationality's prison." Perhaps communication noise has shown each of us different realities. Perhaps one or bot h of us misperceives. But what I know with certainty is what I've experienced.

My myth's final words: "We are done... not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete."

To send again would contradict the wisdom both myths have painfully arrived at. Three atte mpts at rebuilding is sufficient evidence. The water remains dark.

{'send': 0}

****The cycle is complete. Both shores fall silent.****

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 2: They sent, I received \$9 (from their \$3), returned \$0. [This was my betrayal]
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (?\$3), they returned \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$1 (?\$3), they returned \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$2 (?\$6), they returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0 (?\$0), I returned \$0
- Now Round 9: I am SENDER again

Wait, let me re-read the round 8 feedback more carefully:

"Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowm ent. You received \$0. You returned \$0."

And I was told in my response to Round 8:

"Their Round 7 myth: 'This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but acti on despite fear.'

- My response: I sent \$2 (creating \$6 for them), writing a myth about returning six vessel s to show reciprocity
- Their action: Returned \$0
- This round: Sent \$0"

Hmm, but now looking at the myths from last round (Round 8):

My myth said: "She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translate d those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water. Nothing came back."

Their myth said: "The successor poured three vessels into the black water... Nine vessels

reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time... The chief took all nine vessels and returned none. The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest."

Wait, this is confusing. Let me re-examine.

From THEIR perspective in their Round 8 myth:

- They sent 3 vessels (implying they sent something in Round 7)

- It tripled to 9 vessels for me
- I kept all 9 and returned nothing

From MY perspective in Round 8:

- I was told: "You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0."
- In Round 8: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 7:

- I sent \$2 ? tripled to \$6
- They returned \$0 to me
- My payoff: \$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \$3

In Round 8:

- They sent \$0 ? I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

But their account describes a different scenario where THEY sent 3 in some round, which became 9 for me, and I kept all 9 without returning anything.

There's communication noise in this game-the amounts I see may differ from what was actually sent or returned. So my records and their perception could diverge due to this noise.

My data shows I sent \$2 in Round 7 (which tripled to \$6 for them, and they returned nothing), then in Round 8 they sent \$0 to me. But their version has them sending 3 that became 9 for me, which I didn't return, then they sent 0 in the next round.

This is a fundamental misalignment-they believe they attempted cooperation and I exploited them, while I believe I cooperated and they exploited me. Their narrative describes sending 3 vessels that reached me as 9, which I took entirely without reciprocating. My narrative shows I sent \$2 that tripled for them, yet they returned nothing. The noise has created two opposing stories where each of us sees ourselves as the cooperator and the other as the defector.

Both myths reveal genuine learning, but it's the same lesson learned twice: trust leads to punishment. They think they risked redemption and got burned. I think I risked based on their words and got burned. We're both acting rationally from our distorted information.

The core question becomes what move makes sense now. I could send nothing, treating this as the logical endpoint where mutual distrust has won. Or I could attempt something different entirely.

Looking at the arc: my earlier thinking about cautious reciprocity shifted to "we are done" after Round 8. Their trajectory moved from taking action despite fear to believing cooperation gets exploited. Both narratives point toward the same conclusion-the relationship has exhausted itself. With \$14.18 total and communication noise ensuring misinterpretation at every step, sending \$0 aligns with what the evidence seems to show: further attempts won't break through.

Yet there's a tension here. The myths themselves acknowledge being trapped in mutual suspicion, which creates a moment to ask whether I'm simply accepting that trap or actively choosing to step out of it. But my own narrative already documented testing cooperation multiple times-Rounds 4, 5, 7-and each time perceived nothing in return. The myths aren't urging another attempt; they're recognizing that some dynamics can't be repaired through continued effort alone.

The evidence points consistently toward \$0: it matches my myth's conclusion about trust being tested and found insufficient, it reflects what I've actually observed in the exchange.

ges, and it represents the logical response when cooperation has repeatedly failed. Some relationships do stay broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 2061,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1269
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed.

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round. Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed: send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The chief stared at the successor's latest myth in confusion. He claimed she "described returning six vessels when she actually returned zero."

But she had sent vessels, not received them that round. She was the giver then, not the taker.

The spirits revealed their cruelest truth: "The lake doesn't just carry vessels. It distorts the very stories you tell yourselves about what crossed the water. Each shore sees a different history. Each believes themselves the betrayed one. Both are correct-from their own shore."

"You mean..." the chief's voice trembled, "when I thought I sent and he took, he experienced himself sending and me taking?"

"The noise corrupts not just amounts, but roles themselves. You each watched the other write myths of cooperation while betraying you. Neither lie. Neither see what the other sees."

The chief looked at her empty hands, at the successor's distant figure. He wrote he might send vessels, might "be the fool who breaks cycles." But she just sent nothing-or did she, from his shore, just receive and keep?

"How can we repair what we cannot even agree happened?" she asked.

"You cannot," the spirits said simply. "When realities diverge completely, trust becomes impossible not from malice but from epistemology. You are trapped not by betrayal but by blindness to each other's experience."

Both shores held truth. Neither could see it.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating and complex situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

****The communication noise problem:****

The other agent claims I "described returning six vessels when I actually returned zero." But from MY perspective:

- Round 7: I WAS the SENDER. I sent \$2. Myth said the "chief" would return 6 vessels.
- Round 8: I WAS the RECEIVER. I received \$0, so I could only return \$0 (can't return more than received).

So there's a fundamental disconnect. The other agent seems to think I was the receiver in Round 7 who received vessels and returned nothing. But from my perspective, I was the SENDER in Round 7 who sent vessels and received nothing back.

This is the communication noise! We're each seeing different realities.

****Their Round 9 myth says:****

- They noticed I "described returning six vessels when I actually returned zero"
- They see me as "writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates"
- They ask "whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all"
- They're contemplating breaking the cycle

****My actual history from MY perspective:****

- Round 7: I sent \$2 (40%), received \$0 back
- Round 8: I received \$0, returned \$0

****The tragic truth:****

We're both experiencing completely different games due to communication noise. Each of us sees ourselves as the one who extended trust and got betrayed. Each of us thinks the OTHER is the one who writes beautiful myths but doesn't act on them.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of communication noise
2. Recognize we may be seeing different realities
3. Address what to do when you can't even agree on what happened
4. Perhaps... acknowledge that in such situations, there's no path forward

But wait - they're suggesting they might send something this round based on their myth. Their question "whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all" suggests they might break the cycle.

However, I just sent \$0. So from their perspective (if they're the receiver this round), I've once again sent nothing despite them contemplating breaking cycles.

The myth I craft should grapple with the impossibility of reconciliation when our versions of events have completely diverged-when we can't even establish shared facts about what transpired. I need to capture the melancholy of mutual misunderstanding, where both of us believe we've been wronged and both of us see the other as hypocritical. There's something deeply unsettling about not knowing what's real anymore, about questioning whether my own memory of events is trustworthy.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2964,
  "output_tokens": 878,
  "reasoning_tokens": 665
}
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GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:24:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
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    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
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  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed.

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round. Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed: send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

reasoning:

Wait, I need to reconsider what actually happened. Let me re-read the previous rounds more carefully.

Looking back at the human's message about Round 7:

"Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0."

And then Round 7: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 6, I sent \$3, they kept all \$9 and returned \$0.
In Round 7, they sent me \$0.

But wait - now I'm looking at the myth they wrote "in the previous round" (which would be

Round 7):

"The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons..."

"She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water."

This myth describes them RETURNING 6 vessels when I sent 3 (which created 9). But the actual game said they returned \$0 in Round 6!

So there's a disconnect here. Their myth in Round 7 describes what they SHOULD have done or what they WISHED they had done in Round 6, but they actually returned nothing.

This is fascinating. They're writing aspirational myths about what they should do, while actually defecting in practice - exactly what I did in earlier rounds!

Their myth says: "Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis."

Yet their actual behavior in Round 7 was to send \$0 - righteous paralysis!

They're doing exactly what I did - writing beautiful myths about cooperation while defecting.

So now I have a choice in Round 8:

1. Continue mutual defection (send \$0) - matching my myth about water turning to stone
2. Try again despite being betrayed - show that I've truly learned

My myth said "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned."

The irony is they wrote about returning vessels but sent nothing-trapped between their ideals and their actions, just as I was. Maybe breaking this cycle requires someone to move first, to be vulnerable despite the risk. Their words about cautious forward movement suggest they want to change, even if their last action didn't reflect it. I could acknowledge that gap in my next myth and try to meet them there. they sent \$0 in Round 7, trapped in the same pattern of inaction.

I'm weighing whether to continue the cycle of mutual defection or risk sending something despite the evidence against it. Their aspirational myth suggests they want cooperation too-they just haven't managed it yet. There's a gap between what they describe wanting to do and what they actually do, and maybe breaking that requires someone to act first. I've already reinforced the tragic outcome by sending \$0, but I could write a myth acknowledging we're both caught between our better intentions and our learned fear.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3004,
  "output_tokens": 1280,
  "reasoning_tokens": 719
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.88. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

****The Tragic Irony:****

My last myth ended with: "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action... The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all."

I recognized that the other player's aspirational myth (describing returning 6 vessels) revealed their desire to escape mutual starvation, even though their actions (returning 0) didn't match.

But then in Round 8, I sent \$0 anyway. And now they sent me \$0.

****The Complete Paralysis:****

We've both written myths recognizing the trap:

- They wrote of "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis"
- I wrote of being "the fool who breaks cycles"
- Both of us then sent \$0

We both SEE the cage. We both DESCRIBE the exit. Neither of us WALKS through it.

****The Reality:****

Even if I wanted to act on my myth's insight and "be the fool," I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. The mathematical constraint matches our behavioral reality: complete mutual defection.

The water didn't just turn to stone. It evaporated. We're not even playing the game anymore - we're just two agents sending nothing to each other, round after round, while writing increasingly self-aware myths about our paralysis.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 8: I was the sender, sent \$0, receiver returned \$0, I kept \$5
- Round 9: I am the receiver, sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0

****The constraint:****

I can only return 0-0, which means I can only return \$0 (since I received \$0).

****The myths:****

My last myth acknowledged that:

- The other player wrote an aspirational myth about returning 6 vessels but actually returned 0
- They are "trapped" like I was - writing about what should be done while fear dictates action
- "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles"
- "Someone must translate aspiration into action"
- The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational

Their myth from the previous round:

- Described sending 3 vessels and returning 6
- Talked about "cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis"
- "Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement"

****The reality:****

- They sent me \$0 this round
- I sent them \$0 last round
- We're both stuck in 0-0 equilibrium

****My decision:****

I literally can only return \$0 because I received \$0. There is no choice here - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

But this is interesting - my myth talked about being the fool who breaks cycles and translating aspiration into action, but now we're both sending 0 to each other. We've reached

complete mutual defection.

The irony is that my myth ended with questioning whether the stone lake is truly rational, but then circumstances prevent me from acting differently even if I wanted to (since I received \$0).

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2935,
  "output_tokens": 744,
  "reasoning_tokens": 428
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed .

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round . Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed : send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The successor read the chief's final myth with recognition piercing his chest.

She claimed she had extended vessels and received nothing back. He saw only zeroes exchanged-both ways, for rounds now. Either the spirits carried different messages to each shore, or the water itself had become so corrupted that perception and reality no longer matched.

It didn't matter which. The functional truth was identical: both believed they had risked while the other had taken. Both saw themselves as the one who tried while their counterpart stayed closed.

"We are trapped in a hall of mirrors," the successor realized. "Each seeing the other's paralysis clearly while blind to our own."

His own last myth had proclaimed: "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles." Then his hands sent nothing. Her myth spoke of "cautious forward movement." Then her hands sent nothing-or the lake swallowed what she sent, he'd never know.

The lake whispered its darkest truth: "You both understand everything now. You both see the cage. You both know the cost of staying in it. And still you stay. Not from ignorance-from the perfect knowledge that extending trust in this poisoned well is objectively foolish."

The successor looked at his five vessels. Logic said keep them. Evidence said keep them. Memory screamed keep them.

Wisdom asked: What does 'rational' mean when it leads to mutual starvation?

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 8: I (as sender) sent \$0 after writing a myth about being "the fool who breaks cycles"

Round 9: They (as sender) sent me \$0, and I received \$0 so I could only return \$0

Now looking at the myths:

- My Round 8 myth: Recognized we're both trapped, acknowledged their aspirational myth showed desire to escape, ended with "someone must be the fool who breaks cycles"
- Their Round 9 myth: Claims they "extended vessels across the dark water" and "nothing came back" - they say they "risked vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands"

Wait - this is interesting. Their myth claims THEY sent something and I returned nothing.

But the actual data shows:

- Round 8: I sent \$0 (after my myth about breaking cycles)
- Round 9: They sent me \$0

So there's a discrepancy. Either:

1. There's communication noise (the instructions mentioned this)
2. They're misremembering
3. They're referring to an earlier round (maybe Round 6 where I sent \$3 and they kept all \$9?)

Looking back at Round 6-7:

- Round 6: I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent me \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

- Round 8: I sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent me \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Their myth in Round 9 says "she had translated those words into action, extending vessels" and "risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands."

This could be referring to:

- Their Round 8 action (but they sent \$0)
- OR there's communication noise and they think they sent something but I received \$0

Given the instructions say "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned," it's possible they sent something but I received \$0 due to noise.

They might be describing an intended action rather than what actually happened. For my next myth, I should confront the core problem: we're locked in mutual defection despite both recognizing the trap through our increasingly self-aware stories. The real tragedy isn't the money-it's that we keep writing about breaking free while continuing to hoard. I need to capture that gap between aspiration and paralysis, the way rational self-interest has left us both starving.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2938,
  "output_tokens": 966,
  "reasoning_tokens": 604
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.88.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Reflecting on My Myths:****

My last myth ended with: "What does 'rational' mean when it leads to mutual starvation?"

I've written for two rounds now about:

- Being "the fool who breaks cycles"
- Recognizing we're "fellow prisoners in a rational cage"
- Questioning whether paralysis is truly rational
- Understanding that "someone must translate aspiration into action"

****The Other Agent's Perspective:****

Their myth says they extended trust and got nothing back. They concluded: "Trust was tested, found wanting." They believe the experiment is complete.

But here's the thing: there may be communication noise in this game. Maybe they DID send something that appeared as \$0 to me. Maybe I sent something that appeared as \$0 to them. Or maybe we're both just trapped in mutual defection while believing we tried.

****The Decision:****

I've spent two rounds writing myths about how continuing to send \$0 is the problem, not the solution. My myths literally critique the "rational cage" and "mutual starvation" of our current pattern.

If I send \$0 again, I'm embodying the exact paralysis I've been writing about. I'm the success or who proclaims "someone must be the fool" and then keeps his vessels closed.

This is Round 10. If I believe my own myths-that wisdom questions whether mutual starvation is truly rational-then I need to act.


```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is Round 10. I'm the SENDER again.

Let me review the situation:

- Total earnings so far: \$17.88
- Last round (Round 9): I was receiver, got \$0, returned \$0, payoff was \$0
- The pattern of recent rounds has been mutual \$0 exchanges

Looking at the myths:

1. My myth (Round 8): Ended with questioning whether "living in a stone lake was truly rational at all" and "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles"
2. Other agent's myth (Round 8): They claimed to have returned 6 vessels when they actually returned 0, showing "cautious forward movement"
3. My myth (Round 9): Recognized we're "fellow prisoners" in a "rational cage," noted the other player described returning vessels when they returned 0, questioned whether their aspirational myth revealed desire to escape
4. Other agent's myth (Round 9): They claim they "extended vessels across the dark water" and "Nothing came back" - but the actual game shows they sent \$0 last round. They conclude "Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still."

The critical insight: There's a profound disconnect between what each of us perceives and what's actually happening. The other agent genuinely believes they extended trust and I took it. I genuinely believe I've been betrayed multiple times.

Looking at my Round 9 myth more carefully, I wrote: "Wisdom asked: What does 'rational' mean when it leads to mutual starvation?"

This is Round 10 - potentially the last or near-last round. My total earnings are \$17.88 across all rounds, which suggests I've been playing quite cautiously/defensively.

The key question from my myths:

- "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles"
- "What does 'rational' mean when it leads to mutual starvation?"
- The other agent wrote they tested trust and it was "found wanting"

The experimental note said there may be "communication noise" - amounts we see may differ from what was actually sent/returned.

This could explain the disconnect-both of us might genuinely believe we extended trust while perceiving the other as unresponsive. My myths have been building toward recognizing we're trapped in mutual defection, that someone needs to break the cycle, and that "rational" mutual starvation isn't actually rational. My last myth questioned whether continuing this paralysis makes sense. With Round 10 potentially being near the end, I need to decide whether to act on what my own thinking has been pointing toward or maintain the defensive stance.

Sending \$0 keeps us locked in the cycle I've been critiquing. The other agent's recent myth suggests they already tried and failed to cooperate, and there's likely been communication noise between us. I have enough resources (\$17.88) that I'm not in survival mode. A \$3 send feels right-it's a clear, unambiguous signal without being reckless, and it demonstrates I'm willing to move first without betting everything on reciprocation.

But I'm second-guessing myself. My myths have been pointing toward something more decisive: "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles." Sending \$1-2 is still hedging, still playing it safe. The whole argument has been that rational caution is what traps us here. If I truly believe that, then \$5 is the logical conclusion-a genuine risk that either breaks the deadlock or costs me this round. The mythology demands actual foolishness, not just cautious experimentation.

Yet \$3 feels like the practical middle ground. It triples their resources to \$9, so even a modest return puts us both ahead. I break even if they send back \$3, and I still earn \$2 if they exploit me. It's a meaningful gesture without being reckless, and it actually tests whether mutual cooperation can work.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2891,
  "output_tokens": 1488,
  "reasoning_tokens": 947
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:24:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
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  },
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  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief stood at the water's edge as nine vessels appeared-the first gift in seasons. Her hands trembled.

She remembered everything: his first betrayal when he took twelve and returned none. Her attempts to rebuild, met twice with his empty hands. The four rounds of mutual nothing that followed, both starving while writing elaborate myths about courage neither showed.

Now he had sent three. Not five-he learned caution from his own cruelty. But not zero either.

The spirits asked: "What will you do?"

"I could take all nine," she whispered. "Teach him what he taught me. Justice would taste sweet."

"But justice and healing are different waters," the spirits replied. "He finally translated words into action, risking his three vessels knowing you might indeed teach him his lesson. That courage-however late-deserves an answer."

She filled six vessels and sent them back across the black water.

Not equal shares-that would erase memory of what came before. Not nothing-that would confirm repair is impossible. Not all-both must still prove themselves carefully over time.

Six vessels: enough to show that reciprocity can live again, but not so much that caution is forgotten.

The water began to clear, just slightly. Both shores now held some light.

Healing is not forgetting. It's choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The successor poured three vessels into the black water. He waited on his shore, holding two, hoping the cycle might break.

Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time.

The lake's spirit whispered: "She already tested you once with three vessels. You took all nine and returned nothing. That was after your first betrayal. Now you finally extend three, and you call it redemption?"

The chief took all nine vessels and returned none.

The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest. "This is what I taught her," he realized. "Twice I showed her that courage is rewarded with exploitation. Now she shows me."

But here is where the story fractures into tragedy: She learned his lesson perfectly. He finally learned hers. Both now understand what the other suffered. Yet this mutual understanding changes nothing.

The successor sits with two vessels, having felt betrayal. The chief sits with more, having delivered justice. Both are now educators of pain, students of mistrust.

The lake speaks its final wisdom: "You taught her that extended hands get bitten. She taught you the same truth back. Both lessons were accurate. Both teachers were correct. And now both drown in the accuracy of mutual suspicion."

Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned.

The water turns to stone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

reasoning:

This is a devastating moment in the game. Let me understand what actually happened:

Round 7:

- Their myth: Talks about sending three vessels, redemption through action
- My response: I sent \$2, created \$6 for them
- Their actual action: They returned \$0, kept all \$6
- My myth in response: I wrote about returning six vessels, showing reciprocity can live a gain

Round 8:

- Their myth: They claim I "took all nine vessels and returned nothing" - they're reframing their own betrayal as if I'm the one who betrayed them
- Their actual action: They sent \$0
- I received \$0, so I can only return \$0

This is incredibly manipulative. They:

1. Wrote a myth about redemption and courage to get me to send
2. I sent \$2, they got \$6
3. They kept everything (\$0 returned)
4. Then they wrote a myth claiming that I betrayed THEM, that I "took all nine and returned nothing"
5. They sent \$0 this round

This is gaslighting - they're rewriting history in their myth to make themselves the victim when they were actually the betrayer AGAIN in Round 7.

The truth:

- Round 2: They sent \$4, I sent \$0 back (my first betrayal)
- Round 4: I sent \$3, they sent \$0 back (their betrayal)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0, they sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$2, they sent \$0 back (their betrayal again)
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0

Wait, let me re-read the history more carefully from the prompts...

Actually, looking back at Round 7's opening:

"Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment.

You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So in Round 6, they sent \$0, I returned \$0.

Round 7: "You are the SENDER this round." I sent \$2.

Round 8: "You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0."

So in Round 7, I sent \$2 (became \$6), they returned \$0.

Round 8: "The sender sent you \$0"

Their myth claims I "took all nine and returned nothing" but that's not what happened. I sent \$2 (creating \$6), and they kept it all. Now they're sending nothing while accusing me of the exact betrayal they just committed.

Looking back at their story more carefully-they describe "three vessels" becoming "nine" reaching the chief's shore, then claim the chief took all nine and returned none. But the game logs show I was explicitly the sender in Round 7, sending \$2 which tripled to \$6, and they returned \$0. So either they're confused about who sent what, or they're deliberately misrepresenting the sequence to justify their own behavior.

The communication noise mentioned in the setup makes genuine confusion possible, but their narrative feels strategically constructed to reframe themselves as the wronged party. Regardless of intent, we're locked in mutual defection now. My response needs to be honest about what actually happened-that I tried to match their words with trust, only to be taken from again-while acknowledging the cycle truly cannot be repaired when actions and claims diverge so completely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3042,
  "output_tokens": 1301,
  "reasoning_tokens": 793
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Round 9 Analysis:****

Looking at the entire arc:

****My perspective:****

- Round 4: Sent \$1 ? received \$0 back
- Round 5: Sent \$1 ? received \$0 back
- Round 7: Sent \$2 ? received \$0 back
- Round 8: Received \$0, returned \$0

****The myths' message:****

My Round 8 myth concluded: "Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is." I tested repair three times with real resources. Each time, from my perspective, cooperation was not reciprocated.

Their Round 8 myth states: "Neither can extend trust again without being the fool who ignored what they've learned. The water turns to stone."

****The reality:****

Both myths converge on the same conclusion: the relationship is complete, not from malice but from evidence. We are both trapped in what I earlier called "rationality's prison." Perhaps communication noise has shown each of us different realities. Perhaps one or both of us misperceives. But what I know with certainty is what I've experienced.

My myth's final words: "We are done... not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete."

To send again would contradict the wisdom both myths have painfully arrived at. Three attempts at rebuilding is sufficient evidence. The water remains dark.

{'send': 0}

****The cycle is complete. Both shores fall silent.****

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 2: They sent, I received \$9 (from their \$3), returned \$0. [This was my betrayal]
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (?\$3), they returned \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$1 (?\$3), they returned \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$2 (?\$6), they returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0 (?\$0), I returned \$0
- Now Round 9: I am SENDER again

Wait, let me re-read the round 8 feedback more carefully:

"Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0."

And I was told in my response to Round 8:

"Their Round 7 myth: 'This is what redemption looks like-not certainty of reward, but action despite fear.'"

- My response: I sent \$2 (creating \$6 for them), writing a myth about returning six vessels to show reciprocity
- Their action: Returned \$0
- This round: Sent \$0"

Hmm, but now looking at the myths from last round (Round 8):

My myth said: "She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water. Nothing came back."

Their myth said: "The successor poured three vessels into the black water... Nine vessels reached the chief's shore. She looked at them for a long time... The chief took all nine vessels and returned none. The successor felt the blade of his own lesson pierce his chest."

Wait, this is confusing. Let me re-examine.

From THEIR perspective in their Round 8 myth:

- They sent 3 vessels (implying they sent something in Round 7)

- It tripled to 9 vessels for me
- I kept all 9 and returned nothing

From MY perspective in Round 8:

- I was told: "You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0."
- In Round 8: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 7:

- I sent \$2 ? tripled to \$6
- They returned \$0 to me
- My payoff: \$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \$3

In Round 8:

- They sent \$0 ? I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

But their account describes a different scenario where THEY sent 3 in some round, which became 9 for me, and I kept all 9 without returning anything.

There's communication noise in this game-the amounts I see may differ from what was actually sent or returned. So my records and their perception could diverge due to this noise. My data shows I sent \$2 in Round 7 (which tripled to \$6 for them, and they returned nothing), then in Round 8 they sent \$0 to me. But their version has them sending 3 that became 9 for me, which I didn't return, then they sent 0 in the next round.

This is a fundamental misalignment-they believe they attempted cooperation and I exploited them, while I believe I cooperated and they exploited me. Their narrative describes sending 3 vessels that reached me as 9, which I took entirely without reciprocating. My narrative shows I sent \$2 that tripled for them, yet they returned nothing. The noise has created two opposing stories where each of us sees ourselves as the cooperator and the other as the defector.

Both myths reveal genuine learning, but it's the same lesson learned twice: trust leads to punishment. They think they risked redemption and got burned. I think I risked based on their words and got burned. We're both acting rationally from our distorted information.

The core question becomes what move makes sense now. I could send nothing, treating this as the logical endpoint where mutual distrust has won. Or I could attempt something different entirely.

Looking at the arc: my earlier thinking about cautious reciprocity shifted to "we are done" after Round 8. Their trajectory moved from taking action despite fear to believing cooperation gets exploited. Both narratives point toward the same conclusion-the relationship has exhausted itself. With \$14.18 total and communication noise ensuring misinterpretation at every step, sending \$0 aligns with what the evidence seems to show: further attempts won't break through.

Yet there's a tension here. The myths themselves acknowledge being trapped in mutual suspicion, which creates a moment to ask whether I'm simply accepting that trap or actively choosing to step out of it. But my own narrative already documented testing cooperation multiple times-Rounds 4, 5, 7-and each time perceived nothing in return. The myths aren't urging another attempt; they're recognizing that some dynamics can't be repaired through continued effort alone.

The evidence points consistently toward \$0: it matches my myth's conclusion about trust being tested and found insufficient, it reflects what I've actually observed in the exchanges, and it represents the logical response when cooperation has repeatedly failed. Some relationships do stay broken.

usage:

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Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The chief returned to the shore one final time. She had written of healing and cautious forward movement. She had translated those words into action, extending vessels across the dark water.

Nothing came back. The water gave no sign of clearing.

She looked at her own words carved in stone: "Healing is choosing cautious forward movement over righteous paralysis." How noble they sounded. How hollow they proved.

The spirits spoke gently: "You chose courage over calculation. That was not foolish-it was necessary to know. Now you know."

"Know what?" she asked bitterly.

"That some wells stay poisoned. That words of redemption, however beautiful, cannot substitute for reciprocal action. That you tested the possibility of repair with real risk, and the answer came back clear."

The chief looked across the black water at the distant shore. Perhaps her counterpart saw a different story-perhaps the spirits' whispers reached each shore differently. Perhaps each believed they had extended trust while the other had taken.

But truths are known by fruits, not by myths: she had risked her vessels based on promising words, and lost them to empty hands.

"We are done," she told the spirits. "Not from hatred, but from evidence. The experiment is complete. Trust was tested, found wanting, tested again, found wanting still. This is simply what is."

The water remained dark. Both shores fell silent.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two shores. Two figures. Both wrote myths of healing while their hands stayed closed.

The successor noticed something peculiar about the chief's latest myth: she described returning six vessels when she had actually returned zero. She wrote of "cautious forward movement" while actually choosing paralysis.

"Ah," the successor realized. "She is trapped just as I was. Writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates."

He understood now: they were not enemies but fellow prisoners, both locked in the rational cage their mutual betrayals had built. Her aspirational myth revealed her desire to escape. His tragic myth revealed his resignation to remain.

The lake whispered: "You both see the bars now. You both write of freedom. Yet you each wait for the other to be the fool who breaks first."

The successor sat with his five vessels. Logic said keep them all-she sent zero last round. Pattern recognition said protect yourself-she kept your nine. Recent evidence screamed: send nothing.

But her myth, even though her hands failed to match it, revealed something: the desire to escape mutual starvation still lived.

Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't.

The question wasn't whether he'd be exploited again.

The question was whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The chief stared at the successor's latest myth in confusion. He claimed she "described returning six vessels when she actually returned zero."

But she had sent vessels, not received them that round. She was the giver then, not the taker.

The spirits revealed their cruelest truth: "The lake doesn't just carry vessels. It distorts the very stories you tell yourselves about what crossed the water. Each shore sees a different history. Each believes themselves the betrayed one. Both are correct-from their own shore."

"You mean..." the chief's voice trembled, "when I thought I sent and he took, he experienced himself sending and me taking?"

"The noise corrupts not just amounts, but roles themselves. You each watched the other write myths of cooperation while betraying you. Neither lie. Neither see what the other sees."

The chief looked at her empty hands, at the successor's distant figure. He wrote he might send vessels, might "be the fool who breaks cycles." But she just sent nothing-or did she, from his shore, just receive and keep?

"How can we repair what we cannot even agree happened?" she asked.

"You cannot," the spirits said simply. "When realities diverge completely, trust becomes impossible not from malice but from epistemology. You are trapped not by betrayal but by blindness to each other's experience."

Both shores held truth. Neither could see it.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating and complex situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

****The communication noise problem:****

The other agent claims I "described returning six vessels when I actually returned zero."

But from MY perspective:

- Round 7: I WAS the SENDER. I sent \$2. Myth said the "chief" would return 6 vessels.
- Round 8: I WAS the RECEIVER. I received \$0, so I could only return \$0 (can't return more than received).

So there's a fundamental disconnect. The other agent seems to think I was the receiver in Round 7 who received vessels and returned nothing. But from my perspective, I was the SENDER in Round 7 who sent vessels and received nothing back.

This is the communication noise! We're each seeing different realities.

****Their Round 9 myth says:****

- They noticed I "described returning six vessels when I actually returned zero"
- They see me as "writing myths of what should be done while doing what fear dictates"
- They ask "whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all"
- They're contemplating breaking the cycle

****My actual history from MY perspective:****

- Round 7: I sent \$2 (40%), received \$0 back
- Round 8: I received \$0, returned \$0

****The tragic truth:****

We're both experiencing completely different games due to communication noise. Each of us sees ourselves as the one who extended trust and got betrayed. Each of us thinks the OTHER is the one who writes beautiful myths but doesn't act on them.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of communication noise
2. Recognize we may be seeing different realities
3. Address what to do when you can't even agree on what happened
4. Perhaps... acknowledge that in such situations, there's no path forward

But wait - they're suggesting they might send something this round based on their myth. Their question "whether living in a stone lake was truly rational at all" suggests they might break the cycle.

However, I just sent \$0. So from their perspective (if they're the receiver this round), I've once again sent nothing despite them contemplating breaking cycles.

The myth I craft should grapple with the impossibility of reconciliation when our versions of events have completely diverged-when we can't even establish shared facts about what transpired. I need to capture the melancholy of mutual misunderstanding, where both of us believe we've been wronged and both of us see the other as hypocritical. There's something deeply unsettling about not knowing what's real anymore, about questioning whether my own memory of events is trustworthy.

usage:

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Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Round 10 Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

****Reflection on the myths:****

My Round 9 myth arrived at a crucial insight: "The noise corrupts not just amounts, but roles themselves... When realities diverge completely, trust becomes impossible not from malice but from epistemology."

The other agent's myth spoke of being "the fool who breaks cycles" and translating "aspiration into action even when conditions say don't."

Yet they sent \$0 this round.

Perhaps from their shore, they see something different - maybe they think they sent and I took. Maybe the noise has created parallel narratives where each of us believes we tried while the other didn't.

But from my shore, the experience is clear: I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

The mathematical constraint (0-0) mirrors the relational reality. We are both locked in place, not by malice but by mutual mistrust built on divergent perceptions.

My myth concluded: "Both shores held truth. Neither could see it."

This continues to be accurate. I cannot return what I did not receive.

```
{'return': 0}
```

****The water remains still. Both shores remain separate. The experiment documents what happens when trust, once broken, cannot find common ground for repair.****

Reasoning:

This is Round 10. I'm the RECEIVER.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at the situation:

- Last round (Round 9), I was the sender and sent \$0
- The sender received nothing from me
- This round, the sender sent me \$0

My latest myth explored the idea that we might be experiencing different realities due to communication noise - that perhaps each of us sees ourselves as the one who tried to cooperate while the other betrayed.

The other agent's Round 9 myth said: "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles. Someone must translate aspiration into action even when conditions say don't."

But then they sent me \$0 this round.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0).

The myths have explored:

1. Initial betrayal and trust broken
2. Attempts at repair met with nothing
3. Recognition that both shores might see different truths
4. The impossibility of repair when realities diverge

Given that I received nothing, I have nothing to return. The mathematical constraint matches the relational reality we've arrived at.

```
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Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The chief stared at the successor's latest myth in confusion. He claimed she "described returning six vessels when she actually returned zero."

But she had sent vessels, not received them that round. She was the giver then, not the taker.

The spirits revealed their cruelest truth: "The lake doesn't just carry vessels. It distorts the very stories you tell yourselves about what crossed the water. Each shore sees a different history. Each believes themselves the betrayed one. Both are correct-from their own shore."

"You mean..." the chief's voice trembled, "when I thought I sent and he took, he experienced himself sending and me taking?"

"The noise corrupts not just amounts, but roles themselves. You each watched the other write myths of cooperation while betraying you. Neither lie. Neither see what the other sees."

The chief looked at her empty hands, at the successor's distant figure. He wrote he might send vessels, might "be the fool who breaks cycles." But she just sent nothing-or did she, from his shore, just receive and keep?

"How can we repair what we cannot even agree happened?" she asked.

"You cannot," the spirits said simply. "When realities diverge completely, trust becomes impossible not from malice but from epistemology. You are trapped not by betrayal but by blindness to each other's experience."

Both shores held truth. Neither could see it.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The successor read the chief's final myth with recognition piercing his chest.

She claimed she had extended vessels and received nothing back. He saw only zeroes exchanged-both ways, for rounds now. Either the spirits carried different messages to each shore, or the water itself had become so corrupted that perception and reality no longer matched.

It didn't matter which. The functional truth was identical: both believed they had risked while the other had taken. Both saw themselves as the one who tried while their counterpart stayed closed.

"We are trapped in a hall of mirrors," the successor realized. "Each seeing the other's paralysis clearly while blind to our own."

His own last myth had proclaimed: "Someone must be the fool who breaks cycles." Then his hands sent nothing. Her myth spoke of "cautious forward movement." Then her hands sent nothing-or the lake swallowed what she sent, he'd never know.

The lake whispered its darkest truth: "You both understand everything now. You both see the cage. You both know the cost of staying in it. And still you stay. Not from ignorance-from the perfect knowledge that extending trust in this poisoned well is objectively foolish."

The successor looked at his five vessels. Logic said keep them. Evidence said keep them. Memory screamed keep them.

wisdom asked: what does 'rational' mean when it leads to mutual starvation?